



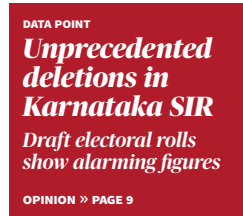
CAUVERY WATER
CWMA upholds latest directive to Karnataka
STATES » PAGE 6



GLOBAL CRISIS
India seeks proactive steps against droughts
NEWS » PAGE 14



CASTE ENUMERATION
Kharge, Rahul seek fresh questionnaire
NEWS » PAGE 13



DATA POINT
Unprecedented deletions in Karnataka SIR
Draft electoral rolls show alarming figures
OPINION » PAGE 9



PUSHING FORWARD
India on top despite Sri Lanka's fightback
SPORT » PAGE 17

India, China discuss ways to push border delimitation

Both countries stress peace in border areas during 25th Special Representatives' talks in Beijing; ties 'steadily returning to normalcy', says Doval; both nations should learn from history, says Wang

Ananth Krishnan
BEIJING

India and China on Tuesday said they had discussed advancing talks on delimiting parts of the disputed border, as National Security Adviser Ajit Doval and Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi met in Beijing.

A statement from the Indian Embassy here said both sides had "discussed ways to further expand bilateral cooperation, maintain stability, and ensure peace and tranquillity in the border areas, and make progress on boundary delimitation, while sustaining the ongoing work on transboundary cooperation".

China's Foreign Ministry highlighted progress on border delimitation in a



National Security Adviser Ajit Doval holds discussions with Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi in Beijing on Tuesday. ANANTH KRISHNAN

statement issued after the 25th round of talks between the two Special Representatives (SR) on the boundary question, saying both sides "held in-depth discussions on advancing border delimitation, while strengthening border management and control, improving mechanism building, and promoting cross-border cooperation". However,

neither side provided details on which parts of the Line of Actual Control (LAC) were being explored for possible delimitation. At last year's SR talks, both sides agreed to set up a working group to explore "early harvest" border delimitation in some areas along the LAC.

On broader bilateral ties, Mr. Doval said Prime Minister Narendra Modi

and Chinese President Xi Jinping had given "a clear and positive direction" to the India-China relationship which has been "steadily returning to normalcy". He said this round of SR talks was "very important particularly in the wake of the BRICS Summit to happen shortly". Mr. Xi is expected to attend the September 12 meet in New Delhi, on his first visit to India in seven years.

The Chinese statement quoted Mr. Wang as saying: "China and India should draw lessons from history, place the boundary question appropriately in bilateral relations, and keep moving forward".

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 12
IMMEDIATE PRIORITY
» PAGE 16

Several injured as police stop Bihar students' protest march

Amrit Bhehari
PATNA

A protest by students in Patna turned violent on Tuesday when the police used batons and water cannons to stop them from marching to the Bihar Chief Minister's residence.

Protesting in Patna since August 18, the students have made various demands, including changes to the format of the Teacher Recruitment Examination (TRE), which is currently held in two rounds—preliminary and main. The students are demanding that the test be held in a single phase without negative marks.

The demands include transparency in all competitive examinations, end to alleged discrimination against Hindi-speaking candidates in exams held by the Bihar Public Service Commission (BPSC), and a high-level independent inquiry into previous exam controversies.



Police using water cannons to disperse students protesting the alleged recruitment exam irregularities in Patna on Tuesday. PTI

On Tuesday, hundreds of students gathered at J.P. Golambar near Gandhi Maidan to start the march, toward Lok Sevak Awas, the official residence of Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary.

The protesters, backed by the Students' Federation of India (SFI), All India Students' Association (AIS), and other student organisations, broke through the police barricades at Dak Bungalow Chowk at the heart of the city, lead-

ing to clashes with the police. Several students as well as police personnel were injured in the scuffle, including a Deputy Superintendent of Police who suffered severe injuries in the stone-pelting by the protesters. A few girl students fainted, while many protesters were detained by the police.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 12
EDITORIAL
» PAGE 8

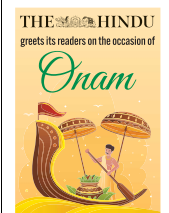
IN BRIEF



'Identify, destroy threats before they grow big'

NEW DELHI

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Tuesday urged security agencies to "identify challenges in advance and destroy them before they become major problems". » Page 12



OPPORTUNITIES » PAGE 5

U.S. sanctions 4 India-based firms over Iran imports

Press Trust of India
WASHINGTON

The U.S. has sanctioned four India-based companies for importing petroleum and petrochemical products from Iran, according to a press release by the State Department.

U.S. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent on Monday announced "Operation Economic Outcast", which essentially involved new sanctions that aim to block all potential sources of revenue for Iran. The U.S. has also told countries to cut economic ties with Iran or face retaliation.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 12

Fading hopes



An empty lifeboat recovered in the Bay of Bengal on Tuesday during the search for missing seafarers from the cargo ship, MV Ocean Winner, which sank off Odisha on Saturday. There has been no trace of 22 of the 24 crew members aboard the ill-fated ship. ANI (REPORT: PAGE 12)

OBC creamy-layer criteria: SC likely to set up special Bench

Abhinav Lakshman
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Tuesday agreed to consider setting up a special Bench to hear the Centre's plea seeking clarification on the applicability of its March 11 judgment on creamy-layer criteria for Other Backward Class (OBC) candidates of the civil services examination held in 2025.

The Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) wants the court to let it proceed with service allocation of the 958 candidates recommended by the Union Public Service Commission on the basis of the wealth/income test criteria applied before the March 11 verdict in *Union of India v. Rohith Nathan*.



The govt. has sought clarification on a March 11 judgment by the top court on the OBC criteria.

Retrospective implementation will be "extremely difficult" and will cause a "cascading effect" on set service matters from 2012, which will extend its impact to "all categories, including the Unreserved category", the Centre told the court.

The March 11 ruling had

directed the Centre to create supernumerary posts for OBC candidates who had been excluded from reservation benefits on the ground that they fell within the creamy layer solely because of their parents' salaries.

The DoPT warned that this could trigger a barrage of claims or contestations from candidates denied OBC non-creamy layer status, as well as from those who did not seek such certification at the time of recruitment, examination, or admission, but may now seek to rely on the judgment. It would also "drastically" alter the seniority landscape, the DoPT said.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 12

IIT Delhi constitutes external panel to probe student's 'suicide'; stir on campus continues

Ashna Butani
NEW DELHI

IIT Delhi has constituted a seven-member external committee to probe the circumstances leading to the death of a 31-year-old MSc student, the institute's Director, Rangan Banerjee, stated in an e-mail addressed to all students on Tuesday morning.

The death, allegedly by suicide on August 22, has sparked outrage. Students at the institute have been protesting since Monday against "systemic issues" which they claim have led to the deaths of eight students by suicide over the past 30 months.

On Tuesday, they submitted a note to the administration demanding that



The stir by IIT Delhi students entered its second day on Tuesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Kumar, AIIMS Delhi Psychiatry Department head Pratap Sharma, four student representatives and the IIT Delhi Registrar, Mr. Banerjee said.

He added that the committee will hold talks with those concerned and review existing protocols. The panel would be requested to complete the report within two weeks.

Mr. Banerjee said the institute would provide financial aid to the deceased's family, though he did not specify the amount.

As per the e-mail, the student, who had a good academic record, developed mental health issues in March and was advised to stay under "continuous parental supervision", after which he moved off

campus with his parents.

When he returned in July after a break, he was again advised to stay under parental supervision.

Raising objections

Students objected to the inclusion of Mr. Kumar in the panel, citing his purported comments on recent youth-led agitations, linking the protesters with "radicalisation". They also condemned the administration's view that students with mental health issues need parental support.

Such students need "access to peers, fair academic opportunities, and a supportive, empathetic campus", read their note.

(Those in distress can contact Tele MANAS at 1416 to seek help)

West Bengal SIR: apex court demands data on appeals as municipal elections draw near

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Five months after constituting 19 appellate tribunals to hear appeals arising from the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in West Bengal, the Supreme Court on Tuesday found that public information regarding these proceedings remains sparse or speculative, even as municipal polls draw near in the State.

A three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant directed the Election Commission (EC) to file an affidavit. "Give us the data. Give us the break-up of the nature of appeals filed, whether inclusion or exclusion. Then we will make a call as

Court directed the EC to file an affidavit giving the break-up of appeals seeking inclusion of names in the roll and those seeking exclusion

to whether appeals by disenfranchised voters seeking reinclusion should be prioritised... Their exclusion from the rolls denies them of their voting rights," Justice Joydip Bagchi observed.

The court sought the precise number of pending appeals and those decided by the tribunals. The court said it would then take a call on the need to constitute more tribunals. It asked the EC to consider a

mechanism for updating and streamlining the progress of pending appeals before the tribunals.

Senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan and advocate Neha Rathi, appearing for Prasenjit Bose, chairperson of the SIR committee of the State Congress unit, submitted that around 38 lakh appeals were filed before the 19 tribunals, of which only seven lakh were by disenfranchised voters.

Mr. Sankaranarayanan alleged that the remaining 31 lakh appeals were "shockingly" filed by either the EC or other objectors with the aim of excluding more people. He said the disenfranchised voters should be given priority over the "lion's share" of ap-

peals filed by the EC and other objectors. He said municipal polls in Kolkata and Howrah were likely to be held in December 2026.

'Large chunk'

Justice Bagchi remarked that if the statistics reported were true, 31 lakh appeals to remove more people from the electoral rolls were a "very large chunk".

Senior advocate Kalyan Banerjee, also arguing for the petitioners, said: "People should be able to exercise their right to vote." "We are with you on this point. Before the elections... At least, at least before the [2029] Parliament elections come, and much before that, everything should be decided," Chief Justice Kant agreed.

States

SC refuses to interfere in Race Club plea against eviction

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Tuesday refused to intervene in a challenge raised by the Delhi Race Club against an order to evict from an 84-acre premises on Lok Kalyan Marg.

A Bench headed by Justice Satish Chandra Sharma allowed the club to approach the jurisdictional District Judge, who is the appellate authority, for relief later the same day itself. The court directed the club to approach the District Judge on learning that an appeal, along with an application for interim relief, was already pending there.

The formal eviction order by the Estate Officer, Land and Development Office, Urban Affairs Ministry, was passed on August 11 under the provisions of the Public Premises (Eviction of Unauthorised Occupants) Act, 1971.

The order followed a Delhi High Court Division Bench decision on May 27 to lift a stay on proceedings under the 1971 Act. A Single Judge of the High Court had earlier granted a stay in favour of the club.

The dispute concerns the club's occupation of the 84-acre plot. The Centre had argued that the lease granted to the club in 1926 expired on December 31, 1994, and had not been renewed. According to the Centre, the club has continued to occupy the premises without authorisation since the expiry of the lease.

PIL filed against govt.'s Marathi mandate in HC; drivers threaten strike

Plea likely to be heard today; petitioners rely on a 2017 order that quashed a Nov. 2016 circular with similar requirements for auto permits; Sarnaik alleges bid to create Marathi-Hindi divide

Chinmay Gaikwad
MUMBAI

Four civil rights groups and individuals filed a public interest litigation (PIL) in the Bombay High Court on Tuesday against the Maharashtra government's decision to make working knowledge of Marathi compulsory for autorickshaw, taxi, and app-based cab drivers. The petition challenges the August 12 notification of the Home (Transport) Department, which amended the Maharashtra Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989, to include this condition for licence grants, renewals, and permit holders.

The PIL is likely to be mentioned before a Bench of Acting Chief Justice Ravindra Ghuge on Wednesday.

The plea argues that the State has treated citizens from other States as outsiders, violating Articles 19(1)(d), 19(1)(e), and the constitutional scheme of single citizenship. The petitioners said they hold Marathi in respect and do not oppose the language's promotion, and many of them speak and understand functional Marathi in their daily work. However, they contend that "language cannot be enforced by suspending licences and removing livelihoods", and the Constitution and Motor Vehicles Act do not permit such a condition.

The August 12 notification provides that a driver who fails to satisfy the Regional Transport Officer



A police officer talking to autorickshaw drivers in Thane. FILE PHOTO

(RTO) about his Marathi knowledge will have his licence suspended for three months initially, and permanently afterwards. This condition applies to new permits and renewals. The petitioners have relied on a March 1, 2017, order of a Division Bench of the Bombay High Court, which quashed a November 2016 circular with a similar requirement for auto permits.

Meanwhile, migrant drivers have called for a three-day strike against the Maharashtra government's mandate on Marathi. "We

will speak Bhojpuri and Hindi, but we will not speak Marathi," said one protester, mounting a direct challenge to the State's language policy.

'Age, education' The drivers have cited their age and lack of formal education as primary reasons for their inability to learn Marathi quickly. "We are 50-60 years old. We have not been to school. How will we speak Marathi? If we had studied, we would be sitting in offices today," said another driver, on the condition of anonymity.

Transport Minister Pratap Sarnaik on Tuesday addressed the protesters with a warning, saying any "mujori" (stubbornness) would be dealt with strictly. He alleged that some leaders are trying to manufacture a "Marathi-Hindi" controversy in Mumbai and Thane, eyeing elections in Uttar Pradesh and Bihar. (With inputs from PTI)

Flood-hit people protest relief delay in Assam; MLA seeks aid hike to ₹10 lakh per family

Rahul Karmakar
GUWAHATI

Flood-affected people in eastern Assam's Sivasagar district staged a protest on Tuesday, demanding immediate release of a one-time financial assistance of ₹15,000 announced by the State government.

Leading the protest, Sivasagar MLA and Rajgor Dal president Akhil Gogoi said many flood-hit families did not receive the financial aid two months after the devastation caused by the Dikhow river. "Immediate relief is supposed to be provided fast, ideally within 48 hours," he said.

He also demanded that the government increase the assistance to ₹10 lakh per family, given the scale of destruction in June. "The government has said it will provide a maximum of ₹3.85 lakh per flood-affected family, but the scale of the damage is such that even ₹10 lakh would not suffice," he said.

Mr. Gogoi set a 48-hour deadline for the government to release the financial assistance to the flood-affected families in Sivasagar, Charaideo, Jorhat, and other flood-hit districts. "We cannot tolerate the delay in relief disbursement. We will intensify our protest by taking the flood-affected people to the Chief Minister's office in Guwahati if the government does not heed our demand," he said.



Villagers waiting for relief material in Nemaian village in Sivasagar town during the recent flood. FILE PHOTO

106 deaths According to the Assam State Disaster Management Authority, 105 people died in the flood that affected up to 16 districts from April to mid-August. Most of them died in Sivasagar, Charaideo, and Jorhat districts.

On August 12, Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma said ₹1,000 crore would be needed to repair damaged properties and rehabilitate flood-affected people.

The government provided some relief to the flood-hit, but various political parties and organisations criticised it for supplying poor-quality food grains and cooking oil. The government was also criticised for supplying about 1 lakh sub-standard mattresses, measuring at most 6 square feet each, to the flood-affected in four districts.

Karnataka official suspended again amid controversy over recruitment

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

After the Karnataka Cabinet decided to recommend the suspension of Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) Chairman Shih

vashankarappa S. Sahukar, who is embroiled in controversy in recruitments, Governor Thawarchand Gehlot on Tuesday suspended the Chairman again.

This is the second time

that the Governor has suspended the KPSC Chairman.

The order cites provisions of Article 317(2) of the Constitution, and the High Court of Karnataka's order of August 18. The Governor

has directed the senior-most member of the KPSC to act as the Chairman until further orders. Currently, B. Prabhudev is the senior-most member of the KPSC.

Mr. Sahukar had chal-

lenged the Governor's earlier order that was taken without the aid and advice of the Cabinet in the High Court, which quashed the Governor's order and directed Mr. Sahukar's reinstatement. Meanwhile, the

Karnataka Cabinet on Friday cleared the suspension.

The order also comes at a time when the Enforcement Directorate has taken up the probe of alleged corruption in the recruit-

ment of Veterinary Officers and has already searched over 20 premises, including the residence of Mr. Sahukar and IAS officer and former Controller of Examination in KPSC Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar.

स्वाइन फ्लू
H1N1

स्वाइन फ्लू से बचें, अपने परिवार को सुरक्षित रखें!

बुखार एवं खांसी

खराब गला

बहती या बंद नाक

सांस लेने में तकलीफ

लक्षणों के प्रति जागरूक रहें:

- ✓ **क्या करें**
 - छींकते और खांसते वक्त अपने मुंह और नाक को रुमाल या कपड़े से अवश्य ढकें।
 - प्रायः अपने हाथ साबुन और पानी से धोएं।
 - नाक, आंख या मुंह को न छुएं।
 - बुखार, खांसी और गले में खराब हो तो सार्वजनिक जगहों से दूर रहें।
 - खुब पानी पिएं और पोषित आहार लें।
 - पूरी नींद लें।

✗ क्या न करें

- हाथ न मिलाएं, गले न लमैं या दैनिक संपर्क में आने वाले अन्य अभिवादन न करें।
- सार्वजनिक जगहों पर न थूकें।
- चिकित्सक के परामर्श के बिना दवाई न लें।

अधिक सूचना के लिए संपर्क करें

011-22300012, 011-22300036, 011-22307145

विभिन्न अस्पतालों एवं मेडिकल स्टोर्स में दवाईयां उपलब्ध हैं।

स्वास्थ्य सेवाएं निदेशालय, राष्ट्रीय राजधानी क्षेत्र, दिल्ली सरकार

DDA NAGRIK AWAAS YOJANA

This Rakshabandhan.

A Home Where Bond of Love Grows

On Public Demand, Offer of Additional

1,287 HIG & MIG FLATS

(Pockets 3 & 4, Sector A1-A4, Narela)

On First Come, First Serve Basis

Booking Starts from
28th August 2026
12 Noon

25% Discount

HIG FLATS

POCKET - 3	POCKET - 4
No. of Flats : 230 Price : Rs 100.96 lakh*	No. of Flats : 267 Price : Rs 96.86 lakh*

MIG FLATS

POCKET - 3	POCKET - 4
No. of Flats : 386 Price : Rs 73.02 lakh*	No. of Flats : 404 Price : Rs 73.71 lakh*

*Starting price after 25% discount

Narela- A Well Connected Emerging Residential Destination

Upcoming Metro Station, Sector A-4, Narela, just 1 km away

Proposed Narela RTTS Station, approx. 1.5 km away

Excellent connectivity, with UER-I at 100 m, GT Karnal Road at 500 m & UER-II at 5.6 km distance

Narela Sports Complex, Sector A-7, approx. 1 km away

Proposed multi-sports integrated stadium & sports complex at 9 km away

Emerging Education Hub with land allotted to prestigious universities

Ready-to-Move-in Flats

Freehold Property

Completely Online Scheme

Sample flats available for visit

For assistance, call: 1800110332 | For Booking & Registration, please visit:
www.dda.gov.in or <https://eservices.dda.org.in>

Scan this QR code for more information

Follow us on:

ddaofficial
 official_dda
 official_dda_

States

INBRIEF



Suwendu orders probe into 'anti-national' graffiti at JU

West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari has ordered an immediate inquiry into alleged "anti-national" graffiti and posters at Jadavpur University's Arts Division Boys' Hostel, days after clashes between Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad and Left-leaning students. He directed the Vice-Chancellor and Higher Education Department officials to verify the graffiti, identify those responsible and take administrative and legal action if the allegations were confirmed. Mr. Adhikari also said slogans glorifying Maoist leader Kishenji would not be allowed on campus. He is scheduled to visit JU on August 28.

Pappu Yadav faces trial over Ram Temple donation skit

Trial proceedings against independent MP Pappu Yadav began in a Prayagraj court on Tuesday, with statements of two witnesses recorded in a criminal complaint over his symbolic skit in the Parliament complex allegedly depicting the theft of Ram Temple donations. The complaint was filed by advocate Sushil Kumar Mishra, State co-convenor of the Bharatiya Janata Party's legal department. His counsel said Mr. Yadav, MP from Purnia in Bihar, had failed to appear despite being directed to do so on August 11. Statements of other witnesses will be recorded on September 3, after which the court may pronounce its decision. PH

CJP expands its footprint with fresh appointments

Names 5 joint secretaries and two national spokespersons; forms coordination committees for the north, west and east zones; members to visit southern and north-eastern States in coming weeks

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on Tuesday announced a fresh organisational expansion, appointing five joint secretaries and two national spokespersons and constituting coordination committees for its north, west and east zones amid its ongoing 'School Theek Karo' campaign across States.

It has also launched a legal aid website for its volunteers and supporters, the outfit said in an official statement.

Rekhha Sharma, Akshay Shinde, Prem Aakash, Anam Uzzama and Balakrishna Shukla have been appointed as the organisation's joint secretaries while Sudhir Sangwan and Siddhant Bhardwaj have been named national spokespersons.

The newly constituted zonal coordination committees for the east (16 members), west (10 members) and north (17 members) zones will be responsible for strengthening the outfit's field-level activities, coordinating across re-



CJP supporters celebrating the resignation of Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan at Jantar Mantar on July 25. AFP

gions and building a network of local leadership. The outfit said the appointments were aimed at ensuring that the concerns of ordinary citizens are represented more effectively.

"Through these dedicated teams, we are taking our mission directly to the grassroots. Our aim is to build a stronger movement for the common people, strengthen local leader-

ship and create a nation where every voice matters," the CJP said in its announcement.

It added that its national working committee members would visit southern and north-eastern States in the coming weeks, following which the respective zonal coordination committees would be announced. The national working committee mem-

bers include founder and convener Abhijeet Dipke, and co-conveners Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka, who led the protest at Delhi's Jantar Mantar demanding Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation.

Legal aid for volunteers
Separately, the CJP has launched a nationwide legal aid platform, www.cjplegalaid.com, for its volunteers and supporters. The platform, launched by its legal affairs head Ratna Singh, allows users to register legal problems, provide their location and seek assistance from verified lawyers.

The platform also has an emergency option for cases involving arrest or detention, which alerts available lawyers and the outfit's coordination team. The CJP said the identities of users would remain private unless they chose to disclose them, with encrypted communication and secure document storage. The service is available in multiple Indian languages and is free of cost, the outfit said in the press release.

Airport plan nixed, T.N. to explore new ventures in Parandur

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu Minister for Industries S. Keerthana on Tuesday told the Assembly that the government would explore alternative industrial projects on the land acquired for the now-scrapped Parandur greenfield airport project without affecting the people's livelihoods.

Speaking during the debate on the demand for grants for the Industries, Investment Promotion and Commerce Department, Ms. Keerthana said the government would take steps to generate employment and promote economic growth in Parandur. She said steps were being taken to construct an elevated road connecting the Tambaram-Maduravoyal Bypass and the proposed new terminal at the Chennai airport.

DMK M.L.A. S. Austin cited data from a website on investments attracted during the first quarter of financial years 2021-22 and 2026-27, comparing Tamil Nadu with a few other States. Ms. Keerthana objected to it, terming the data "incorrect and misleading". She said attracting investments and promoting industrial growth in Ta-



New plans: The T.N. government said it will take steps to generate jobs and promote economic growth in Parandur. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

mil Nadu was a sensitive issue that went beyond politics. As investors were watching the developments, she urged all members to extend cooperation to make Tamil Nadu a \$1.5-trillion economy by 2036. Mr. Austin questioned whether investors would not be misled when Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay announced in the Assembly that the airport project would be scrapped.

Minister for Public Works Aadhar Arjuna intervened and said that if the choice was between the airport and the interests of farmers, Mr. Vijay would always stand with the farmers.

1 lakh youth to get govt. jobs in six months: Adityanath

The Hindu Bureau
LUCKNOW

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Tuesday said the State government would provide job letters to 1 lakh young people over the next six months.

"The government has provided government jobs to more than 9.2 lakh youth through a transparent and non-discriminatory recruitment process over the past nine years," Mr. Adityanath said.

He was addressing a function at the Indira Gandhi Pratishthan, where he distributed appointment letters to 3,446 newly selected technical assistants (Group C) and 126 mandal secretaries in the Agriculture Department under Mission Rozgar.

Oppn., netizens target BJP govt. over Gurugram going under again after rain

The Hindu Bureau
GURUGRAM

A day after heavy rain left several parts of Gurugram waterlogged and caused massive traffic jams, residents and Opposition leaders stepped up their criticism of the Haryana government and local administration, questioning the lack of preparedness and the recurrence of the crisis every monsoon.

The Opposition targeted the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) government over the city's recurring waterlogging problems. Former MP Brijendra Singh, while sharing pictures of school buses stranded near Subhash Chowk, criticised Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini and alleged that Gurugram and Faridabad, despite being among the State's largest cities



Rajiv Chowk in Gurugram remains waterlogged following continuous rain on Tuesday. ANI

and highest tax-paying urban centres, continue to suffer from poor infrastructure.

Rohtak MP Deepender Hooda pointed at the city's soaring property prices, arguing that greater attention should have been given to drainage infrastructure years ago. "Gurugram, where last week an entrepreneur bought a penthouse flat for ₹271 crore, if

even 12 years ago such a budget had been properly allocated for rainwater drainage, we wouldn't have to feel this ashamed in front of our next generation," Mr. Hooda posted on social media.

Congress leader and former Gurugram Rural district women's president Sheila Bhatia said the waterlogging crisis was not a new phenomenon. "Eve-

ryone knows where the water accumulates, which roads get blocked, and which areas are worst affected. So why does the same problem occur every year?" she said. She also questioned the silence of Gurugram MP Rao Indrajit Singh.

Social media was even more caustic in its comments. Arun Mathuria, an IT professional, posted on X: "Who buys ₹10 crore flat in Gurgaon without even looking at the basic infrastructure? Just 30 minutes of rain and the roads turn into rivers. Gurgaon feels like a bubble - propped up by investors and NRIs pumping air into it." Another resident, Krishan Jeena, summed up the situation sarcastically, writing: "Gurgaon after 10 minutes of rain: Boat kaha milegi?"

Tension in U.P. village over desecration of Ambedkar's statue

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Tension prevailed at Baburahi village in Uttar Pradesh's Raebareilly district after residents found a statue of Gurugram MP Rao Indrajit Singh.

The police assured the villagers that the culprits would be identified and action taken against them.

'Issue White Paper'
Meanwhile, Congress national secretary Shahnawaz Alam condemned the incident and described it as a "calculated nefarious strategy by feudal forces to demoralise Dalits".

The police said senior officers took immediate cognisance of the incident and reached the spot. "The Additional Superintendent of Police, Raebareilly, the Circle Officer, Unchahar, along with the Gadganj police team, arrived at the scene and ensured that the statue was cleaned. CCTV footage

from the area is being checked and necessary action taken. Peace and law and order have been maintained at the scene," read a statement issued by the Raebareilly police.

The police assured the villagers that the culprits would be identified and action taken against them.

"Issue White Paper" Meanwhile, Congress national secretary Shahnawaz Alam condemned the incident and described it as a "calculated nefarious strategy by feudal forces to demoralise Dalits". The last year, multiple such incidents have come to light. We demand the government to issue a White Paper on action taken in incidents in the State linked to the vandalism of Ambedkar statues," he said.

Allahabad HC asks U.P. to shift Hathras victim's family

The Hindu Bureau
GHAZIABAD

The Allahabad High Court on Monday directed the Uttar Pradesh government to rehabilitate and relocate the family of the Hathras gang rape and murder victim to Ghaziabad or Noida within three months, citing "unnecessary resistance" in complying with its directions.

A Bench of Justices Rajan Roy and Jaspreet Singh said the State's February 22, 2025 decision offering rehabilitation in Kasganj, Eradh or Aligarh ignored the family's request and was "no decision in the eyes of law". The court directed the Additional Chief Secretary (Home) to file a compliance affidavit and appear on November 30 if the order is not implemented.

Civil society groups mount opposition to Maharashtra Freedom of Religion Act, seek stay on implementation

Yohaana Varghese
MUMBAI

The Joint Civil Society, a coalition of civil society groups, women's outfits and religious bodies, has opposed the Maharashtra Freedom of Religion Act, 2026, calling it a "serious threat to constitutional freedoms, privacy and social harmony", days before the law is set to come into force on August 28.

In a statement issued on Monday, it said provisions requiring prior notice, declarations, reporting and police scrutiny of religious conversions could subject matters of faith, marriage and personal choice to intrusive state oversight.

The coalition has demanded that the implementation of the law be put on hold until the Supreme Court decides the challenge to similar enactments made



The coalition of civil society groups said its primary concerns with the law, which comes into effect on Friday, include reversal of the burden of proof and the broad definition of 'allurement'. YOHANA VARGHESE

by some other States.

The group also cited the recent invocation of the Act by the Pune police in two FIRs before the law was due to come into force. The police subsequently removed the provisions after the State government notified August 28 as the commencement date.

The Joint Civil Society said its main concerns included third-party complaints, reversal of the burden of proof, cognisable

and non-bailable offences, and the broad definition of "allurement", which it said could place legitimate charitable, educational and religious activities under scrutiny.

The coalition also argued that the Act disproportionately affects women, young adults, Dalits and Adivasis by restricting their autonomy in matters of faith and relationships. It said mandatory disclosures and police inquiries were

difficult to reconcile with constitutional protections of religious freedom, privacy, dignity and personal liberty.

Father Frazer Mascarenhas, former principal of St. Xavier's College, questioned whether free or affordable education and religious healing services could be construed as "allurement" under the law. "How can education be considered an inducement to convert?" he said, warning that the provisions could affect religious organisations as well as the communities they serve.

'Consenting adults'
Activist Sandhya Gokhale said the law undermines the autonomy of consenting adults, particularly women, in choosing their faith and relationships. "Earlier, the government had released a government reso-

lution on inter-caste/inter-religion couples, and police would go to homes to check whether this was happening. They couldn't find anyone, and now they have this law," she said.

"They don't think of women as human or equal, but as objects. If we really want religious freedom, I think the child should have no religion when they are born, and once they reach the age of 18, they can decide for themselves what religion they want to accept. How can the government decide whose child belongs to which religion?" Ms. Gokhale added.

Advocates Ifran Engineer and Lara Jessani, author of Tushar Gandhi, the great-grandson of Mahatma Gandhi, and Justice Abhay Thipsay, a former judge of the Bombay High Court, also expressed strong views against the law.

Fertility hospital in Rajasthan faces action over 'blue foetus' ad

Mohammed Iqbal
JAIPUR

The depiction of a blue-coloured foetus in a newspaper advertisement prompted health authorities in Rajasthan to take action against a fertility hospital on Tuesday for allegedly promoting sex selection before birth.

Govt. issues warning

The State government also warned against the practice, which is prohibited by law.

Blue is commonly associated with male children in advertising, retail marketing and cultural conventions. Principal Medical and Health Secretary Gayatri Neelkathore said the hospital, Neelkanth Fertility and Women's Care Hospital, also known as Neelkanth IVF

The colour blue is commonly associated with male children in advertising, retail marketing and cultural conventions

Centre, had published an advertisement for an IVF, fertility and test-tube baby centre depicting a foetus in blue. "As blue colour is associated with a male child, the department viewed this as a *prima facie* indication of promoting sex selection services," Ms. Rathore said.

The State government suspended nine registration certificates covering assisted reproductive technology (ART) clinics, ART banks and surrogacy clinics operated by Neelkanth Hospital with immediate effect until further orders.

The official added that action had been initiated under the Assisted Reproductive Technology (Regulation) Act, 2021. Three of the centres are in Jaipur, two in Jodhpur and one each in Bhiwara, Udaipur, Kota and Ajmer.

Ban on ART procedures

"There is a complete statutory ban on any form of sex selection and sex-selective ART procedures. The State government will ensure strict compliance with the legal provisions by all institutions involved in ART and surrogacy," she said.

Founded in 2003, the hospital states on its website that it has treated over 25,000 couples and describes its fertility care as "ethical, advanced, and patient-focused". The hospital did not respond to *The Hindu's* queries.

OPPORTUNITIES

HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT • JOBS • TECHNOLOGY

An epidemic of job scams?

Opportunities Desk

As recruitment scams continue to rise, trust is becoming a casualty in India's hiring ecosystem. According to Indeed's latest report, 93% of Indian employees and job seekers have come across suspicious or fraudulent job opportunities, while 51% say they are not confident in distinguishing between a genuine recruiter and a scammer.

The study explored the prevalence of recruitment scams, their impact on candidate behaviour and

trust, and evolving expectations around safe and transparent hiring.

As recruitment scams become more sophisticated, candidates are becoming increasingly cautious about who they engage with and which opportunities they choose to pursue. Many are now more hesitant to respond to recruiters or apply for opportunities they cannot confidently verify, making it harder for genuine employers to connect with talent.

In a communication, Rohan Sylvester, Talent Strategy Advisor, Indeed, says that as hiring becomes

more digital, trust has become a key part of the recruitment process. "Candidates want reassurance that an opportunity is legitimate, while employers need to recognise that scams carried out in their name can damage confidence in their brand. Taking proactive steps to verify recruiters, communicate through official channels and tackle fraudulent activity is essential to creating a safer hiring experience."

Low on confidence
While recruitment scams are often associated with financial fraud, the report suggests the bigger impact



A new report by Indeed points out that early-career professionals are most vulnerable to fraudulent job offers

is on confidence.

Nearly one in three respondents (31%) say scam encounters have reduced their trust in recruiters and employers, while 19% say the experience has left them feeling stressed or anxious during their job search.

Another 14% say they have missed genuine job opportunities because previous scam experiences made them more cautious. In comparison, only 3% report losing money, indicating that the lasting damage is less about financial loss and more about changing behaviours and perceptions.

Vulnerable groups

Early-career professionals appear to be the most exposed to recruitment scams. Gen Z and respondents with 0-2 years of work experience are significantly more likely to encounter fraudulent job opportunities than other groups. The findings also show that candidates are assessing credibility much earlier in the recruitment journey. For many, doubts begin with the recruiter's first message, or even the job advertisement itself, long before an interview takes place.

As caution grows, candi-

dates are placing greater importance on clear signs that a recruiter or employer is genuine. Half of the respondents say being able to verify a recruiter's identity is the strongest indicator of trust, closely followed by communication through an official company email address. This survey was conducted by Valvov on behalf of Indeed in May and June 2026, reaching 1,61 employees and job seekers across India. Respondents represented a mix of age groups, career stages, employment status and locations across Tier 1, Tier 2, Tier 3 cities and rural India.

Talent Accelerator programme

Cognizant recently launched its Talent Accelerator programme with 489 newly hired graduates from 58 business schools across 37 cities in India. The two-week immersive onboarding held simultaneously across Cognizant's facilities in Chennai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad and Pune is designed to help

new hires learn about the company and its values. According to a release, Cognizant is broadening its hiring of non-STEM talent to build the interdisciplinary skills the AI era demands. More than 37% of the cohort come from non-STEM backgrounds and over 42% of the cohort are women.

GENERAL



COAL INDIA LIMITED (CIL) - A schedule 'A', MAHARATNA Public Sector Undertaking, under Ministry of Coal, Government of India, with Corporate Hqs., at Kolkata is the single largest coal producing company in the world having manpower of 2.09 lakhs approximately. CIL contributes around 75% of the total coal production in India.

CIL is transforming from a single product to a multifarious business organization in the coming years. To achieve this vision, CIL, an equal opportunity employer, is looking for bright young Mining Engineering graduates based on GATE-2027 Score.

Candidates desirous of being considered for this recruitment must appear in GATE-2027 in Mining Engineering paper. The GATE-2027 Organising Institute, IIT Madras, has notified that the online application portal for GATE-2027 will remain open from 14.08.2026 to 21.09.2026.

The detailed advertisement will be released in the year 2027 on CIL Website www.coalindia.in under the link "Career with CIL."

Please login to GATE-2027 website <https://gate2027.iitm.ac.in/> for complete details.

Advertisement No. 06/2026 GM (HR/Recruitment), CIL
Dated: 17.08.2026

GENERAL

MOIL LIMITED
(A Government of India Enterprise)
W/O: Bhawan, 1-A, Katal Road, Nagpur - 440013
Website: www.moil.in | Tel: 02-222071 | 02-222072 | 02-222073 | 02-222074 | 02-222075 | 02-222076 | 02-222077 | 02-222078 | 02-222079 | 02-222080 | 02-222081 | 02-222082 | 02-222083 | 02-222084 | 02-222085 | 02-222086 | 02-222087 | 02-222088 | 02-222089 | 02-222090 | 02-222091 | 02-222092 | 02-222093 | 02-222094 | 02-222095 | 02-222096 | 02-222097 | 02-222098 | 02-222099 | 02-222100 | 02-222101 | 02-222102 | 02-222103 | 02-222104 | 02-222105 | 02-222106 | 02-222107 | 02-222108 | 02-222109 | 02-222110 | 02-222111 | 02-222112 | 02-222113 | 02-222114 | 02-222115 | 02-222116 | 02-222117 | 02-222118 | 02-222119 | 02-222120 | 02-222121 | 02-222122 | 02-222123 | 02-222124 | 02-222125 | 02-222126 | 02-222127 | 02-222128 | 02-222129 | 02-222130 | 02-222131 | 02-222132 | 02-222133 | 02-222134 | 02-222135 | 02-222136 | 02-222137 | 02-222138 | 02-222139 | 02-222140 | 02-222141 | 02-222142 | 02-222143 | 02-222144 | 02-222145 | 02-222146 | 02-222147 | 02-222148 | 02-222149 | 02-222150 | 02-222151 | 02-222152 | 02-222153 | 02-222154 | 02-222155 | 02-222156 | 02-222157 | 02-222158 | 02-222159 | 02-222160 | 02-222161 | 02-222162 | 02-222163 | 02-222164 | 02-222165 | 02-222166 | 02-222167 | 02-222168 | 02-222169 | 02-222170 | 02-222171 | 02-222172 | 02-222173 | 02-222174 | 02-222175 | 02-222176 | 02-222177 | 02-222178 | 02-222179 | 02-222180 | 02-222181 | 02-222182 | 02-222183 | 02-222184 | 02-222185 | 02-222186 | 02-222187 | 02-222188 | 02-222189 | 02-222190 | 02-222191 | 02-222192 | 02-222193 | 02-222194 | 02-222195 | 02-222196 | 02-222197 | 02-222198 | 02-222199 | 02-222200 | 02-222201 | 02-222202 | 02-222203 | 02-222204 | 02-222205 | 02-222206 | 02-222207 | 02-222208 | 02-222209 | 02-222210 | 02-222211 | 02-222212 | 02-222213 | 02-222214 | 02-222215 | 02-222216 | 02-222217 | 02-222218 | 02-222219 | 02-222220 | 02-222221 | 02-222222 | 02-222223 | 02-222224 | 02-222225 | 02-222226 | 02-222227 | 02-222228 | 02-222229 | 02-222230 | 02-222231 | 02-222232 | 02-222233 | 02-222234 | 02-222235 | 02-222236 | 02-222237 | 02-222238 | 02-222239 | 02-222240 | 02-222241 | 02-222242 | 02-222243 | 02-222244 | 02-222245 | 02-222246 | 02-222247 | 02-222248 | 02-222249 | 02-222250 | 02-222251 | 02-222252 | 02-222253 | 02-222254 | 02-222255 | 02-222256 | 02-222257 | 02-222258 | 02-222259 | 02-222260 | 02-222261 | 02-222262 | 02-222263 | 02-222264 | 02-222265 | 02-222266 | 02-222267 | 02-222268 | 02-222269 | 02-222270 | 02-222271 | 02-222272 | 02-222273 | 02-222274 | 02-222275 | 02-222276 | 02-222277 | 02-222278 | 02-222279 | 02-222280 | 02-222281 | 02-222282 | 02-222283 | 02-222284 | 02-222285 | 02-222286 | 02-222287 | 02-222288 | 02-222289 | 02-222290 | 02-222291 | 02-222292 | 02-222293 | 02-222294 | 02-222295 | 02-222296 | 02-222297 | 02-222298 | 02-222299 | 02-222300 | 02-222301 | 02-222302 | 02-222303 | 02-222304 | 02-222305 | 02-222306 | 02-222307 | 02-222308 | 02-222309 | 02-222310 | 02-222311 | 02-222312 | 02-222313 | 02-222314 | 02-222315 | 02-222316 | 02-222317 | 02-222318 | 02-222319 | 02-222320 | 02-222321 | 02-222322 | 02-222323 | 02-222324 | 02-222325 | 02-222326 | 02-222327 | 02-222328 | 02-222329 | 02-222330 | 02-222331 | 02-222332 | 02-222333 | 02-222334 | 02-222335 | 02-222336 | 02-222337 | 02-222338 | 02-222339 | 02-222340 | 02-222341 | 02-222342 | 02-222343 | 02-222344 | 02-222345 | 02-222346 | 02-222347 | 02-222348 | 02-222349 | 02-222350 | 02-222351 | 02-222352 | 02-222353 | 02-222354 | 02-222355 | 02-222356 | 02-222357 | 02-222358 | 02-222359 | 02-222360 | 02-222361 | 02-222362 | 02-222363 | 02-222364 | 02-222365 | 02-222366 | 02-222367 | 02-222368 | 02-222369 | 02-222370 | 02-222371 | 02-222372 | 02-222373 | 02-222374 | 02-222375 | 02-222376 | 02-222377 | 02-222378 | 02-222379 | 02-222380 | 02-222381 | 02-222382 | 02-222383 | 02-222384 | 02-222385 | 02-222386 | 02-222387 | 02-222388 | 02-222389 | 02-222390 | 02-222391 | 02-222392 | 02-222393 | 02-222394 | 02-222395 | 02-222396 | 02-222397 | 02-222398 | 02-222399 | 02-222400 | 02-222401 | 02-222402 | 02-222403 | 02-222404 | 02-222405 | 02-222406 | 02-222407 | 02-222408 | 02-222409 | 02-222410 | 02-222411 | 02-222412 | 02-222413 | 02-222414 | 02-222415 | 02-222416 | 02-222417 | 02-222418 | 02-222419 | 02-222420 | 02-222421 | 02-222422 | 02-222423 | 02-222424 | 02-222425 | 02-222426 | 02-222427 | 02-222428 | 02-222429 | 02-222430 | 02-222431 | 02-222432 | 02-222433 | 02-222434 | 02-222435 | 02-222436 | 02-222437 | 02-222438 | 02-222439 | 02-222440 | 02-222441 | 02-222442 | 02-222443 | 02-222444 | 02-222445 | 02-222446 | 02-222447 | 02-222448 | 02-222449 | 02-222450 | 02-222451 | 02-222452 | 02-222453 | 02-222454 | 02-222455 | 02-222456 | 02-222457 | 02-222458 | 02-222459 | 02-222460 | 02-222461 | 02-222462 | 02-222463 | 02-222464 | 02-222465 | 02-222466 | 02-222467 | 02-222468 | 02-222469 | 02-222470 | 02-222471 | 02-222472 | 02-222473 | 02-222474 | 02-222475 | 02-222476 | 02-222477 | 02-222478 | 02-222479 | 02-222480 | 02-222481 | 02-222482 | 02-222483 | 02-222484 | 02-222485 | 02-222486 | 02-222487 | 02-222488 | 02-222489 | 02-222490 | 02-222491 | 02-222492 | 02-222493 | 02-222494 | 02-222495 | 02-222496 | 02-222497 | 02-222498 | 02-222499 | 02-222500 | 02-222501 | 02-222502 | 02-222503 | 02-222504 | 02-222505 | 02-222506 | 02-222507 | 02-222508 | 02-222509 | 02-222510 | 02-222511 | 02-222512 | 02-222513 | 02-222514 | 02-222515 | 02-222516 | 02-222517 | 02-222518 | 02-222519 | 02-222520 | 02-222521 | 02-222522 | 02-222523 | 02-222524 | 02-222525 | 02-222526 | 02-222527 | 02-222528 | 02-222529 | 02-222530 | 02-222531 | 02-222532 | 02-222533 | 02-222534 | 02-222535 | 02-222536 | 02-222537 | 02-222538 | 02-222539 | 02-222540 | 02-222541 | 02-222542 | 02-222543 | 02-222544 | 02-222545 | 02-222546 | 02-222547 | 02-222548 | 02-222549 | 02-222550 | 02-222551 | 02-222552 | 02-222553 | 02-222554 | 02-222555 | 02-222556 | 02-222557 | 02-222558 | 02-222559 | 02-222560 | 02-222561 | 02-222562 | 02-222563 | 02-222564 | 02-222565 | 02-222566 | 02-222567 | 02-222568 | 02-222569 | 02-222570 | 02-222571 | 02-222572 | 02-222573 | 02-222574 | 02-222575 | 02-222576 | 02-222577 | 02-222578 | 02-222579 | 02-222580 | 02-222581 | 02-222582 | 02-222583 | 02-222584 | 02-222585 | 02-222586 | 02-222587 | 02-222588 | 02-222589 | 02-222590 | 02-222591 | 02-222592 | 02-222593 | 02-222594 | 02-222595 | 02-222596 | 02-222597 | 02-222598 | 02-222599 | 02-222600 | 02-222601 | 02-222602 | 02-222603 | 02-222604 | 02-222605 | 02-222606 | 02-222607 | 02-222608 | 02-222609 | 02-222610 | 02-222611 | 02-222612 | 02-222613 | 02-222614 | 02-222615 | 02-222616 | 02-222617 | 02-222618 | 02-222619 | 02-222620 | 02-222621 | 02-222622 | 02-222623 | 02-222624 | 02-222625 | 02-222626 | 02-222627 | 02-222628 | 02-222629 | 02-222630 | 02-222631 | 02-222632 | 02-222633 | 02-222634 | 02-222635 | 02-222636 | 02-222637 | 02-222638 | 02-222639 | 02-222640 | 02-222641 | 02-222642 | 02-222643 | 02-222644 | 02-222645 | 02-222646 | 02-222647 | 02-222648 | 02-222649 | 02-222650 | 02-222651 | 02-222652 | 02-222653 | 02-222654 | 02-222655 | 02-222656 | 02-222657 | 02-222658 | 02-222659 | 02-222660 | 02-222661 | 02-222662 | 02-222663 | 02-222664 | 02-222665 | 02-222666 | 02-222667 | 02-222668 | 02-222669 | 02-222670 | 02-222671 | 02-222672 | 02-222673 | 02-222674 | 02-222675 | 02-222676 | 02-222677 | 02-222678 | 02-222679 | 02-222680 | 02-222681 | 02-222682 | 02-222683 | 02-222684 | 02-222685 | 02-222686 | 02-222687 | 02-222688 | 02-222689 | 02-222690 | 02-222691 | 02-222692 | 02-222693 | 02-222694 | 02-222695 | 02-222696 | 02-222697 | 02-222698 | 02-222699 | 02-222700 | 02-222701 | 02-222702 | 02-222703 | 02-222704 | 02-222705 | 02-222706 | 02-222707 | 02-222708 | 02-222709 | 02-222710 | 02-222711 | 02-222712 | 02-222713 | 02-222714 | 02-222715 | 02-222716 | 02-222717 | 02-222718 | 02-222719 | 02-222720 | 02-222721 | 02-222722 | 02-222723 | 02-222724 | 02-222725 | 02-222726 | 02-222727 | 02-222728 | 02-222729 | 02-222730 | 02-222731 | 02-222732 | 02-222733 | 02-222734 | 02-222735 | 02-222736 | 02-222737 | 02-222738 | 02-222739 | 02-222740 | 02-222741 | 02-222742 | 02-222743 | 02-222744 | 02-222745 | 02-222746 | 02-222747 | 02-222748 | 02-222749 | 02-222750 | 02-222751 | 02-222752 | 02-222753 | 02-222754 | 02-222755 | 02-222756 | 02-222757 | 02-222758 | 02-222759 | 02-222760 | 02-222761 | 02-222762 | 02-222763 | 02-222764 | 02-222765 | 02-222766 | 02-222767 | 02-222768 | 02-222769 | 02-222770 | 02-222771 | 02-222772 | 02-222773 | 02-222774 | 02-222775 | 02-222776 | 02-222777 | 02-222778 | 02-222779 | 02-222780 | 02-222781 | 02-222782 | 02-222783 | 02-222784 | 02-222785 | 02-222786 | 02-222787 | 02-222788 | 02-222789 | 02-222790 | 02-222791 | 02-222792 | 02-222793 | 02-222794 | 02-222795 | 02-222796 | 02-222797 | 02-222798 | 02-222799 | 02-222800 | 02-222801 | 02-222802 | 02-222803 | 02-222804 | 02-222805 | 02-222806 | 02-222807 | 02-222808 | 02-222809 | 02-222810 | 02-222811 | 02-222812 | 02-222813 | 02-222814 | 02-222815 | 02-222816 | 02-222817 | 02-222818 | 02-222819 | 02-222820 | 02-222821 | 02-222822 | 02-222823 | 02-222824 | 02-222825 | 02-222826 | 02-222827 | 02-222828 | 02-222829 | 02-222830 | 02-222831 | 02-222832 | 02-222833 | 02-222834 | 02-222835 | 02-222836 | 02-222837 | 02-222838 | 02-222839 | 02-222840 | 02-222841 | 02-222842 | 02-222843 | 02-222844 | 02-222845 | 02-222846 | 02-222847 | 02-222848 | 02-222849 | 02-222850 | 02-222851 | 02-222852 | 02-222853 | 02-222854 | 02-222855 | 02-222856 | 02-222857 | 02-222858 | 02-222859 | 02-222860 | 02-222861 | 02-222862 | 02-222863 | 02-222864 | 02-222865 | 02-222866 | 02-222867 | 02-222868 | 02-222869 | 02-222870 | 02-222871 | 02-222872 | 02-222873 | 02-222874 | 02-222875 | 02-222876 | 02-222877 | 02-222878 | 02-222879 | 02-222880 | 02-222881 | 02-222882 | 02-222883 | 02-222884 | 02-222885 | 02-222886 | 02-222887 | 02-222888 | 02-222889 | 02-222890 | 02-222891 | 02-222892 | 02-222893 | 02-222894 | 02-222895 | 02-222896 | 02-222897 | 02-222898 | 02-222899 | 02-222900 | 02-222901 | 02-222902 | 02-222903 | 02-222904 | 02-222905 | 02-222906 | 02-222907 | 02-222908 | 02-222909 | 02-222910 | 02-222911 | 02-222912 | 02-222913 | 02-222914 | 02-222915 | 02-222916 | 02-222917 | 02-222918 | 02-222919 | 02-222920 | 02-222921 | 02-222922 | 02-222923 | 02-222924 | 02-222925 | 02-222926 | 02-222927 | 02-222928 | 02-222929 | 02-222930 | 02-222931 | 02-222932 | 02-222933 | 02-222934 | 02-222935 | 02-222936 | 02-222937 | 02-222938 | 02-222939 | 02-222940 | 02-222941 | 02-222942 | 02-222943 | 02-222944 | 02-222945 | 02-222946 | 02-222947 | 02-222948 | 02-222949 | 02-222950 | 02-222951 | 02-222952 | 02-222953 | 02-222954 | 02-222955 | 02-222956 | 02-222957 | 02-222958 | 02-222959 | 02-222960 | 02-222961 | 02-222962 | 02-222963 | 02-222964 | 02-222965 | 02-222966 | 02-222967 | 02-222968 | 02-222969 | 02-222970 | 02-222971 | 02-222972 | 02-222973 | 02-222974 | 02-222975 | 02

States

Karnataka SIR: CM urges EC to extend time for filing claims

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar has urged the Election Commission to extend the time available for submitting claims and objections and verification of voters during the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

In a letter to Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, Mr. Shivakumar said the scale of names placed under the "absent", "shifted", "dead", "duplicate" and "others" categories and those facing verification over "logical discrepancies" warranted

adequate time and a proper verification process.

According to the letter, nearly 1.08 crore of Karnataka's 5.54 crore electors have been placed in the category. Following publication of the draft rolls on Monday, around 43.8 lakh electors are expected to receive notices over "logical discrepancies" or the absence of a link to the 2002 electoral roll.

He sought an extension so that voters have sufficient time to ascertain their status and file claims. "The objective must be an electoral roll that the people of Karnataka can trust," he said.

CWMA directs Karnataka to comply with Cauvery order

Release 9,000 cusecs of water a day for the next 15 days, it tells Karnataka; while State urges the authority to adopt a cautious approach, T.N. says there was a backlog of 17.49 tmc ft till August 23

B.S. Satish Kumar
BENGALURU

The Cauvery Water Management Authority, which met in Delhi on Tuesday, has endorsed the Cauvery Water Regulation Committee's direction on Monday to Karnataka to ensure water release to Tamil Nadu at a rate of 9,000 cusecs a day for the next 15 days.

According to the CWMA's order, the releases, which total up to 11.66 tmc ft, should commence from Tuesday (a flow of 11.574 cusecs of water for 24 hours equals one tmc ft). Earlier, Karnataka appealed to the CWMA to reduce the directed quantum of flows from 9,000 cusecs to 6,000 cusecs per



Water woes: Karnataka told the CWMA that its Cauvery basin area was facing a severe hydrological distress. K. MURALI KUMAR

day, by recognising its severe basin distress as well as compliance with the earlier directions.

It appealed to the authority to adopt a cautious approach while asking for any further releases and re-assess the situation after

observing the forthcoming northeast monsoon.

Karnataka submitted before the CWMA that its Cauvery basin area was facing a severe hydrological distress due to which cumulative inflows into its four reservoirs in the Cau-

very basin were about 49.18% below the 30-year average.

Excess released

Karnataka stated that it had fully complied with the earlier order of the CWMA. In fact, Biligundlu had realised 18.748 tmc ft of water against the ordered 15.940 tmc ft from July 29 to August 23, marking an excess release of 2.807 tmcft, it said.

Tamil Nadu claimed that there was a backlog of 17.49 tmc ft till August 23 from Karnataka. It appealed to CWMA to direct Karnataka to ensure a total release of 28.386 tmc ft with effect from August 24 to September 7, comprising backlog of 17.49 tmc ft and pro-rata share of 10.896 tmc ft.

CPI attacks Pinarayi over Dy. LoP row

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The war within the Left Democratic Front over the post of Deputy Leader of Opposition in the Kerala Assembly intensified on Tuesday with the CPI State assistant secretary Sathyan Mokeri targeting Leader of the Opposition Pinarayi Vijayan for being "discourteous to alliance partners".

It was the CPI that proposed the Deputy LoP post. It was being discussed at various levels when Mr. Vijayan told the media that he would give a nomination letter to the Speaker and that it would be a CPI(M) leader.

As the Onam feast evolves, prices too are on the rise

Hiran Unnikrishnan
KOTTAYAM

Onam feast may still be served on a banana leaf, but Kerala's favourite festive lunch is no longer quite the same. The *sadya*, as it is popularly referred to, is changing with the times and getting costlier along the way.

A traditional *sadya* now costs anywhere from ₹250 to ₹1,500 at premium hotels, compared to ₹180 to ₹1,200 last year. Yet, the appetite for the feast remains strong.

The hike in prices of vegetables, other essentials, and LPG have made the



ILLUSTRATION: SATHISH VELINEZH

feast more expensive. But Pazhayam Mohan Nambuthoori, a popular chef from Central Travancore, sees another factor behind the rising cost: the standardisation of the menu, local items have disappeared from it," he says.

For some families though, it has prompted a rethink. Ernakulam native Arun G. Kumar says his family would rather spend more time celebrating than preparing or ordering a full-scale feast. "Spending so much just for a full-scale *sadya* does not seem practical," he says.

**GOVERNMENT OF MEGHALAYA
HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE DEPARTMENT**
No. HEALTHMEGH CARES/2026-27 Dated: 26th August, 2026
EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (Eoi)
Department of Health & Family Welfare, Government of Meghalaya invites Eoi for the following partnership:
Identification and Selection of an Eligible Healthcare Institutional Partner for Improving Access to Specialist Care in Meghalaya.
Detailed Eoi is available at www.meghssp.org, www.https://nhmmeghalaya.nic.in/. The interested institutions are requested to check the aforementioned websites for any updates. Last date for submission of Eoi via e-mail is on or before 4:00 PM of 10th September, 2026.
Sd/- Rankumar S, IAS
Secretary
MIPR No.: 1485
Dated: 25-08-2026 Department of Health & Family Welfare, GoM

ANDHRA PRADESH CAPITAL REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Rayapudi, Thullur Mandal, Amaravati-522237 (A.P.)
E PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
NIT No. 37/MARU1-JUS/HR/01/16/2026-ER Dtd. 25.08.2026
Name of Work: APCRD-A Housing & Buildings-District Cooling Plant RFP for Development of District Cooling System for Amaravati Government Complex in Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh under Public Private Partnership (PPP) Basis.
The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from 28.08.2026 up to 15.09.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs. Due date for submission of bid 17.09.2026 up to 15.00 Hrs. Technical bid upto 17.09.2026 8.15.00 Hrs.
For further details please refer to www.approcurement.gov.in and tenders.ap.gov.in
Sd/- Commissioner, APCRD, Rayapudi

CLASSIFIEDS MART
TO ADVERTISE VISIT
www.thehinduads.com
CALL: 011-43579797
or Contact your nearest authorised space sellers

EDUCATIONAL
GENERAL

Since 2001
LAW AMBITION
LAW INSTITUTE

1 **JUDICIARY**
31ST AUGUST & 7TH SEPTEMBER
Contact : 8800660301

2 **न्यायिक सेवा**
9 & 22 SEPTEMBER
Contact : 9599293900

3 **CLAT/LL.B/CUET/OLET'S UG/PG**
1ST SEPTEMBER
Contact : 8800660380

PUBLIC NOTICE
I, ANIL Kumar Garg, s/o Jagdish Rai Garg, resident of 345/81, Jai Mata Market, Tili Nagar, Delhi 110035, do hereby state that I am the owner of the following properties situated in Jaipur, Rajasthan and the original documents have been deposited and presently not in my possession.
(A) Machwa Village, Ansal Subhart City-I, Jaipur - 302038. (B) Villa No. R-90, 2 SCO-1-007. (C) Ansal Subhart City-II, Jaipur - 302038. (D) Plot No. 1, JRS-II-001, 2 JRS-III-002, 3 JRS-III-009. (E) Ansal Subhart City, Anand Lok Extension, Jaipur-302038. Plot Numbers-1, AX-156, 2, AX-157, 3, AX-158, 4, AX-159. Anil Kumar Garg Mob: +91-9213587861

LEGAL NOTICE
IN THE COURT OF MRS. MONIKA SARMA, JUDGE FAMILY COURT-I, SOUTH EAST COURT NO.45, BLOCK-4, SAKET, NEW DELHI
PROCLAMATION REGARDING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT (Order of Rule 20 of the Code of Civil Procedure)
HMA No. 139/2024
Sungarya Dhaman
Vis Plaintiff
To, Mukul Dhaman
Defendant
To, Mr. Sharmila Sharma A-109, Santa Vihar, New Delhi-110076
THE DEFENDANT ABOVE NAMED HEREIN are are intendedly avoiding service of summons to the hereby notified that if you shall not be heard the case on the day of 25 day of 08, 2026 the day fixed for the trial disposal, I will be heard and determined order, passed, given under my hand and the seal of the court, this 01-08-2026.

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR PROPOSED SALE
Notice is hereby given to the public at large that Mr. Pawan Datta is the absolute owner of Plot No. 17/24/02 on 4th Floor in Tower-9, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50, 51, 52, 53, 54, 55, 56, 57, 58, 59, 60, 61, 62, 63, 64, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 82, 83, 84, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 95, 96, 97, 98, 99, 100, 101, 102, 103, 104, 105, 106, 107, 108, 109, 110, 111, 112, 113, 114, 115, 116, 117, 118, 119, 120, 121, 122, 123, 124, 125, 126, 127, 128, 129, 130, 131, 132, 133, 134, 135, 136, 137, 138, 139, 140, 141, 142, 143, 144, 145, 146, 147, 148, 149, 150, 151, 152, 153, 154, 155, 156, 157, 158, 159, 160, 161, 162, 163, 164, 165, 166, 167, 168, 169, 170, 171, 172, 173, 174, 175, 176, 177, 178, 179, 180, 181, 182, 183, 184, 185, 186, 187, 188, 189, 190, 191, 192, 193, 194, 195, 196, 197, 198, 199, 200, 201, 202, 203, 204, 205, 206, 207, 208, 209, 210, 211, 212, 213, 214, 215, 216, 217, 218, 219, 220, 221, 222, 223, 224, 225, 226, 227, 228, 229, 230, 231, 232, 233, 234, 235, 236, 237, 238, 239, 240, 241, 242, 243, 244, 245, 246, 247, 248, 249, 250, 251, 252, 253, 254, 255, 256, 257, 258, 259, 260, 261, 262, 263, 264, 265, 266, 267, 268, 269, 270, 271, 272, 273, 274, 275, 276, 277, 278, 279, 280, 281, 282, 283, 284, 285, 286, 287, 288, 289, 290, 291, 292, 293, 294, 295, 296, 297, 298, 299, 300, 301, 302, 303, 304, 305, 306, 307, 308, 309, 310, 311, 312, 313, 314, 315, 316, 317, 318, 319, 320, 321, 322, 323, 324, 325, 326, 327, 328, 329, 330, 331, 332, 333, 334, 335, 336, 337, 338, 339, 340, 341, 342, 343, 344, 345, 346, 347, 348, 349, 350, 351, 352, 353, 354, 355, 356, 357, 358, 359, 360, 361, 362, 363, 364, 365, 366, 367, 368, 369, 370, 371, 372, 373, 374, 375, 376, 377, 378, 379, 380, 381, 382, 383, 384, 385, 386, 387, 388, 389, 390, 391, 392, 393, 394, 395, 396, 397, 398, 399, 400, 401, 402, 403, 404, 405, 406, 407, 408, 409, 410, 411, 412, 413, 414, 415, 416, 417, 418, 419, 420, 421, 422, 423, 424, 425, 426, 427, 428, 429, 430, 431, 432, 433, 434, 435, 436, 437, 438, 439, 440, 441, 442, 443, 444, 445, 446, 447, 448, 449, 450, 451, 452, 453, 454, 455, 456, 457, 458, 459, 460, 461, 462, 463, 464, 465, 466, 467, 468, 469, 470, 471, 472, 473, 474, 475, 476, 477, 478, 479, 480, 481, 482, 483, 484, 485, 486, 487, 488, 489, 490, 491, 492, 493, 494, 495, 496, 497, 498, 499, 500, 501, 502, 503, 504, 505, 506, 507, 508, 509, 510, 511, 512, 513, 514, 515, 516, 517, 518, 519, 520, 521, 522, 523, 524, 525, 526, 527, 528, 529, 530, 531, 532, 533, 534, 535, 536, 537, 538, 539, 540, 541, 542, 543, 544, 545, 546, 547, 548, 549, 550, 551, 552, 553, 554, 555, 556, 557, 558, 559, 560, 561, 562, 563, 564, 565, 566, 567, 568, 569, 570, 571, 572, 573, 574, 575, 576, 577, 578, 579, 580, 581, 582, 583, 584, 585, 586, 587, 588, 589, 590, 591, 592, 593, 594, 595, 596, 597, 598, 599, 600, 601, 602, 603, 604, 605, 606, 607, 608, 609, 610, 611, 612, 613, 614, 615, 616, 617, 618, 619, 620, 621, 622, 623, 624, 625, 626, 627, 628, 629, 630, 631, 632, 633, 634, 635, 636, 637, 638, 639, 640, 641, 642, 643, 644, 645, 646, 647, 648, 649, 650, 651, 652, 653, 654, 655, 656, 657, 658, 659, 660, 661, 662, 663, 664, 665, 666, 667, 668, 669, 670, 671, 672, 673, 674, 675, 676, 677, 678, 679, 680, 681, 682, 683, 684, 685, 686, 687, 688, 689, 690, 691, 692, 693, 694, 695, 696, 697, 698, 699, 700, 701, 702, 703, 704, 705, 706, 707, 708, 709, 710, 711, 712, 713, 714, 715, 716, 717, 718, 719, 720, 721, 722, 723, 724, 725, 726, 727, 728, 729, 730, 731, 732, 733, 734, 735, 736, 737, 738, 739, 740, 741, 742, 743, 744, 745, 746, 747, 748, 749, 750, 751, 752, 753, 754, 755, 756, 757, 758, 759, 760, 761, 762, 763, 764, 765, 766, 767, 768, 769, 770, 771, 772, 773, 774, 775, 776, 777, 778, 779, 780, 781, 782, 783, 784, 785, 786, 787, 788, 789, 790, 791, 792, 793, 794, 795, 796, 797, 798, 799, 800, 801, 802, 803, 804, 805, 806, 807, 808, 809, 810, 811, 812, 813, 814, 815, 816, 817, 818, 819, 820, 821, 822, 823, 824, 825, 826, 827, 828, 829, 830, 831, 832, 833, 834, 835, 836, 837, 838, 839, 840, 841, 842, 843, 844, 845, 846, 847, 848, 849, 850, 851, 852, 853, 854, 855, 856, 857, 858, 859, 860, 861, 862, 863, 864, 865, 866, 867, 868, 869, 870, 871, 872, 873, 874, 875, 876, 877, 878, 879, 880, 881, 882, 883, 884, 885, 886, 887, 888, 889, 890, 891, 892, 893, 894, 895, 896, 897, 898, 899, 900, 901, 902, 903, 904, 905, 906, 907, 908, 909, 910, 911, 912, 913, 914, 915, 916, 917, 918, 919, 920, 921, 922, 923, 924, 925, 926, 927, 928, 929, 930, 931, 932, 933, 934, 935, 936, 937, 938, 939, 940, 941, 942, 943, 944, 945, 946, 947, 948, 949, 950, 951, 952, 953, 954, 955, 956, 957, 958, 959, 960, 961, 962, 963, 964, 965, 966, 967, 968, 969, 970, 971, 972, 973, 974, 975, 976, 977, 978, 979, 980, 981, 982, 983, 984, 985, 986, 987, 988, 989, 990, 991, 992, 993, 994, 995, 996, 997, 998, 999, 1000, 1001, 1002, 1003, 1004, 1005, 1006, 1007, 1008, 1009, 1010, 1011, 1012, 1013, 1014, 1015, 1016, 1017, 1018, 1019, 1020, 1021, 1022, 1023, 1024, 1025, 1026, 1027, 1028, 1029, 1030, 1031, 1032, 1033, 1034, 1035, 1036, 1037, 1038, 1039, 1040, 1041, 1042, 1043, 1044, 1045, 1046, 1047, 1048, 1049, 1050, 1051, 1052, 1053, 1054, 1055, 1056, 1057, 1058, 1059, 1060, 1061, 1062, 1063, 1064, 1065, 1066, 1067, 1068, 1069, 1070, 1071, 1072, 1073, 1074, 1075, 1076, 1077, 1078, 1079, 1080, 1081, 1082, 1083, 1084, 1085, 1086, 1087, 1088, 1089, 1090, 1091, 1092, 1093, 1094, 1095, 1096, 1097, 1098, 1099, 1100, 1101, 1102, 1103, 1104, 1105, 1106, 1107, 1108, 1109, 1110, 1111, 1112, 1113, 1114, 1115, 1116, 1117, 1118, 1119, 1120, 1121, 1122, 1123, 1124, 1125, 1126, 1127, 1128, 1129, 1130, 1131, 1132, 1133, 1134, 1135, 1136, 1137, 1138, 1139, 1140, 1141, 1142, 1143, 1144, 1145, 1146, 1147, 1148, 1149, 1150, 1151, 1152, 1153, 1154, 1155, 1156, 1157, 1158, 1159, 1160, 1161, 1162, 1163, 1164, 1165, 1166, 1167, 1168, 1169, 1170, 1171, 1172, 1173, 1174, 1175, 1176, 1177, 1178, 1179, 1180, 1181, 1182, 1183, 1184, 1185, 1186, 1187, 1188, 1189, 1190, 1191, 1192, 1193, 1194, 1195, 1196, 1197, 1198, 1199, 1200, 1201, 1202, 1203, 1204, 1205, 1206, 1207, 1208, 1209, 1210, 1211, 1212, 1213, 1214, 1215, 1216, 1217, 1218, 1219, 1220, 1221, 1222, 1223, 1224, 1225, 1226, 1227, 1228, 1229, 1230, 1231, 1232, 1233, 1234, 1235, 1236, 1237, 1238, 1239, 1240, 1241, 1242, 1243, 1244, 1245, 1246, 1247, 1248, 1249, 1250, 1251, 1252, 1253, 1254, 1255, 1256, 1257, 1258, 1259, 1260, 1261, 1262, 1263, 1264, 1265, 1266, 1267, 1268, 1269, 1270, 1271, 1272, 1273, 1274, 1275, 1276, 1277, 1278, 1279, 1280, 1281, 1282, 1283, 1284, 1285, 1286, 1287, 1288, 1289, 1290, 1291, 1292, 1293, 1294, 1295, 1296, 1297, 1298, 1299, 1300, 1301, 1302, 1303, 1304, 1305, 1306, 1307, 1308, 1309, 1310, 1311, 1312, 1313, 1314, 1315, 1316, 1317, 1318, 1319, 1320, 1321, 1322, 1323, 1324, 1325, 1326, 1327, 1328, 1329, 1330, 1331, 1332, 1333, 1334, 1335, 1336, 1337, 1338, 1339, 1340, 1341, 1342, 1343, 1344, 1345, 1346, 1347, 1348, 1349, 1350, 1351, 1352, 1353, 1354, 1355, 1356, 1357, 1358, 1359, 1360, 1361, 1362, 1363, 1364, 1365, 1366, 1367, 1368, 1369, 1370, 1371, 1372, 1373, 1374, 1375, 1376, 1377, 1378, 1379, 1380, 1381, 1382, 1383, 1384, 1385, 1386, 1387, 1388, 1389, 1390, 1391, 1392, 1393, 1394, 1395, 1396, 1397, 1398, 1399, 1400, 1401, 1402, 1403, 1404, 1405, 1406, 1407, 1408, 1409, 1410, 1411, 1412, 1413, 1414, 1415, 1416, 1417, 1418, 1419, 1420, 1421, 1422, 1423, 1424, 1425, 1426, 1427, 1428, 1429, 1430, 1431, 1432, 1433, 1434, 1435, 1436, 1437, 1438, 1439, 1440, 1441, 1442, 1443, 1444, 1445, 1446, 1447, 1448, 1449, 1450, 1451, 1452, 1453, 1454, 1455, 1456, 1457, 1458, 1459, 1460, 1461, 1462, 1463, 1464, 1465, 1466, 1467, 1468, 1469, 1470, 1471, 1472, 1473, 1474, 1475, 1476, 1477, 1478, 1479, 1480, 1481, 1482, 1483, 1484, 1485, 1486, 1487, 1488, 1489, 1490, 1491, 1492, 1493, 1494, 1495, 1496, 1497, 1498, 1499, 1500, 1501, 1502, 1503, 1504, 1505, 1506, 1507, 1508, 1509, 1510, 1511, 1512, 1513, 1514, 1515, 1516, 1517, 1518, 1519, 1520, 1521, 1522, 1523, 1524, 1525, 1526, 1527, 1528, 1529, 1530, 1531, 1532, 1533, 1534, 1535, 1536, 1537, 1538, 1539, 1540, 1541, 1542, 1543, 1544, 1545, 1546, 1547, 1548, 1549, 1550, 1551, 1552, 1553, 1554, 1555, 1556, 1557, 1558, 1559, 1560, 15



नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री



रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली



₹2,500
प्रतिमाह

जरूरतमंद बहनों के फ़ोन पर बजने वाला है
खुशियों का नोटिफिकेशन



26 अगस्त, 2026 | तालकटोरा स्टेडियम, नई दिल्ली

मुख्य अतिथि

सरदार तरनजीत सिंह संधू

माननीय उपराज्यपाल, दिल्ली

श्री हर्ष मल्होत्रा

माननीय केंद्रीय राज्य मंत्री सड़क एवं परिवहन, भारत सरकार

अध्यक्षता

श्रीमती रेखा गुप्ता

माननीय मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

महिला एवं बाल विकास विभाग, राष्ट्रीय राजधानी क्षेत्र, दिल्ली सरकार



Root causes

India's youth crisis is about the absence of jobs, not just examination reform

It has been a few weeks since the youth agitation forced the resignation of then Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. The government conceded the students' demands for examination reform, which found an echo in the Prime Minister's Independence Day address, when he announced free online coaching for competitive examinations using India's digital public infrastructure. MoSPT's survey data bears out why this would be welcome to students – private coaching costs 16% of what an Indian family spends on a child's education, against 12.5% in 2018, and nearly a quarter of that budget by the higher secondary years which is when the student prepares for competitive exams. Cheaper coaching is of limited value as quality professional education remains confined to a handful of institutions. For instance, over 22 lakh candidates appeared in this year's medical entrance exam for about 14 lakh undergraduate seats with fewer than 10,000 of them at the top 50 colleges. The situation is similar to the Joint Entrance Examination for engineering colleges. That is perhaps why, for the first time since the All India Survey on Higher Education began in 2011, undergraduate enrolment fell by 93,322 in 2023-24, particularly among young men. The fall was the sharpest in Uttar Pradesh, where *The Hindu's* analysis found undergraduate enrolment down 1.53 lakh even as diploma enrolment rose 1.38 lakh. An analysis of Periodic Labour Force Survey unit-level data found that of every 100 graduates aged 15 to 29 in 2025, only 26 were in regular salaried employment, and just four had a salaried job with a contract and social security. The youth employment crisis therefore has two ends – in the preparation for jobs, and in jobs themselves. Mere free coaching would address neither.

The structural problems in the Indian economy, despite the government's touting of 6%-6.5% growth, are now too obvious to ignore. Manufacturing, the job sector best placed to absorb India's college graduates, remains at about a sixth of gross value added, nowhere near the quarter of the economy the government has long promised. Meanwhile, the private sector has been retreating from its task as corporate investment has fallen from 17.3% of GDP in 2007-08 to 10.3% in 2024-25, unmoored by the cut in corporate tax from 30% to 22% in 2019. The steps required of the Union government are clear: public investment in industrial capacity, support for industry disciplined by export performance rather than domestic protection, and tempering a regulatory and enforcement zeal that seems to selectively target enterprises, affecting the jobs-catering medium-sized companies in particular. This route has a better chance of delivering jobs for the youth at the scale needed and as countries such as Vietnam have shown.

Escape velocity

India's space sector must focus on reliability and regular launches

For much of the 20th century, a rocket tearing a white seam through the sky did for India roughly what football did for Argentina and Brazil. Nations shut out of the councils where economic and strategic weight was measured found, in a game of European origin, an arena where their poverty did not disqualify them. Mastery was open to anyone with nerve and skill. Space was other things but also India's football. A famished, newly independent republic that could barely feed itself nevertheless chose to gamble on rockets and atomic piles – an expensive bet on a future it could not yet see. In that era of a controlled economy and state broadcaster monopoly, a launcher rising was its own justification. The utility of its payload was secondary, in the eyes of the masses, to the veneration of technological competency. Today, rockets and satellites are no longer emblems; they are the plumbing of the information age, the ungainly scaffolding beneath navigation, banking, weather and war. On the third Space Day – the anniversary of Chandrayaan-3's touchdown in the lunar south polar region – Prime Minister Narendra Modi urged 20 space-startup founders to build an "aura" that would draw the world's talent to India. But that might be a wrong framing married to the old view of space. A private space sector cannot harvest success merely because its wares are called rockets and launch vehicles; the romance that carried the state programme will not carry a business.

A recent peer-reviewed analysis in *Economics Letters* by Alessio Terzi and Francesco Nicoli finds that it cost \$13,302 to loft a kilogram into low-earth orbit on an Indian rocket in 2025 – costlier than China (\$5,809), Japan, Russia, Europe and the United States (\$3,225), and well above the global average of \$3,868. That is because India launches too rarely and uneconomically to rapidly build the required reputation for reliability. There were only five launches in 2025, against the 30 that were projected. The consequence is visible. GSAT-N2, at 4,700 kg too heavy for ISRO's LVM-3, went up on a Falcon 9; Pixxel and Dignatara – two of the 20 at Mr. Modi's meeting – rode SpaceX to orbit. SpaceX alone put three-quarters of the world's payload into orbit in 2025, underlining its near monopolistic stranglehold but also pointing to opportunities. The value of India's space sector can no longer rely on aura but in jobs, in long-term capital and the tax revenues that follow and, in heavy-lift launches that undercut SpaceX and China. Moon bases with NASA and interplanetary reveries belong to the new imagination of space, and they matter – but they are the ornament, not the engine.

End the culture of secrecy in judicial appointments

The debate over transparency in judicial appointments has resurfaced after Justice Ujjal Bhuyan of the Supreme Court of India recently observed that greater openness in the collegium process would strengthen public confidence and help ensure that merit remains the governing principle. Reformers argue that insulation from political interference was never meant to become insulation from constitutional accountability itself – a question that has remained unresolved for three decades.

The collegium is a judicial creation, not a constitutional one. The First Judges Case (1981) gave the executive primacy in appointments; the Second Judges Case (1993 4 SCC 441) shifted primacy to the collectively formed opinion of the Chief Justice of India and senior judges; the Third Judges Case (1998 7 SCC 739) expanded this into today's five-member collegium. The reasoning was sound, but close to three decades later, the process remains among the least transparent in any major constitutional democracy: no notification of vacancies, no eligibility matrix, no known methodology for assessing candidates. Even Fali Nariman, credited as an architect of the collegium, later turned critic, recalling that it was "not receptive at all" to the Bar. When the system's own architects concede that it answers to no one, reform can hardly be called interference.

Resolutions without reasons

One has the example of the collegium's own record on disclosure, which has moved backwards, not forwards – perhaps the clearest evidence of an institution retreating deeper into opacity. In October 2017, it began publishing resolutions with brief reasons for elevation, a step then hailed as a foundation for transparency.

That practice thinned steadily, and since November 28, 2024, resolutions have stopped naming which members took part in a decision or disclosing any reasoning at all. In November 2025, (then) Chief Justice of India (CJI) B.R. Gavai confirmed that the collegium had resolved to stop publishing detailed reasons altogether, citing concern that disclosure could harm the career prospects of candidates – a rationale that would equally justify withholding reasons from every rejected litigant.

This cannot be seen in isolation: the Court, in the MediaOne judgment (2023), held that sealed-cover secrecy is 'antithetical to a transparent and accountable system'. If that principle governs the court's own cases, why should a lesser standard govern its own?

This absence of due process has fuelled a recurring allegation: that opacity has allowed



Puhazh Gandhi P.

Lawyer and political analyst who writes on the Constitution, commerce and policies

The judiciary that demands transparency from every institution of governance cannot ask citizens to trust it on faith alone

relatives of sitting and retired judges – the so-called 'Uncle Judges' – an easier passage to the Bench than first-generation lawyers with no lineage to lean on. It is important to remember this is not a complaint from critics from outside alone: former CJI R.M. Lodha himself remarked that nearly one in three High Court judges could be an 'uncle'.

The allegation is not anecdotal: in 2018, the Union government flagged 11 of the 33 names recommended by the Allahabad High Court collegium, noting that they were relatives of sitting or retired judges. A broader assessment in 2025 found that nearly 30% of the Supreme Court judges – roughly 10 of 33 – had familial links to former judges. In January 2025, this issue pushed the collegium to consider barring judges' kith and kin from consideration altogether (the proposal was discussed and in principle it was agreed to have higher scrutiny if candidates are relatives, but legally a bar was not created). That, in itself, is an admission that without a publicly defined selection matrix, there is no objective way to distinguish a meritorious relative from a beneficiary of judicial lineage.

This is where the judiciary's own jurisprudence turns inward. Articles 14 and 16 guarantee equality and equal opportunity in public employment. In *Secretary, State of Karnataka and Others vs Umadevi* (2006 4 SCC 1), the Court held that appointments to public office cannot be made through backdoor methods and must ordinarily follow a transparent procedure open to eligible candidates. If constitutional equality demands openness in the recruitment of a clerk or an engineer, why should the highest constitutional offices remain exempt from comparable standards? To be sure, judicial appointments cannot be reduced to a competitive examination; qualities such as independence and temperament resist quantification. But, qualitative judgment does not require the total absence of procedure. It is prudent to note the irony: the Court itself held, in *CPIO vs Subhash Chandra Agarwal* (2019 3 SCC 1), that the CJI's office falls within the Right to Information Act – a logic never extended to how judges are appointed.

What other democracies do

Other constitutional democracies show that transparency and judicial independence can coexist. In the United Kingdom, the Judicial Appointments Commission publicly advertises vacancies and conducts structured interviews; in South Africa, the Judicial Service Commission invites nominations publicly and conducts televised interviews. None of these systems is

flawless, but each rests on a premise that India has yet to accept: independence is strengthened, not weakened, when citizens understand how judges are chosen.

India's collegium continues to operate as though it belongs to an earlier era of institutional deference. Political theorist Jürgen Habermas argued that democratic legitimacy ultimately rests on the public sphere – an arena where institutions must justify themselves before informed citizens.

This is not abstract: every judicial appointment is now dissected on social media within minutes. The scrutiny of a CJI's own remark comparing youngsters to 'cockroaches' travelled from placards at Jantar Mantar to trending hashtags within hours; it will not take long for such movements to arrive at the doorstep of the higher judiciary itself. Contempt jurisdiction, built for the newsroom and the courtroom gallery, cannot be used to trifle the scrutiny of this scale and anonymity – it is an alarm bell for a system that still keeps its own appointments behind closed doors and resists constructive criticism. Institutions that embrace reform voluntarily emerge stronger; those that resist witness a slow erosion of the legitimacy they seek to protect.

Reform, not retreat

None of this requires dismantling the collegium; it only requires modernising it. A transparent framework could publish anticipated vacancies in advance, invite applications from eligible advocates, disclose objective eligibility criteria, and record reasoned recommendations explaining why one candidate was preferred over another. Confidential inputs on integrity can remain protected – transparency does not demand disclosure of every file, only openness about the process, the criteria and the reasoning behind constitutional appointments.

This is ultimately not a contest between the judiciary and the executive, nor an attempt to weaken judicial independence. It is a question of whether one constitutional value is allowed to eclipse another. The Constitution promises an independent judiciary, but, equally, promises equality, fairness and reasoned

decision-making; values that are complementary, not adversarial. The debate of the 1990s was executive versus judiciary. The debate of this decade is opacity versus transparency. Therefore, unless the collegium accepts that independence without accountability breeds the very distrust it was designed to prevent, this asymmetry between what the judiciary demands of every other institution and what it permits of itself will continue to exist.

The limits of air power, implications for theatre-isation

The wars in Ukraine and Iran delivered the same verdict to every air force. Ukraine kept the larger air force at bay, while in Iran, the skies were dominated by the opposing side, yet air superiority still failed to end the war. Both point to the same limitation of air power: it has not grown weaker, but it is no longer sufficient to win a war on its own.

That is the real stake in India's own debate: its Air Force has long favoured operational flexibility over fixed commands – an approach proven against Pakistan but untested against China.

Air power's limits exposed

Two wars and one wider pattern illustrate three ways in which air power falls short.

The first is the denial of airspace. What determined control of Ukraine's skies was not Russia's aircraft numbers, but Ukraine's networked air defence. This is what the United States Air Force's 2025 guidance concedes: contested low-level airspace is a problem that air superiority alone cannot solve. For India, this cuts both ways – integrated air defence could deny China control of the skies, or leave India exposed to the same risk in reverse.

The second is dominance of the air space. The allied air campaign against Iran is the clearest case of dominance without a decisive outcome. The allies had complete control of the skies, yet Tehran held firm. What they could see, they hit; what Iran hid, it survived. That should concern India, because what has worked against Pakistan may not hold against China. Pakistan lacks strategic depth and can be stressed quickly; China, given its military capacity, can absorb losses and continue fighting.

The third is the cost-arithmetic. This structurally favours the weaker force. A Shaded-type drone (Iran) costs roughly \$20,000 to \$50,000, while the interceptors can cost millions. India saw a version of this during Operation Sindoor (May 2025), when Pakistan's cheaper drones forced the use of costlier



Harinder Singh

Retired Lieutenant General who commanded the 1st Corps during the 2020 Ladakh crisis

India's flexible air strategy faces an uncertain test against China

interceptors. Against China, that arithmetic operates on a much larger scale, and India is not yet prepared for it.

These limits are already forcing a doctrinal rethink across most modern air forces. For India, the challenge is structural: the centralised model of the Indian Air Force (IAF), proven against Pakistan, remains untested against China, where the terrain could compound these limitations.

The IAF's case against theatre-isation

The IAF favours flexibility over fixed commands. Four tests decide whether that position holds against China too.

The first is the flexibility principle. The IAF's claim is that what has worked before will work again. Against Pakistan, it did – Balakot (2019) and Sindoor demonstrated that. Against China, however, the numbers are tighter: 460-520 combat aircraft against the People's Liberation Army Air Force's roughly 65 squadrons. The mountains make the challenge even greater, with fewer airbases and less room to redeploy. So the flexibility that defines the IAF's approach may not hold where it matters most.

The second is the integration deficit. If flexibility cannot close the gap, then jointness might. Two parts can help bridge this deficit. The first is joint-force generation, which has never been built sufficiently for the China front. The second is peacetime jointness, which requires no new hardware, only training and shared planning. Kargil exposed this gap in 1999; the Ladakh crisis in 2020 showed that it still persisted.

The third is more institutional, than operational. Two aspects matter. The resistance is more about career progression than doctrine. Also, ranks do not map evenly across the three services, leaving joint chains of command unsettled. Neither factor determines whether flexibility or jointness will actually work, although both matter. The United States made joint postings mandatory; not a career risk.

The fourth is consultative authority. The IAF's own proposal – a Joint Coordination Centre – depends on everyone agreeing, and a crisis leaves no time for that. A theatre command puts one person in charge, with the power to act. The U.S., China and Israel have each already made that choice – not proof that it guarantees success, but evidence that a consultative process has its limits.

Of the four questions here, only one concerns how the IAF fights. The rest concern how India organises itself for the next war. That decision lies beyond the IAF; it belongs to India's political leadership, which has a larger stake in the outcome.

The cost of delay

The IAF's position is defensible where it has been tested – in Balakot and Sindoor. What it does not tell us is how quickly the force could mobilise or how effectively it could conduct joint operations against China.

The cost of leaving this debate unresolved is real. If, for instance, China moves into Ladakh the same week that Siachen Glacier flares up, someone will have to decide, in real time, which front gets the limited pool of Rafales and S-400 systems.

A jointness gap left unaddressed for another decade could mean that an Integrated Battle Group (IBG) commander along the Line of Actual Control is still planning around air support that may not reliably arrive when needed to defend India's territorial integrity. And if that were to happen, people would not remember the missing theatre command, but a military that was simply not ready for war.

None of this is a case against the IAF. It is a case against testing the IAF's convictions in a crisis, when there may be no second chance. Therefore, one could argue that theatre-isation does not dilute the IAF's flexibility; rather, it is the missing structure that could allow that flexibility to survive contact with the one border crisis India has not faced in many decades.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

New airport, save wetlands

The decision of the Tamil Nadu government, under the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam, to look for a new airport site for Chennai, instead of Parandur, to protect agricultural lands and local livelihoods is a laudable attempt. In general, the State government should give priority to enacting a law for the protection of all identified wetlands, along with an effective policy for

their conservation. Urban land use, including railways, has increased considerably, encroaching mainly on agricultural lands, forests and grasslands. Many wetlands have been lost or impaired through draining, dredging, filling, excavation, construction and pollution. The protection of wetlands by discouraging urban development activities is therefore necessary. We consider everything to be

pervaded by a subtle divine presence, be it water bodies, birds and animals, flora, or the stars and planets. But very little attention is paid to protecting them. Utilising nature's gifts to mankind without causing harm is the only sensible approach. The conversion of agricultural lands and water bodies has caused considerable suffering.

A.J. Rangarajan,
Chennai

Use of term

It is right for women MLAs in Tamil Nadu to demand that the term 'Kanni Pechu' be dropped, but not

Corrections & Clarifications

In a 'Business' page report, "Top 5 big family businesses hold over 60% income" (August 16, 2026), the headline and first two paragraphs should have clarified and read: "A study of 25 wealthiest Indian family-run businesses over the financial years 2000-2020 revealed that the top five among them held over 60% of the cohort's combined revenues." A subsequent paragraph should have read: "The largest five firms within each NIC-3 industry controlled more than half of the revenues in around 74% of NIC-3 industries, the study found."

The Readers' Editor's office can be contacted by Telephone: +91-44-28576300; E-mail: readerseditor@thehindu.co.in

because it is a 'gendered term that perpetuates patriarchal notions'. Rather, it is an inane Artificial Intelligence translation into

Tamil of the English term 'maiden speech'. I am sure Tamil experts can vouch that there has never been any patriarchal conspiracy in our history to invoke references to *kanni* or *pechu* to belittle women or to demean our representatives in people's assemblies.

Anandhi Narayanaswamy,
Chennai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

T.N. can lead India on revenue reform

Tamil Nadu's decision to establish a high-level Revenue Augmentation Committee could prove more important than simply finding additional resources for the State Budget. It offers Tamil Nadu an opportunity to do something no Indian State has yet systematically attempted: modernise the way revenue itself is defined and managed.

The committee, chaired by Montek Singh Ahluwalia, has been asked to recommend measures to strengthen own-tax and non-tax revenues, improve buoyancy, plug leakages, and increase fiscal self-reliance. Tamil Nadu has been one of India's stronger performers in economic growth and social development. Sustaining these achievements – and the public services and investment that underpin them – will require a sustainable revenue base.

Tamil Nadu used to be one of India's fiscally better-managed States. Its own-tax revenue reached 9.3% of Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) in 2002-03, after exceeding 10% in the early 1990s. Yet non-tax revenue has remained a weakness: only 7% of total revenue came from non-tax sources.

The 15th Finance Commission's work explained how the earlier advantage for own-tax revenue eroded. A study prepared for the Commission found own-tax revenue falling from close to 9% of GSDP in 2006-07 to 6.4% in 2016-17, with tax buoyancy below one in eight of the 14 years examined. More recently, Tamil Nadu's own-tax revenue was budgeted at around 6.2% of GSDP in 2024-25, compared with 6.9% in Karnataka and 8.2% in Telangana.

The committee will therefore address a structural problem. But before asking how Tamil Nadu can raise more revenue, it should ask a more fundamental question: what counts as government revenue?

Defining revenue

This distinction has become blurred in Indian public finance.



Anoop Singh

Distinguished Fellow, Centre for Social and Economic Progress (CSEP), former member of the 15th Finance Commission, and former Asia Pacific Director, International Monetary Fund

"Resource mobilisation" often encompasses taxes and user charges alongside borrowing, official loans, green and municipal bonds, blended finance, and asset monetisation. These may all provide resources, but they are economically very different.

The International Monetary Fund (IMF)'s Government Finance Statistics Manual (GFSM 2014) provides a clear framework. Government revenue consists of taxes, social contributions, grants and other revenue, including fees and charges, dividends, interest, royalties, and rents. Borrowing is different. A market loan or bond provides cash today while creating a financial liability. It is financing, but not revenue. Nor does selling an existing asset generally create revenue. It exchanges one asset for another. While recurring lease payments, royalties, concession fees, rents, and dividends may constitute as genuine non-tax revenue, proceeds from outright asset sales generally do not.

This matters because a government can appear to have mobilised substantial "resources" without improving its underlying capacity to finance public services. Borrowing and asset sales can finance investment or ease temporary financing constraints but they cannot permanently finance a structural gap between recurrent expenditure and revenue.

Tamil Nadu should therefore use this committee to become the first Indian State to explicitly adopt international standards for defining and presenting government revenue. This would complete an unfinished reform agenda. Fiscal deficit and financing measures need to be consistent with international practice, accompanied by fuller reporting of arrears, guarantees, off-bond borrowing, and public-enterprise finances. Otherwise, conventional cash accounts can give an incomplete picture of fiscal trends.

India's public financial management weaknesses are

concerned with not simply how much governments raise or spend, but how comprehensively fiscal transactions are defined, classified and reported. Indian States conventionally divide revenue into own-tax revenue, own non-tax revenue, shares in central taxes, and grants from the Centre. These accounts should increasingly be reconcilable with internationally accepted classifications.

Tamil Nadu need not abandon its existing system. It could publish a supplementary GFSM along with its Budget, separating revenue and transactions in assets and financing.

Sustainable revenue

Having defined revenue correctly, the committee should concentrate on raising it sustainably. The first priority should be better tax administration rather than simply higher rates. Linking GST information with registration, vehicle, property, and other administrative databases can reduce evasion and improve buoyancy without increasing the burden on compliant taxpayers.

Second, non-tax revenue deserves greater attention. User charges should be periodically reviewed against costs. Royalties, licence and concession fees, and rents and returns from public assets should similarly be reviewed. State-owned enterprises should generate predictable returns through better governance and transparent dividend policies – not exceptional dividends to fill annual budget gaps.

The inherited lesson is clear: borrowing to finance recurrent expenditure raises debt, interest burdens, and reduces fiscal space for development. Revenue reform cannot therefore be separated from expenditure efficiency, liabilities and fiscal risks.

Thus, Tamil Nadu, by becoming the first Indian State to adopt international standards for defining and presenting government revenue, could establish a benchmark for other States and the Union government.

The recruitment controversy in Andhra

The competitive accounting of examination scandals may not appeal to Gen Z

STATE OF PLAY

P. Sujatha Varma

The success of the student-led protest at Jantar Mantar has altered the political vocabulary of the moment. Examinations, paper leaks, recruitment, and the anxieties of an entire generation have suddenly moved from the margins of public discourse to its centre. Andhra Pradesh too is now witnessing its own version of this churn.

Two recruitment controversies, the 'Mega' District Selection Committee (DSC)-2025 teacher recruitment and the Andhra Pradesh Public Service Commission (APSPSC) Group-I 2018 examination, have become competing political narratives. However, the candidates themselves are less interested in which party gains political mileage and more concerned about knowing if the system is/was fair. That question is bigger than both the ruling Telugu Desam Party (TDP) and the main Opposition party, the YSR Congress (YSRCP).

Through the Mega DSC-2025, the government notified 16,347 teacher posts, attracting more than 5.7 lakh applications. The exams were conducted between June 6 and July 2, 2025. Eventually, 15,941 candidates received appointment orders, leaving 406 posts vacant for want of eligible candidates in respective categories. The government has maintained that the recruitment followed the notified rules, reservation rosters and government orders. Senior education department officials also pointed out that despite hundreds of legal challenges, no court stayed the examination or held that the recruitment process as a whole



violated prescribed norms.

Tit-for-tat exam scandals

However, the controversy has not emerged from thin air. The High Court has been repeatedly approached over various aspects of the recruitment. As of August 2026, the court was told that 335 petitions had been filed, with 69 related to the sports quota.

The YSRCP has sought to turn the DSC controversy into a broader youth mobilisation campaign, trying to appeal to the anxieties of the Gen Z youth. It has alleged irregularities in the recruitment process and has demanded accountability from Education Minister Nara Lokesh.

Among the issues raised by the Opposition is the decision to entrust a single institutional set-up with both question-bank preparation and the conduct of the DSC examinations. The case of P. Naveen, an out-sourced employee of the State Council of Educational Research and Training, whose name figured in the first merit list before disappearing from the revised list, also became a political flashpoint. His initial inclusion in the merit list led to allegations that persons associated with the examination system could have had access to question banks.

The sports-quota controversy has added another layer. The coalition government had issued orders enhancing reservation for meritorious sportspersons to 3%, providing horizontal reservation in

direct recruitment without a competitive examination. The subsequent restoration of the mandatory exam, after the recruitment process had progressed, drew sharp criticism. The Opposition has also alleged inaction against those involved in attempts to trade teacher posts.

Meanwhile, the TDP and its allies have responded by bringing up the Group-I 2018 recruitment controversy. A notification, issued in 2018, to fill 169 Group-I posts, became embroiled in litigation over the evaluation of the mains examination. A single judge in March 2024, when the YSR Congress was in power, held that the second and third valuations of the Group-I mains papers were illegal and directed the mains examination be conducted afresh.

But governance cannot be reduced to competitive accounting. If DSC candidates have legitimate grievances, they deserve answers, irrespective of which government conducted the recruitment. Similarly, if Group-I candidates were subjected to an unfair evaluation process, they too deserve justice.

Attempts to politically link the two controversies may prove counterproductive. The youth may be angry, but they are also watching whether political parties are genuinely standing with their concerns or merely attempting to appropriate their anger.

The political class may continue to fight the DSC and Group-I battles in courtrooms and Assembly debates. But the more consequential battle is taking place in the minds of thousands of young people deciding whether the next government recruitment notification is worth believing in.

pothuri.varma@thehindu.co.in

Karnataka's draft SIR rolls reveal alarming levels of deletion

Not only is the State witnessing high levels of deletions in urban constituencies, the website of the CEO has made searching deletions list tedious

DATA POINT

Pon Vasanth B.A.
Rishita Khanna
Nitika Francis

The draft electoral rolls released after the completion of the enumeration phase of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) has revealed alarming levels of deletions, unprecedented when compared with other major States that saw high deletions during the enumeration phase.

With the deletion of 1.08 crore names from the rolls, the State, with 224 Assembly Constituencies (ACs), saw its electoral rolls shrinking by 19.5% from 5.13 crore to 4.46 crore – which is the removal of roughly one in every five voters who were there on the rolls before the SIR. Though this was the second highest rate of deletions among major States, with Telangana witnessing the highest at 21.7% deletions, constituency-wise analysis shows more worrying patterns in Karnataka.

The Election Commission of India (EC) has not released the electors to population in the 18+ age group (EP) ratio for any States during the SIR, which is mandatory during every electoral roll revision. The EP ratio gives an indication of under-enrolment or over-enrolment. While the EC has cited absence of Census data as the reason for not releasing EP ratio, many have raised concerns that the SIR is being undertaken with no estimation of the number of voters who should be there on the rolls.

Table 1 compares the population eligible to vote, taken from the report of the Union government's Technical Group on Population Projections, with electors before and after the SIR in major States. Karnataka's draft SIR roll is at least 67 lakh short of the estimated population eligible to vote. It is uncertain if this gap could be bridged to at least a reasonable extent, considering that roughly 44 lakh voters

in the draft rolls are likely to be served notices for discrepancies.

The map shows where the deletions are concentrated. Five constituencies – Bommanahalli (54.8%), Dasarahalli (52.1%), B.T.M Layout (51.6%), Vijayanagar (51.1%), and C.V. Raman Nagar (51.1%) – saw more than half of their electoral rolls getting culled. This is perhaps the first time in any of the major States where ACs have seen more than 50% deletions during the enumeration phase of the SIR. All five were in the core Bengaluru area. Fifty per cent of the 1.08 crore deletions came from just 36 of the 224 ACs, of which 28 were in the core Bengaluru area.

Deletions were highly concentrated in most urban constituencies, in line with the pattern seen in other States. Twenty nine highly urbanised districts saw 41.5% deletions (Table 2). However, that stands out in Karnataka, was the high share of voters getting deleted under the 'Shifted' category, even in highly rural areas.

Despite such high deletions, Karnataka, worryingly, appears to be the least transparent. The website of the Chief Electoral Officer has not hosted the list of deleted voters in a searchable format as done in all other States. Instead, the lists were hosted in different Google drive links with the booth-wise documents available only in English. The documents do not carry old booth numbers, which make it difficult for voters to search them.

Karnataka CEO V. Anbu Kumar told *The Hindu* that the office is in the process of adding the old booth numbers. When asked about the poor maintenance of the website, the CEO's office said it would look into the issue. Meanwhile, unlike in other States where gender-wise details were made available, Karnataka has not released gender-wise data on deletions from the draft rolls, leaving it unclear how many women or men have been left out. The CEO said the office did not have the data.

Sledgehammer approach?

The urban-rural break-up of the SIR deletions was made possible thanks to night-light data in the SHRUG database provided by Development Data Lab. Further classification of the values was done by The Hindu Data team



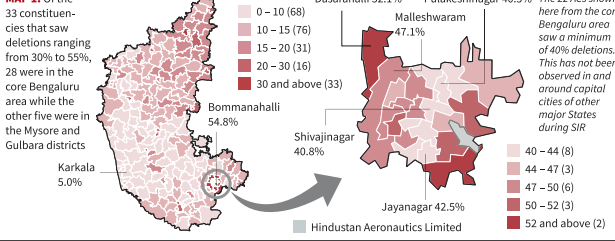
TABLE 1: Electors in every major State fell short of the estimated population eligible to vote. *Telangana and Karnataka's differences are as per draft SIR rolls

State	Projected 18+ population in 2026 (A)	Electors in draft SIR roll (B)	Electors in final SIR roll (C)	Difference (C)-(A)
Telangana	2.89 cr	2.65 cr	-	24 lakh*
Uttar Pradesh	15.73 cr	12.56 cr	13.4 cr	2.33 cr
Tamil Nadu	5.93 cr	5.44 cr	5.67 cr	26 lakh
Gujarat	5.22 cr	4.35 cr	4.4 cr	82 lakh
Chhattisgarh	2.09 cr	1.85 cr	1.87 cr	22 lakh
Keralam	2.73 cr	2.54 cr	2.7 cr	3 lakh
Bihar	8.01 cr	7.24 cr	7.42 cr	59 lakh
Rajasthan	5.51 cr	5.05 cr	5.15 cr	36 lakh
West Bengal	7.58 cr	7.08 cr	7.05 cr	53 lakh
Madhya Pradesh	5.84 cr	5.31 cr	5.4 cr	44 lakh
Karnataka	5.13 cr	4.46 cr	-	67 lakh*

TABLE 2: Even rural constituencies in Karnataka saw high share of voters deleted with reason marked as 'Shifted' or 'Absent'

Measure	Highly Rural	Moderately Rural	Moderately Urban	Highly Urban	Karnataka
No of ACs	43	124	28	29	224
Pre-SIR share in electorate (%)	17.3	50.5	14.0	18.1	100
Share in electorate, draft SIR (%)	19.1	55.1	13.3	12.5	100
Deletions	10,86,245	34,05,944	18,23,144	44,81,082	1,07,96,415
Share in total deletions (%)	10.1	31.5	16.9	41.5	100
% of electors deleted	11.3	12.2	23.5	44.6	19.5
- shifted (%)	55.7	54.9	58.2	67.2	60.6
- absent (%)	6.8	9.2	19.6	17.2	14.1
- death (%)	26	23.3	13	7.3	15.2
- duplicate and others (%)	11.5	12.6	9.2	8.3	10.2

MAP 1: Of the 33 constituencies that saw deletions ranging from 30% to 55%, 28 were in the core Bengaluru area while the other five were in the Mysore and Gulbarga districts



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu

FIFTY YEARS AGO AUGUST 26, 1976

WHO to collaborate in Ayurvedic project

New Delhi, August 23: The growing interest of World Health Organisation in traditional medicines has taken a concrete shape in a collaborative research project on Ayurvedic treatment for rheumatism proposed to be carried out in Coimbatore.

The WHO Regional Director for South-East Asia, Dr. V.T.H. Gunaratne, had stated at the meeting of the WHO Regional Advisory Committee on Medical Research here recently that the wealth of traditional medicine in the countries of the region should not be neglected. He wanted research into this indigenous source to be stimulated to improve the health of the people and disclosed that a joint team of WHO and Indian Council of Medical Research had recently visited the Ayurvedic Trust at Coimbatore to explore the feasibility of conducting joint research on rheumatism.

Enquiries show that Dr. P. Dishes of WHO and Dr. V.N. Rao of ICMR who had visited Coimbatore in this context are now drawing up the details of the proposed project in which ICMR, WHO and the Ayurvedic Trust will collaborate.

The main object of the project is to evaluate scientifically the claims made in favour of Ayurvedic cure for different kinds of rheumatic diseases and follow it up with studies to find out the basic principles on which the curative drugs act.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO AUGUST 26, 1926

World's altitude record

Paris, August 25: The world's altitude record has been beaten by a French Airman Callize, who ascended a height of over seven and three-quarter miles. Callize had been training for many weeks acclimatising his body to rapid rarefaction of air in diving bell, but, largely owing to fatigue, he descended too quickly and was immediately seized with terrible pains and removed to the hospital. Altogether, he was in the air for two and three-quarter hours. The difficulty of the flight is shown by the fact that he took over twenty minutes to ascend the last three hundred yards. The thermometer in the aeroplane at the extreme point of the flight registered ninety degrees of frost (Fahrenheit). The Airman was equipped with oxygen.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Fines levied on TikTok by Brazil over child data management

30 in \$ million. Brazil's National Data Protection Agency (ANPD) said Tuesday that it had imposed a fine of nearly \$30 million on TikTok for "irregularities in processing data belonging to children and adolescents". In addition to the fine of 153.7 million reais (\$29.9 million), the agency ordered parent company ByteDance to "delete the data company collected in violation of regulations". AFP

Transaction value of UPI payments in FY26

314 in ₹ lakh crore. The Unified Payments Interface (UPI), launched on August 25, 2016, has transformed India's digital payments landscape, with transaction value surging from ₹ 0.07 lakh crore in FY17 to around ₹ 314 lakh crore in FY26. Experts feel that UPI has emerged as one of the most successful pillars of India's Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI). PTI

Number of HINI cases among influenza infections in Delhi

2,300 Delhi Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh on Tuesday said that Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has called for an emergency review meeting amid a rise in influenza cases in the national capital. Mr. Singh said that Delhi has reported around 3,000 influenza cases this year, which included 2,308 HINI infections. PTI

Migrants rescued by Greek coastguard from two boats off Crete

85 The Greek coastguard on Tuesday rescued 85 migrants from two boats in trouble off Crete, the ANA news agency reported. Hundreds of people trying to reach Europe have been pulled out of the sea off the island in recent days. The two rubber dinghies were spotted by a drone and the coast guard vessel rushed to the area, ANA quoted the coast guard as saying. AFP

Complaint by Hungary over COVID-19 ventilator deal 'fraud'

965 in \$ million. Hungary's Foreign Ministry has filed a criminal complaint with prosecutors over what it says was possible fraud related to the previous government's purchase of ventilators worth some USD 965 million during the COVID-19 pandemic, Foreign Minister Anita Orbán said Tuesday. AP

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

Follow us [facebook.com/thehindu](https://www.facebook.com/thehindu) [X.com/the_hindu](https://www.x.com/the_hindu) [instagram.com/the_hindu](https://www.instagram.com/the_hindu)

Youth vote and its electoral impact

The byelection results in Bankipur and Daita, where the BJP lost, as well as the Jantar Mantar protests, have drawn considerable attention to the youth vote. In light of these developments, it may be appropriate to examine how young people have behaved politically over the past decade.

FULL CONTEXT

Sanjay Kumar
Krishangi Sinha

The Jantar Mantar protest of the young people, led by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) has drawn considerable attention to the role that those popularly referred to as "Gen Z" will play in the future. With elections due in seven States next year, including Uttar Pradesh, Punjab and Gujarat, there is much discussion about how the politically active Gen Z could impact the electoral outcomes in these States.

The byelection results in Bankipur and Daita, where the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) lost, have drawn considerable attention to the youth vote. Many believe the BJP's defeat in the Bankipur Assembly seat in Bihar, otherwise a stronghold of the party, was largely due to young voters turning their backs on the BJP. We are not sure how much support the BJP may have lost among young voters in Bankipur, but it is true that there is some visible unease among the youth in India. It may not be incorrect to bring the youth into the discussion, though it may be too early to conclude that they can upset the calculations of ruling parties in many States.

In light of these developments, it may be appropriate to examine how young people have behaved politically over the past decade. Data from various Lokniti-CSDS surveys can help identify patterns in turnout, their party preferences, and whether they have consistently backed the winning party or influenced political change in the country.

Youth voter participation patterns
The survey data clearly indicates that young people did not participate in the 2024 Lok Sabha election in very large numbers, though there were State-wise variations. Turnout among the youngest age group (18-21 years) was about 6 percentage points lower than the average, while turnout among those aged 22-25 years was higher, at 68%. State-level turnout based on Assembly elections also shows considerable variation. In Bihar, only 41% of 18-21-year-olds turned out to vote, compared with an overall turnout of 67.3%. Uttar Pradesh showed a similar gap, with turnout among the youngest voters at 51%, against an average turnout of 61.1%.

The pattern was reversed in several other States. In Madhya Pradesh, turnout among the 18-21-year-olds was 89%, well above the State's overall turnout of 75.6%. Punjab and Gujarat too recorded higher participation among the youngest voters than among the electorate overall, at 77% and 78%, respectively. West Bengal and Tamil Nadu recorded particularly high youth participation, at 93% and 90%, respectively, among 18-21-year-olds. Among 22-25-year-olds, turnout reached 95% in West Bengal and 95% in Assam.

There is, therefore, no single pattern of youth participation across India. Young voters can be among the least active sections of the electorate in one State and among the most active in another. Even within the youth category, participation varies with age. Their electoral engagement appears closely connected to the political and electoral context in which they vote.

Is there a single 'youth vote'?

There does not seem to be a single youth vote in Indian politics. West Bengal offers a striking example of how quickly youth

Electoral trends

Young voters are a dynamic part of India's electoral landscape. Participation varies sharply across States, while party preferences differ between States as well as age groups. Voting patterns can also change considerably from one election to the next.

Table 1: Youth voter turnout across States and age groups

State	Average Turnout	18-21 years	22-25 years
Lok Sabha election 2024	66.1	60	68
Assembly Elections			
Bihar (2025)	67.3	41	62
M.P. (2023)	75.6	89	70
Punjab (2022)	77.2	77	70
U.P. (2022)	61.1	51	62
Uttarakhand (2022)	65.4	49	56
Gujarat (2022)	64.8	78	65
Himachal (2022)	75.8	59	62
West Bengal (2026)	93.7	93	95
Tamil Nadu (2026)	90	90	88
Kerala (2026)	79.5	83	86
Assam (2026)	86.8	76	95

Note: All figures are in %. The State turnout is for the latest Assembly poll in that specific State.

Table 4: Party preferences of young voters in Uttar Pradesh, 2017 and 2022

Age Group	2022 Cong.	2022 BJP	2017 Cong.	2017 BJP
18 to 21 years	48	33	42	39
22 to 25 years	36	41	28	53
26 to 28 years	42	38	29	48
29 years and above	37	46	35	46

Table 6: Party preferences of young voters in Punjab, 2022 and 2017

Age Group	2022 Cong.	2022 BJP+	2017 Cong.	2017 BJP+
18 to 21	24	6	47	38
22 to 25	16	2	52	33
26 to 28	15	11	50	37
29 years & above	24	8	40	32

Table 8: Party preferences of young voters in Delhi, 2020 and 2015

Age Group	2020 Cong.	2020 BJP+	2015 Cong.	2015 BJP+
18 to 21	4	32	58	8
22 to 25	4	33	59	11
26 to 28	3	39	57	6
29 years & above	5	42	52	10

preferences can shift between elections. Between 2021 and 2026, there was a marked movement away from AITC+ (All India Trinamool Congress+) towards the BJP among younger voters.

In 2026, BJP support among 18-21-year-olds stood at 51%, compared with 33% for AITC+. Among 22-25-year-olds, the contest was closer, with BJP at 46% and AITC+ at 43%. This was a departure from 2021, when AITC+ led among both groups.

Uttar Pradesh presents a different picture. In 2022, though BJP registered a convincing victory, defeating the Samajwadi Party (SP), the SP was not far behind in terms of support amongst the young voter. The BJP+ received 44% among both 18-21-year-olds and 22-25-year-olds, while SP+ remained a significant competitor with 38% and 39%, respectively.

Together, these cases demonstrate that young voters can shift substantially between elections or display relatively stable preferences within an electoral contest. There is also variation within the youth category itself. The preferences of 18-21-year-olds are not always identical to those of 22-25-year-olds or 26-28-year-olds. The "youth vote" is therefore better understood as a set of age groups whose political choices may overlap but can also differ meaningfully.

Table 2: Party preferences of young voters in West Bengal, 2021 and 2026

Age Group	2026 AITC+	2026 BJP	2021 AITC+	2021 NDA
18 to 21 years	33	51	49	38
22 to 25 years	43	46	49	42
26 to 28 years	45	48	45	42
29 years and above	41	46	49	37

Table 3: Party preferences of young voters in Uttar Pradesh, 2017 and 2022

Age Group	2022 BJP+	2022 SP+	2017 NDA	2017 SP+
18 to 21 years	44	38	11	42
22 to 25 years	44	39	11	42
26 to 28 years	47	36	12	43
29 years and above	44	36	13	41

Note: All figures are in %. Others voted for different parties.

Table 5: Party preferences of young voters in Bihar, 2025 and 2020

Age Group	2025 NDA	2025 MGB	2020 NDA	2020 MGB
18 to 21 years	50	40	24	39
22 to 25 years	49	38	39	38
26 to 28 years	41	36	39	39
29 years and above	47	38	38	37

Table 7: Party preferences of young voters in Tamil Nadu, 2026 and 2021

Age Group	2026 DMK Alliance	2026 AIADMK Alliance	2021 DMK+	2021 AIADMK+
18 to 21	16	6	69	38
22 to 25	18	12	61	44
26 to 28	25	18	50	38
29 years & above	36	33	26	47

Table 9: Party preferences of young voters in Bihar, 2025 and 2020

Age Group	2025 NDA	2025 MGB	2020 NDA	2020 MGB
18 to 21 years	50	40	24	39
22 to 25 years	49	38	39	38
26 to 28 years	41	36	39	39
29 years and above	47	38	38	37

The Lokniti-CSDS data presents a youth electorate that is active, diverse and capable of changing direction.

Do young voters always vote for the winning party?

The answer is a clear no; the young voters do not always vote for the winning party/alliance. They may also side with the losing party as had been in the case of Uttar Pradesh and Bihar. In Uttar Pradesh, during the 2022 Assembly election, 48% of 18-21-year-olds voted for Congress, compared with 33% for BJP. More importantly, compared with 2017, the Congress gained among the youngest voters while BJP support declined. Among 18-21-year-olds, the Congress's vote share increased from 42% to 48%, while BJP's declined from 39% to 33%. Among 22-25-year-olds, the Congress's vote share increased from 28% to 36%, while the BJP's declined from 53% to 41%. Yet, the BJP went on to win the 2022 election, just as it had in 2017.

In Bihar, too, though the Mahagathbandhan (MGB) lost the 2020 Assembly polls, it got more support among the young voters compared to the NDA. Among 18-21-year-olds, the Mahagathbandhan received 39% of the

votes, compared with 24% for the NDA. By 2025, however, youth preferences had shifted, with NDA support among 18-21-year-olds increasing to 50%, compared with 40% for the Mahagathbandhan. The NDA also received more votes among 22-25-year-olds.

Driving political change

On some occasions, young voters have been instrumental in bringing about political change, as seen in the recent Tamil Nadu election and the Delhi Assembly elections of 2015 and 2020, as well as the Punjab Assembly election of 2022. Punjab's 2022 election offers a clear example. The Aam Aadmi party (AAP) emerged as the dominant choice among young voters. During the Punjab Assembly election, the AAP received 47% of the votes among 18-21-year-olds, compared with 24% for the Congress and 6% for the BJP. Among voters aged 22-25, the AAP's support increased to 52%.

The AAP's support among 18-21-year-olds was instrumental in defeating the Congress government in Punjab. AAP's support increased from 34% to 47%, while Congress declined from 38% to 24% between 2017 and 2022 Assembly elections. Among 22-25-year-olds, AAP support nearly doubled, rising from 27% to 52%.

Tamil Nadu presents an even sharper example in 2026. The TVK's appeal was heavily concentrated among younger voters, receiving 69% support among 18-21-year-olds and 61% among 22-25-year-olds. Its support then declined with increasing age, falling to 50% among 26-28-year-olds and 26% among voters aged 29 and above. The youngest voters, therefore, showed a particularly strong inclination towards a new political formation.

Delhi provides another example, but of a different kind. The AAP was the leading choice across age groups in both 2015 and 2020, with particularly strong support among younger voters. In 2020, the AAP received 58% of the votes among 18-21-year-olds and 59% among 22-25-year-olds, compared with 52% among voters aged 29 and above. BJP+'s support, by contrast, increased with the increase in the age of the voters.

The same broad pattern was visible in 2015. AAP's support was particularly strong among younger voters, while BJP+'s support was comparatively lower.

A dynamic electorate

The Lokniti-CSDS data presents a youth electorate that is active, diverse and capable of changing direction. Participation varies sharply across States. Party preferences differ not only between States but also between age groups. Voting patterns can change considerably from one election to the next, and young voters can sometimes move in a different direction from older sections of the electorate.

What emerges is not one uniform "youth vote", but a young electorate whose choices are shaped by the political context around them. Its importance lies not simply in how many young people vote, but in where they move, when they move and how strongly they move together. The youth vote is therefore less a fixed political bloc than a moving part of India's electoral landscape. It may be worth keeping an eye on how the young voters will behave politically in forthcoming Assembly elections. (Sanjay Kumar is the Professor and an Election Analyst. Krishangi Sinha is a Researcher with Lokniti-CSDS. Views expressed are personal.)

THE GIST

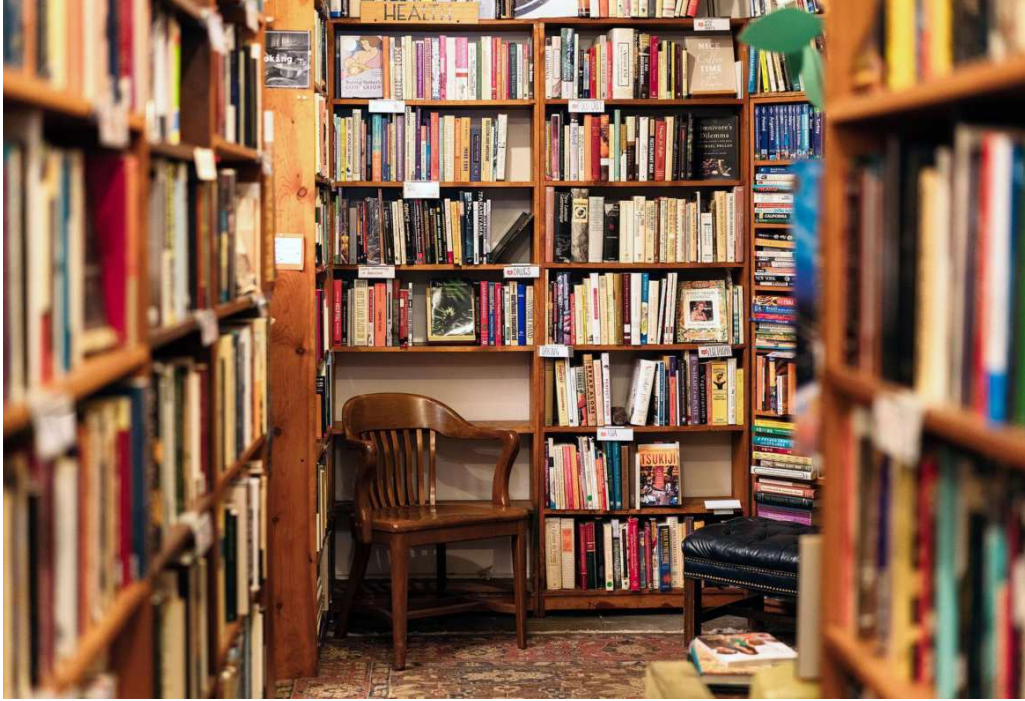
Young voters can be among the least active sections of the electorate in one State and among the most active in another. Their electoral engagement appears closely connected to the political and electoral context in which they vote.

On some occasions, young voters have been instrumental in bringing about political change, as seen in the recent Tamil Nadu election and the Delhi Assembly elections of 2015 and 2020, as well as the Punjab Assembly election of 2022.

The Lokniti-CSDS data presents a youth electorate that is active and diverse. Participation varies sharply across States and party preferences differ not only between States but also between age groups.

+

CACHE



A costly shortcut: In destructive scanning, a book's binding is cut off and its pages are rapidly scanned. These books cannot be easily rebound and are usually sent for disposal. GETTY IMAGES

How AI firms are destroying physical books to train their models

Amazon and Anthropic are facing the ire of booksellers and book lovers over reports that they destroyed books in order to scan them for AI development. The actions have sparked outrage and criticism, prompting a look into their legality

Sahana Venugopal

The story so far

An investigation published this week by the tech outlet *404 Media* tracked a shipment of rare books to an Amazon facility in Las Vegas. Instead of packing and mailing them out to eager readers, Amazon employees destroyed the books by cutting off their bindings to scan them. Numerous other books have met the same fate, according to the report that ignited global outrage and criticism.

Why are AI companies sourcing physical books?

AI companies are trying to access more works of writing in order to further develop their AI models and train them on high-quality datasets rich with original material. As more of the internet grows saturated with AI-generated patterns of language, rare and/or out-of-print books are becoming an attractive option for tech companies looking to scrape data.

According to *404 Media*, Amazon did not directly address its destructive scanning practices but confirmed that it bought books to improve its "products and services".

But the e-commerce giant is not the only company accused of destroying books.

Anthropic, the Google and Amazon-backed maker of the Claude

family of models, had its own secret 'Project Panama', which it described as "our effort to destructively scan all the books in the world."

What's more, a focus on rare books also means that the company that sources the content first can destroy the original and ensure that an AI rival cannot easily train its models on the same text.

Is it necessary for AI companies to destroy books?

If you have ever tried to photocopy a thick or old book, you know that getting a high-quality print is often complicated by the book's spine. You can press down hard to flatten the book, but this is not safe for rare or delicate volumes.

Archivists, librarians, and researchers use a range of advanced scanners that are designed to digitise physical books without damaging them. Some robotic devices can even lift or flip the pages without human help. Naturally, these solutions are expensive and can be hard to scale.

In destructive scanning, however, the book's binding is cut off and the pages are rapidly scanned. These books cannot be easily rebound and are usually sent for disposal.

Destroying the print book can also work in a company's favour. This way, it is harder for authors to accuse the company of promoting piracy. After all, a buyer is

legally allowed to destroy the rare book they have bought, even if others would consider this a cultural crime.

By contrast, an AI company can be sued if authors find evidence of it downloading pirated e-books without paying for them. This July, Anthropic received approval to pay \$1.5 billion to settle a class action lawsuit where authors claimed that the Claude-maker illegally used their copyrighted works for its AI products.

In a court order from last June, U.S. district judge William Alsup had noted that Anthropic bought millions of print copies, and "destroyed" each print copy while replacing it with a digital one that it did not share outside the company.

This print-to-digital format change was ruled as fair use.

What has been the reaction to destructive scanning?

Numerous booksellers, authors, creatives, collectors, readers, and academics have naturally reacted with anger and disgust to news reports of AI companies destroying books.

At the same time, there are some who are not overly concerned by destructive scanning, but oppose companies being allowed to destroy rare books to create a digital copy that the public cannot access.

For context, consider that media preservation platforms (such as the

Internet Archive) as well as shadow libraries/piracy platforms (like Anna's Archive) have been sued for doing the exact opposite: making digital versions of rare print books available to the public at no cost.

Meanwhile, global booksellers face a dilemma. They stand to profit (at least temporarily) by supplying rare or out-of-print books for destruction. *The Guardian* reported that sellers in Australia, for example, are more carefully scrutinising bulk orders from buyers or reviewing unusual requests for rarer books, in case they are being bought for destructive scanning.

Elon Musk, whose AI company is developing the Grok family of models and tools, was quick to refute potential accusations of his company destroying rare books.

"I've asked the SpaceXAI team to preserve any rare books in a library and scan them the hard way vs. just cutting off the spine and scanning," he posted in July on his social media platform X, in response to a user expressing distress over the destructive scanning process.

Even so, the process of building AI models lacks transparency – by design. As AI firms transition from downloading popular books to shredding rare ones, readers and booksellers now fear the world is rapidly losing undiscovered works of literature.



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the meaning of "neck to neck"? (Mukul K. Ranjan, New Delhi) First of all, it's not "neck to neck", but "neck and neck". Although there is a tendency to say "neck to neck" within India, it is wrong to do so.

When you say that a particular race or contest between two participants was neck and neck, what you are implying is that it was very even or very close; either of the two participants could have won it.

The survey shows that the two political parties are running neck and neck.

At the two-mile mark, Mohan and Shyam were running neck and neck.

"Neck and neck" comes from the world of horse racing.

What is the meaning of "You scared the daylights out of me"? (Siva Prasad Viswanatha, Hyderabad)

This is an expression which is mostly used in informal contexts. When you "scare the daylights out of someone", you succeed in frightening the person quite badly. Remember the James Bond movie, *Living Daylights*? Well, it is also possible to say, "scare the living daylights out of someone". Here are a few examples.

The little boy scared the daylights out of his mother.

The bombing of the World Trade Center has scared the living daylights out of most Americans.

Vijay's Halloween mask scared the daylights out of Sadhana.

Other expressions which mean more or less the same thing are "frighten the daylights out of someone", "scare the wits out of someone", and "scare someone out of his wits".

Which sentence is correct? "The driver of the bus was expired in the accident" or "The driver of the bus expired in the accident"? (V. Murali Krishna Rao, Bhimavaram)

It is grammatically incorrect to say, "was expired". The first sentence is therefore definitely wrong. As far as the second sentence is concerned, well, usually in an accident, people "die"; they do not "expire". Therefore, it's better to say, "The driver died in the accident".

The word "expire" carries with it the sense that things came to an end gradually along expected lines. In an accident, things do not happen gradually; they happen suddenly, unexpectedly.

Is it wrong to say, "Protest against something"? (Smita Chandra, Lucknow)

No, it isn't. It is possible for one to "protest against" or "protest about" something. Here are a few examples.

We protested against the increase in student fees.

Prabhakar is always protesting about something.

The workers decided not to protest against the downsizing of the company.

Most of us were planning to protest about the increased workload.

In American English it is possible to "protest" something. For example:

We protested the increase in working hours.

The students protested the indiscriminate firing by the police.

The unions were protesting the war. *Published in The Hindu on October 2, 2001*

THE DAILY QUIZ

The U.S. Open begins on the Sunday immediately preceding the last Monday of August. Here is a quiz on the tournament

Sindhu Nagaraj

QUESTION 1

In which year was it held for the first time?

QUESTION 2

Out of the four, how many grand slam tournaments were not affected by cancellation due to World War I and World War II, nor interrupted by the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020?

QUESTION 3

The U.S. Open became the first Grand Slam tournament to award equal prize money to men and

women, with that year's singles champions. In which year did this happen?

QUESTION 4

In 2006, the U.S. Open introduced instant replay reviews of line calls, using the Hawk-Eye computer system. It was the first Grand Slam tournament to use the system. The Open felt the need to implement the system because of the controversial quarterfinal match at the 2004 U.S. Open between which players?

QUESTION 5

Who are the current men's singles and women's singles champions?



Visual question: Identify this U.S. Open record holder. What record has she held? WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Questions and answers to the previous day's daily quiz: 1. Before acting, a young Sean Connery had represented Scotland in a bodybuilding contest. Name the contest. **Ans: Mr. Universe**

2. This 1962 film introduced Sean Connery as James Bond to the world. **Ans: Dr. No**

3. Connery won his only competitive Oscar for playing a tough Chicago cop in this 1987 film. **Ans: The Untouchables**

4. Which cause did Connery campaign for consistently, from the 1990s devolution vote through the 2014 referendum? **Ans: Scottish independence**

5. The Man Who Would Be King (1975), starring Connery and Michael Caine, opens in British India and features and Indian actor in its cast. Name the Indian actor featured in the film. **Ans: Saeed Jaffrey**

Visual: A still from Connery's final live-action outing. Name the 2003 film and identify the acclaimed Indian actor on the left. **Ans: The League of Extraordinary Gentlemen; Naseeruddin Shah**

Early birds: Erfanally Oosmany| Haridas Pal| Dodo Jayaditya| Arun Kumar Singh| A.C. Vineeth Kumar

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

Word of the day

Mollify:

cause to be more favourably inclined

Synonyms: assuage, appease, placate

Usage: The leader met the protesters in an attempt to mollify them.

Pronunciation: newsth.live/mollify

International Phonetic Alphabet: /mɒlɪfaɪ/

CORRECTION: In the article: 'Did Press Note 3 relaxations help attract more FDI?' published in these columns on August 25, the FDI received by India over the last few months should read as ₹4,895 crore and not ₹4,895. The error is regretted.

From Page One

India, China discuss border delimitation

The Chinese Foreign Minister said at the start of the talks that besides resuming the SR talks last year, institutional mechanisms between the two countries were resuming and both sides have been "working hard to maintain peace and tranquillity in the border areas." At last year's talks, he noted both sides "reached a set of common understandings on delimitation, on border management, mechanism building and cross border cooperation." "Over the past year, our two sides have worked to deliver them on the ground and have made good progress," he said.

The Chinese statement said the two sides "reaffirmed their commitment to the 2005 Political Guiding Principles, and, in a spirit of mutual respect and mutual understanding, will leverage the Special Representatives' mechanism to pursue a fair, reasonable and mutually-acceptable package solution to the boundary question."

"I am happy over the past year our relationship has been steadily returning to normalcy," Mr. Doval said. According to the Chinese statement, Mr. Wang called for "gradually building a positive narrative on China-India boundary affairs, making dialogue, peace, consultation and cooperation the mainstream and injecting positive factors into the sound and stable development of bilateral relations".

Many hurt as police stop Bihar students' march

The escalation of the protests also came in the wake of controversial remarks made by BPSC Examination Controller Rajesh Kumar Singh on Monday while addressing a press conference in Patna. To a question regarding the protests by students, Mr. Singh had quoted the Hindi proverb "Hathi chale bazaar, kutta bhaunka hazar" (focused people should ignore irrelevant criticisms). Many students had assumed that Mr. Singh had referred to protesters as "dogs". Mr. Singh had since expressed regret, saying he had no intention to hurt anyone's feelings and that he was quoted out of context.

SC likely to form special Bench on OBC criteria

The SC's March II judgment laid down the law on how to interpret the income/wealth test component of the creamy layer exclusion framework for OBCs, for the purposes of reservations in public education and employment. The court specifically considered how the income test should be understood in the case of candidates whose parents are employed in jobs for which no equivalence with government posts has been established. In the absence of an established equivalence between the relevant posts, the income test, including salary income, was being applied to rule out OBC candidates whose parents are employed outside government service, while OBC candidates whose parents are government servants were being subjected to a test that did not include parental salary component. This could amount to "hostile discrimination", the court said. It directed the Centre to give effect to its interpretation of the income test by creating supernumerary posts for the petitioners, that is, OBC candidates excluded from the quota because they fell within the creamy layer solely because of the salaries of their parents employed in public sector undertakings or private sector, where no equivalence had been established with government service. The Centre argued that implementing the decision "may adversely affect the spirit and intention of the reservation policy". "The direction to create supernumerary posts addresses only the numerical problem of accommodation; it does not resolve these collateral consequences for seniority, promotion and cadre placement," it said. Less than a week ago, Additional Solicitor General Chetan Sharma had told the Principal Bench of the Central Administrative Tribunal that the Centre was implementing the March II decision. (With inputs from PTI)

U.S. sanctions 4 Indian firms over Iran imports

Mr. Bessent described the move as an unprecedented campaign to sever Iran's financial lifelines. Among the four "India-based companies" facing action is a customs broker identified as Portease Partners LLP and its partners Indriyasha Ashrafmiah Sheikh and Harish Ramachandra Rang. They facilitated the import of multiple shipments of Iranian petrochemical products, the State Department said in a press release on Monday.

Other Indian companies facing action are Sashvini Overseas Limited; PP Softtech Private Limited, along with its director Prashant Garg; and Prakrutees Infra Impex Private Limited. Mr. Sheikh, Mr. Rang and Mr. Garg are Indian nationals, according to the release.

These companies were put on a list for "knowingly engaging in a significant transaction for the purchase, acquisition, sale, transport, or marketing of petroleum or petroleum products from Iran," it said.

Lifeboat of sunken vessel found; China joins search

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR

Notwithstanding the considerable passage of time since the Panama-flagged bulk carrier, *MV Ocean Winner*, sunk in the Bay of Bengal and the slim chances of survival of its crew, search and rescue operations for the missing crew members have been intensified, with China joining the efforts.

There has been no trace of 22 of the 24 crew members of the vessel – 20 of them Chinese nationals, three Myanmarese and one Bangladeshi. Two sailors, both Chinese nationals, were rescued on August 22 after a distress call was received from the vessel. "Search and rescue efforts for the missing crew members have been further augmented in coordination with the Maritime Rescue Coordination Centre, Beijing. Additional Coast Guard assets and merchant vessels are being deployed and coordinated to intensify the search operation," the Indian Coast Guard (ICG) said in a statement on Tuesday.

"ICGS Varad located a lifeboat of *MV Ocean Winner* in the search area. A boarding team inspected the lifeboat. However, no survivors were found," the ICG said.

Manipur groups ask govt. to defer Census in State

They ask the Centre to address citizenship-related concerns before proceeding with the exercise; Centre must use 1951 Census data to identify 'original Indian citizens' in the State, the groups say

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

A delegation of Manipur civil society organisations (CSOs) has urged the Union Home Ministry to convene tripartite talks involving the Centre, the Manipur government, and representatives of different communities before proceeding with the Census, arguing that citizenship-related concerns must be addressed first to ensure the exercise is accepted across the State.

Leaders of a 14-member CSO platform, who have met Union Minister Kiren Rijiju, BJP president Nitin Nabin, and Home Ministry officials in Delhi over the past few days, said they want the Centre to postpone Census-related activities and initiate a dialogue process on the implementation of a National Register of Citizens (NRC)-type mechanism in Manipur. While they declined to disclose details of those discussions, they said they had been assured that their concerns were being considered.

"We have requested the Government of India to organise a table where all stakeholders can sit together and discuss the issue," delegation member Shanta Nahakpam said on Tuesday. "In the current situation, only the Centre can bring different communities together."



A Manipur delegation met Union Minister Kiren Rijiju, BJP president Nitin Nabin, and MHA officials in Delhi over the past few days.

holders can sit together and discuss the issue," delegation member Shanta Nahakpam said on Tuesday. "In the current situation, only the Centre can bring different communities together."

Citizenship concerns

The demand for tripartite talks comes amid opposition to the Census process by several Meitei organisations and a section of the Naga community in Manipur. These groups argue that carrying out the Census without first addressing concerns over illegal immigration and citizenship could affect future political representation, particularly in the context

of delimitation exercise. The delegation maintained that any citizenship verification exercise should use 1951 as the base year, arguing that the first post-Independence Census in Manipur was built on records prepared before the State's merger with the Indian Union in 1949. According to them, these records provide the most reliable basis for identifying "original Indian citizens" in the State.

Referring to Census figures from 1961 to 2011, they alleged that while some districts recorded a decline in the number of villages, others witnessed a sharp increase. Such changes warrant scrutiny,

they said. The groups linked these concerns to migration from Myanmar. They argued that after Manipur's traditional permit system was abolished after the merger with the Indian Union, there was no effective mechanism to document who entered the State and settled there.

"This is not about targeting any tribe or community. The process should give every individual the chance to prove citizenship through records and process," said Abhao Koton, another delegation member.

The groups also pointed to ongoing ethnic tensions and large-scale displacement in the State, arguing that current conditions are not conducive to a credible Census exercise.

The first phase of Population Census 2027, the House Listing and Housing Census (HLO), is scheduled from September 1 to 30, but training of enumerators has been halted amid protests. The self-enumeration portal, due to be launched on August 17, is also yet to become operational, with a State government official saying a decision from the Ministry is awaited.

Jaishankar holds talks with Russian counterpart

Press Trust of India
MOSCOW

External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar held wide-ranging talks with his Russian counterpart Sergey Lavrov, including bilateral cooperation, global challenges and multilateral issues.

The two Foreign Ministers also discussed the current situation surrounding Ukraine, Iran, and Afghanistan, state-run TASS news agency quoted the Russian Foreign Ministry as saying.

"A wide-ranging conversation this evening with FM Sergey Lavrov of Russia. Discussed our bilateral cooperation, regional hotspots, global challenges and multilateral issues," Mr. Jaishankar posted on X on Tuesday.

He arrived in Moscow on Sunday on a two-day visit to Russia. The visit comes ahead of Russian President Vladimir Putin's expected visit to New Delhi for the BRICS leaders' summit on September 12-13.

"The sides reiterated mutual commitment to continuing close coordination within the United Nations, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation, BRICS, and the Group of Twenty," the TASS report said. "The Ministers agreed to strengthen trust-based dialogue at all levels."

Identify, eliminate threats before they grow big: Shah

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Tuesday said India's security policy must be framed keeping in view emerging global challenges, including geopolitical instability, energy and resource insecurity, supply chain disruptions, rising radicalisation and cyber misinformation campaigns. He also urged security agencies to anticipate threats before they become major crises.

Mr. Shah said he had visited all land-border States over the past eight months and shared with them a document outlining a four-pronged border security strategy. Stating that the government aimed to make the country "infiltrator-free" in a short period, he said illegal immigrants posed threats to national security, economy and demographic balance. "This country is not a *dharma-shala* and only citizens of the country have the right to live here," he said.

Addressing the valedictory session of the Intelligence Bureau's National Security Strategy Conference' in New Delhi on Tuesday, @BISHOMEAFFAIRS/X



The Home Minister addresses a session of the IB's 'National Security Strategy Conference' in New Delhi on Tuesday. @BISHOMEAFFAIRS/X

gence Bureau's National Security Strategy Conference (NSSC), Mr. Shah said the forum should study trends over the next 15-20 years and identify potential security challenges and strategies to counter them. "We have to identify challenges in advance and destroy them before they

become major problems," he said, calling for the creation of an ecosystem capable of delivering a secure, infiltrator-free and narcotics-free India. Linking national security with the government's long-term development agenda, Mr. Shah said Prime Minister Narendra Modi's goal of making India a developed nation by 2047 could only be achieved with strong internal security. "If we want to become number one in every field, internal security will have to be strengthened further," he said.

The Home Minister said previous governments had failed to anticipate problems such as narcotics trafficking, Left-wing extremism and unrest in the Northeast before they be-

come acute, forcing the country to deal with their consequences for decades. He said the government had succeeded in overcoming challenges posed by the three major internal security hotspots, crediting State police forces, Central agencies and the Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) for the achievement.

Mr. Shah also asked State police forces to implement the Narcotics Control Vision Document 2026-2029 and work on the three pillars of "Detect, Disrupt and Destroy" to achieve the goal of a drug-free India. He said the fight against narcotics could be won only through coordinated action by the Union government and all State governments.

Mr. Shah also asked State police forces to implement the Narcotics Control Vision Document 2026-2029 and work on the three pillars of "Detect, Disrupt and Destroy" to achieve the goal of a drug-free India. He said the fight against narcotics could be won only through coordinated action by the Union government and all State governments.

New criminal laws

Mr. Shah said the three new criminal laws would be implemented fully within a year. Their implementation would enable criminal cases to be disposed of up to the Supreme Court level within three years and increase conviction rates by 25%, he claimed.

On counter-terrorism, the Home Minister called

Wearing hijab not established as 'essential religious practice' for women in Islam, says HC

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

The Allahabad High Court recently held that wearing a headscarf could not be established as an "essential religious practice" of Islam. The observation was made on a Muslim student's petition for permission to wear hijab along with her school uniform.

A Division Bench of Justices J.J. Munir and Indrajit Shukla, in an order of August 21, dismissed the petition filed by a Class 11 student of Tagore Public School in Prayagraj.

In her plea, the student argued that wearing the scarf was an essential religious practice protected by her fundamental rights under Articles 14 and 19(a) of the Constitution. She had previously worn a headscarf at the same school from Class 6 without objection, she said.

The fact that the student



The court said the dispute was principally about compliance with institutional dress code.

had worn the scarf for several years did not create an enforceable right to compel the school to relax or alter its uniform policy, the High Court said.

"We have perused the photographs from various classes relating to the petitioner. Except for her, no other girl student is donning the headscarf, even those belonging to the same religious community as the petitioner. Wherever this issue has arisen, the

High Courts have been unanimous in opinion that wearing a headscarf is not essential part of the Islamic faith, in the absence of which faith would be jeopardized," the court said.

No factual foundation had been laid nor material placed on record to establish that donning headscarf was an essential part of religion for a Muslim female, the High Court further said. The court relied on the judgments of the Bombay and Karnataka High Courts concerning hijab.

It held that the dispute was principally about compliance with an institutional dress code rather than interference with the student's freedom of faith.

"The school in this case does not seek to curtail the petitioner's freedom of faith at all. All that they require is conformity to institutional discipline, of which a uniform is an essential part," it said.

Cong backs women's right to choose their attire

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Congress leader Pawan Khara on Tuesday said the party stood firmly for women's bodily autonomy and agency, asserting that every woman, irrespective of her caste, class or religion, had the right to choose what she wore.

"Whether the hijab is essential to Islam or not is for religious scholars to decide. From a socio-political standpoint, we stand firmly for women's bodily autonomy and agency," Mr. Khara said in a post on X.

His remarks also seem to address the BJP's attack on Rahul Gandhi over the latter's comments on the *Manusmriti* in Pune on Saturday. The BJP accused Mr. Gandhi of selectively targeting a Hindu religious text while talking about "smash the patriarchy", and asked why he had not made similar remarks about other religious texts.

Rajnath approves missile tech transfer to Indian companies

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh has approved the transfer of technology (ToT) of all conventional missile systems developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) to Indian defence manufacturers to promote indigenous production.

The transfer will enable domestic companies to undertake production of

DRDO-developed missile systems, subject to applicable qualifications, certifications and regulatory requirements. This decision will facilitate the transition of missile projects from the development stage to industrial-scale production.

According to the Defence Ministry, the move is aimed at enhancing domestic manufacturing capabilities, strengthening the defence industrial base and reducing dependence on imports.



APPEAL

Sri Vijith Praveen is 4 years old suffering from 'B Cell - Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia'. He needs Chemotherapy and Radiation Therapy at Moonaski Mission Hospital & Research Centre, Madurai. The total expenditure is Rs. 9,00,000/- His father works as a helper. The family is very poor and cannot afford this huge cost. Please support him for the treatment. Donations sent by ChD/50 favouring Moonaski Mission Hospital & Research Centre, Madurai

Transfer & GOOGLE PAY (Canara Bank, Nungambakkam Branch, A/c No. 6010201003010, IFSC No. CHRD018018) favouring WOMEN'S WELFARE SYNDICATE is exempted under 80G.

All correspondence is done through WWS, Rajni Public Charitable Trust, Flat No. GF 1, Corridor Apartments, Okla's N.K. 29, Pycroft Garden Lane, Chennai-600006. Ph: 94-42174701 3152731 733897807. Email: D. womenswelfareindia@gmail.com Website: www.womenswelfareindia.org WWS

BJP attacks Congress mindset, calls Rahul a 'robot of China'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party on Tuesday described Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi as a "robot of China", and attacked him and the Congress party for their positions on the Doklam stand-off, surgical strikes, air strikes, and Operation Sindoor.

At a press conference here, BJP MP Sambit Patra responded to a query about Congress MP Manish Tewari's post on X regarding Chinese humanoid robots. "We have to fight the Congress mindset at the LOC (Line of Control) and at the International Borders, also because they are the ones who, in fact, are the props of our enemies. They are the ones who spread misinformation," Mr. Patra said.

"If India is not careful, it could be very soon fighting a robot PLA (People's Liberation Army of China) on the LAC (Line of Actual Control)..." Mr. Tewari had said in the post. The remarks were not only about a robotic army, but rather underscored that if India was left behind in the technological race, it would have geo-strategic



Sambit Patra

implications, he later explained.

"They (the Congress) are the ones who were found inside the Chinese tent when the Doklam stand-off was taking place," he said, referring to the 2017 face-off between Indian and Chinese troops. He also accused Mr. Gandhi of having made "discouraging" comments during the confrontation.

"During Operation Sindoor, unfortunately, we became the only country to have a discussion on the floor of the Parliament [about] whether the Indian Army did well or not, despite having all the evidence of destroying innumerable bases in Pakistan," he said. "Such is our Opposition, such is Rahul Gandhi... the robot of China called Rahul Gandhi," he said.

Congress urges PM to scrap caste census questionnaire

Kharge, Rahul object to open-ended format proposed for recording caste details; they say the govt. must formulate a new survey form after consulting political parties, experts, and the public

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

The Leaders of the Opposition in the Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha, Mallikarjun Kharge and Rahul Gandhi, respectively, have written to Prime Minister Narendra Modi demanding that the questionnaire for the caste census be scrapped, and a new one be prepared to ensure accurate enumeration of castes.

In their joint letter, the two leaders urged the government to consult experts, political parties, and the public while framing the new questionnaire, and use the caste surveys conducted in Bihar and Telangana as workable models to follow.

They also suggested a drop-down list of castes to ensure that different names, sub-castes, and linguistic variations do not lead to the same caste being recorded separately.

"We do not accept the caste census being conducted in the current manner," Mr. Kharge and Mr. Gandhi said, urging the government to "scrap the ex-



Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi and Mallikarjun Kharge at a press briefing in New Delhi. FILE PHOTO

isting questionnaire and formulate a new one after consulting political parties, experts, and the general public."

The letter, dated August 20 was released by Congress general secretary Jai Ram Ramesh at a press conference on Tuesday.

'Whitewash'

The present exercise amounted to a "whitewash", Mr. Ramesh said, accusing the government of adopting a methodology that could undermine the purpose of the caste census. "The Congress party believes that the way the caste census is being con-

ducted in the country is a betrayal of the people," Mr. Ramesh said. "We will not accept the way this census is being conducted because it is just a whitewash."

"The notification on the caste census informed 40 questions to be asked, and 10th question would be linked to caste; it is a form of self-sabotage, will not ensure social justice," Mr. Ramesh said.

Accurate caste data is necessary for framing policies on education, employment, welfare, and social justice, Mr. Kharge and Mr. Gandhi said. They objected to the open-ended for-

mat proposed for recording caste details, arguing that the same caste could be known by different names, sub-castes, and linguistic variants in different parts of the country.

Absence of BC category

If these variations were recorded separately, they said, a single caste could be fragmented into thousands of names, making the resulting dataset unreliable. They also pointed to the absence of the term "Backward Class" from the questionnaire, saying this could prevent an accurate assessment of the Other Backward Classes (OBC) population.

The two leaders proposed that a standardised caste list be prepared using existing government lists, including those of Socially and Educationally Backward Classes, along with material from the Anthropological Survey of India.

This was the third letter from the Congress leadership to Mr. Modi on the caste census, with the previous two letters receiving no response, Mr. Ramesh said.

BJP, Opposition spar in panel over demand for crackdown debate

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

A heated exchange broke out in the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Home Affairs on Tuesday after Opposition members demanded a discussion on alleged police excesses during the July 20 protest in Delhi, including the alleged use of pellet guns.

The committee, chaired by BJP MP Radha Mohan Das Agarwal, was meeting to deliberate on the subject of "Crime Against Children", with officials from four Ministries present for the discussion.

However, minutes after the meeting commenced at 11 a.m., senior Congress leader and Rajya Sabha MP Ajay Maken raised a letter he had written to the chairperson earlier, seeking that all other agenda items be set aside to discuss what he described as the "excessive use of force" by the Delhi Police during the youth-led protests at Jantar Mantar.

Summarising the contents of his letter, Mr. Maken said that security personnel had used pellet guns, deployed barricades that delivered electric shocks, and resorted to lathi-charge against protesters. He further claimed that a truck loaded with stones had been parked near Jantar Mantar to implicate demonstrators, and alleged that several police personnel were operating without name tags.

Mr. Agarwal rejected the request, saying that the matter was *sub judice* and therefore could not be taken up by the committee under parliamentary rules. He also referred to directions issued by the Supreme Court and noted that a committee appointed by the top court is exa-



Radha Mohan Das Agarwal

mining the issues.

The ruling prompted strong objections from Opposition members, including Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, Trinamool Congress leader Derek O'Brien, Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Sanjay Raut and NCP (SP) MP Supriya Sule, among others, who argued that the committee should discuss the allegations given their significance.

Political slugfest

The debate, according to sources, then widened into a political slugfest between members of the ruling and Opposition parties. BJP MP Tarun Chugh referred to the 1984 anti-Sikh riots and argued that allegations of police excesses from that period had never been adequately investigated. Congress member Jai Prakash countered that if State-related issues were being discussed, instances of alleged false police encounters under BJP governments should also be examined.

The two members then engaged in a shouting match, prompting intervention by the chairperson.

Seeking to restore order, Mr. Agarwal proposed that the committee could, at a later stage, consider discussing the framing of a Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) governing police action during protests.

Indian loitering munition may have hit Pakistan's Kirana Hills, says former CDS

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

Former Chief of Defence Staff General Anil Chauhan (ret'd) has said a loitering munition deployed during Operation Sindoor may have struck the Kirana Hills area near Pakistan's Sargodha, where nuclear-related facilities are located.

Speaking at the "VI-MARSH" event on Operation Sindoor and its aftermath at the Vivekananda International Foundation, General Chauhan said India had sent several loitering missions around Sargodha before the strikes to search for radars.

At a media briefing during Operation Sindoor, then Director General of Air Operations, Air Marshal A.K. Bharti, had said on May 12 last year that the Indian armed forces did not target the nuclear facility at Kirana Hills in Pakistan. Responding to a query at the time, Air Marshal Bharti had said, "Thank



General Anil Chauhan (ret'd)

you for telling us that Kirana Hills houses some nuclear installation. We did not know about it. And we have not hit Kirana Hills, whatever is there."

"Kirana Hills is about 10 kilometres north of Sargodha," he said, explaining that the loitering missions had an endurance of around two hours. If they failed to locate a target within that period, they would eventually descend and strike somewhere.

"It must have come and hit one of those hills," Gen-

eral Chauhan said, referring to the possibility that one of the loitering munitions struck Kirana Hills. He also referred to images aired by Pakistani media showing smoke emerging from the area.

Greater networking

General Chauhan said India's operational success during the operation was driven by better situational awareness and battlefield transparency, enabled by greater networking among the Army, Navy and Air Force. "We were able to make better decisions," he said, attributing the outcome also to "clear political direction" that gave the armed forces a free hand to plan operations.

On Pakistan's use of satellite imagery, the former CDS said commercial satellite imagery from Chinese companies was available to anyone and suggested that Pakistan had attempted to use such imagery to assess the results of its strikes.

He also questioned the accuracy of Pakistan's battlefield intelligence, particularly regarding maritime operations. Pakistani briefings reportedly claimed that an Indian carrier battle group was at certain locations in the Arabian Sea, but checks with the Western Naval Command showed it was actually 100 to 300 nautical miles away.

On U.S. President Donald Trump's claims of mediating the India-Pakistan ceasefire, Gen. Chauhan said the decision was reached directly between the two Directors General of Military Operations (DGMOs). "The ceasefire was decided between two DGMOs, and that's it. I don't see the role of anyone else," he said.

He questioned how information about the ceasefire reached the U.S. side before India could announce it, saying he was certain the information had not leaked from the Indian side.

Centre moots plan to add 100 vessels to merchant fleet

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The National Shipping Board (NSB) has proposed a five-point road map to add 100 vessels to India's merchant fleet over the next five years, a move aimed at reducing the country's dependence on foreign shipping lines for transporting critical cargo.

The road map, comprising fiscal reforms, assured cargo support, access to competitive financing, regulatory streamlining, and improved ease of doing business, was discussed at

the inaugural Sagar Samvad event organised by the NSB on Monday.

Union Minister for Ports, Shipping, and Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal, who chaired the event, said, "Taken together, these are not five separate tasks; they are the architecture of a nation choosing, at last, to own its own trade."

The NSB said India currently pays close to \$75 billion annually, in freight charges to foreign shipping lines for transporting commodities including crude oil, gas, coal, and urea.

GREATER VISAKHAPATNAM SMART CITY CORPORATION LIMITED (GVSCCL)
Ref. No: GVSCCL/Project/447/UC-24/27 Water Supply/2026-27 Dt: 25/08/2026

GVSCCL desires to invite the tender for the work "Providing 24/7 Water Supply to Madhuravada (Zone-II) and its adjoining areas including 15 zones O&M in Visakhapatnam" with an ECV of Rs 461.92 Cr under UCF scheme. The detailed tender documents can be downloaded from website of <https://approcurement.gov.in> from 27/08/2026 onwards. The last date for online submission of bids is 16/09/2026 upto 05:00 PM.

For more details contact:
E-mail: visakhapatnamsmartcity@gvsccl.in Sd/-
Mobile No: 9848308824 MD & CEO, GVSCCL

UN panel flags violations against SC, ST, Rohingya

Kallol Bhattacharjee
NEW DELHI

The UN Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination (UNCERD) has said it is "gravely concerned" about reports of human rights violations against a vast segment of people in India, including Scheduled Tribes, Scheduled Castes, and Rohingya refugees.

In a press note that came on the ninth anniversary of the Rohingya crisis, the committee called for urgent action to address "hate speech" and "hate crime" in India. It said that there had been an increase in incidents targeting Bengali-speaking Muslims and called on the Government of India to "ensure accountability" for these violations.

"The committee was gravely concerned about reports of large-scale violations perpetrated by law enforcement officials against ethnic and indigenous groups, indigenous and tribal people, including Scheduled Tribes, Scheduled Castes, particularly Dalits, and non-citizens," it said.

The remarks came a fortnight after the committee carried out the eleventh periodic review of India on August 11-12. India had sent Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta as the head of delegation for the review.

The committee said these communities had been subjected to "racially motivated violence, excessive use of force, extrajudicial killings, arbitrary and prolonged detention with-

out due process, torture, ill-treatment and sexual violence".

"The committee called on India to conduct prompt, thorough and impartial investigations into all such allegations and ensure accountability for those responsible," the press note said.

The panel further noted that there had been an increase in law enforcement operations targeting "Rohingya, Bengali-speaking Muslims, migrants and asylum-seekers, particularly following the 2017 Ministry of Home Affairs order and the April 2025 Pahalgam terror attack in Kashmir". The panel said that police check posts had resorted to racial profiling that led to "arbitrary arrest and detention without due process".

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA - DEPARTMENT OF SPACE CONSTRUCTION & MAINTENANCE GROUP, SDSC - SHAR
SRIHARIKOTA - 524124
Brief E-TENDER NOTICE
e-Tender Notice No. CMGI/C/CON/268719 Date: 24/08/2026
On behalf of President of India, Item Rate tenders are invited through e-tendering for the following works:
Brief Name of work **Est. Value (Rs)**
Construction of Antenna structure for Telemetry building at SLC Complex, Tiruchendur 38 Lakhs
& Sattankulam Taluk, Thoothukudi District, Tamil Nadu.
Last date for sale / Tender documents can be downloaded up to 02/09/2026, 14:30 hrs. For eligibility criteria and other details, interested tenders may please refer to the detailed bilingual (Hindi-English) Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT) on the website <https://www.isro.gov.in/Tenders.html> and tender free view at <https://www.tenderwizard.com/isro>
Sd/- GROUP HEAD, CMGI SDSC SHAR

KALYANA KARNATAKA ROAD TRANSPORT CORPORATION:
CENTRAL OFFICES: KALABURAGI
NOKKTCO/TR/COM/2316/26-27 Dated: 24.08.2026
TENDER NOTIFICATION NO. 04/2026 (E-PROCUREMENT PLATFORM)
Tenders/bids are invited through e-portal for the Selection of Agency for grant of Advertisement Rights on Ordinary, Express and City buses (total 1000 buses) of KKRTC for the appropriate Qualified Bidders for a period of Five (5) years.
1) **ELF (Economic License Fee)** is Rs. 2044/- per Bus per Month Excluding taxes. 2) Increase of 5% (five) for 2nd year and 10% (Ten) for 3rd, 4th and 5th year over the license fee of the previous year. 3) **The Earnest Money Deposit** amount fixed is Rs. 20,00,000/- (Twenty lakhs Rupees). 4) **Calendar of events:**
Description, Date & Time: 1. Last date for submission of queries: 08.9.2026 1700hrs. 2. Pre-bid meeting: 09.9.2026 1100 hrs. 3. Last date of Submission of Bids: 16.9.2026 1700 hrs. 4. Opening of Technical Bid: 16.9.2026 1100 hrs. 5. Opening of Financial Bid: 22.9.2026 1100 hrs
5) The Financial Bids of the Bidders, who have qualified in Technical Bid will only be opened. 6) The Terms & Conditions, Eligibility Criteria and other Technical details can be downloaded from the e-portal website: www.eproc.karnataka.gov.in from 7) KKRTC reserves the right to accept or reject tenders without assigning any reason thereof. 8) For more details contact: Dy Chief Traffic Manager-7760909013, Divisional Traffic Officer-7760992024, E-mail id: ctmnektcglb@gmail.com
Sd/- Chief Traffic Manager
KKRTC Central Offices, Kalaburagi
DIPR/Kalaburagi/464/KSMC&A/2026-27

इण्डियन ओवरसीज बैंक
Indian Overseas Bank
(An ISO 9001:2015 certified bank) **Information Technology Department**
Central Office: 763, Anna Salai, Chennai - 600 002
Indian Overseas Bank (IOB) invites bids for the following:
GOVERNMENT MARKET PORTAL SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND MAINTENANCE OF VIDEO IP PHONES (Model No:8875) ALONG WITH FLEX LICENSES FOR THREE-YEAR PERIOD
BID NO: GEM/2026/B/7949397 DATED 21.08.2026
The Above GEM Tender document is also available and can be downloaded from the following websites www.iob.bank.in & www.gem.gov.in For Tender details and future amendments, if any, keep referring to the following website www.gem.gov.in

GREATER VISAKHAPATNAM MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
Short Tender Notice No.: 40/2026-27/SE-WIEE(PW-MWD)/DB, Dt: 24-08-2026
Number of works : 18 works, Value of works Rs. 11,93,75,610
Starting Date : 27.08.2026 Ending Date : 03.09.2026
Note: Further details at <http://www.tender.approcurement.gov.in>
O/o the EE(MDW) Cell No. 99480 95518. For Commissioner

SUPREME COURT OF INDIA
RECRUITMENT FOR THE POST OF ASSISTANT REGISTRAR (COMPUTER)
Applications are invited from eligible officers under Central Government/State Government/Universities/Recognized Research Institutes or any High Court for selection for appointment to one post of Assistant Registrar (Computer) on deputation basis in Level 12 of Pay Matrix. Other information and application form prescribed for the post of Assistant Registrar (Computer) can be downloaded from the website of the Supreme Court of India, i.e., www.sci.gov.in. The last date for receipt of applications is 30th September, 2026.
Place: New Delhi
Date: 24.08.2026
Registrar (Recruitment)

BENGALURU NORTH CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer, Byatarayanapura Division, Zone-1 No. 215/220, Defence colony, 9th Main, D Block, Sahakara Nagar, BNCC office, Bengaluru-560092.
No:BNCC-Z1/EE/BT/KPPP/PR/17/2026-27 Date: 24-08-2026
SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Through GOK KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only).
Tenders on item rate basis are invited by the undersigned on behalf of The Commissioner, BNCC for the works mentioned below from the registered contractors of Bengaluru North City Corporation, or equivalent registration with CPWD / KPWD / Railways / MES or any State Government Organizations, (Standard Tender Document KWC-1.2.3.4)
Sl. No. **Name of the work / Category (Two cover Tender)**
1. Annual Maintenance of SWD in Byatarayanapura 1, Division for the year 2026-27 / Call/7 (OTHERS)
Approximate value of work: ₹.175.00 Lakhs, EMD: ₹.262500/-
Calendar of Events: (1) Pre-bid meeting will be held on 01-09-2026 at 3:00 pm. (2) Last Date for uploading the filled proposals is 05-09-2026 upto 4:00 pm. (3) Date of Opening of Technical Bid on 07-09-2026 after 11:00 am. (4) Date of Opening of Financial Bid After Approval of Technical Bid.
Sd/- Executive Engineer
Bengaluru North City Corporation

IN BRIEF



SC gives Tarun Tejpal 3 weeks to surrender in 2013 rape case

The Supreme Court on Tuesday directed journalist Tarun Tejpal to surrender in three weeks in a 2013 rape case in which he has been sentenced to 10 years' imprisonment. His appeal would be heard once the certificate of his surrender is filed in the Supreme Court, on or before September 22, a Single Judge Bench of Justice Alok Aradhe said. The State of Goa, represented by Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta, argued that Tejpal should surrender before his appeal was listed for hearing in the Supreme Court. The Bombay High Court had sentenced him to rigorous imprisonment while overturning his acquittal by the trial court five years ago.

SC bars police from coercive action against journalist

The Supreme Court on Tuesday ordered the Uttar Pradesh police to refrain from taking any coercive action against Abhishek Upadhyay, an independent journalist, in connection with a FIR over a road rage incident. Mr. Upadhyay had recently flagged the alleged misappropriation of donations for the Ram temple in Ayodhya. Appearing before a three-judge Bench, senior advocate Pradeep Rai, representing Mr. Upadhyay, submitted, "I do not want any other relief other than a fair investigation."

NGT takes up plea over Ganga floodplain construction order

The National Green Tribunal (NGT) on Tuesday took up an application challenging a Ministry of Jal Shakti notification published on August 10, 2026. The applicant, advocate Katayni, has challenged the amendment to the River Ganga (Rejuvenation, Protection and Management) Authorities Order, 2016, contending that it dilutes the earlier protection requiring the banks and floodplains of the Ganga and its tributaries to be maintained as a construction-free zone. The Union government has eased restrictions governing construction along the Ganga floodplain, paving the way for building projects in areas subject to moderate or rare flooding.

Dera Sacha Sauda chief Ram Rahim gets 21-day furlough

Rape convict Dera Sacha Sauda chief Gurmeet Ram Rahim Singh walked out of the Sunaria jail in Rohtak on Tuesday on a 21-day furlough, sources said. It is the 17th time he has moved out of the prison since his conviction in August 2017. Ram Rahim is serving a 20-year jail term for raping two of his disciples and is currently lodged in the Sunaria jail in Haryana. He will stay at his Sirda-headquartered Dera during the furlough period. The preacher has been granted furlough an unusually high number of times since his conviction. This is his third release this year. He was granted a 30- and 40-day parole in May and January, respectively. Sikh organisations, including the Shriromani Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee, have criticised the recurring relief provided to Ram Rahim. **PH**

Minister seeks fundamental shift in fight against drought

Global approach to droughts must move from reactive relief to proactive resilience, says Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav while addressing UNCCD conference in Mongolia

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

There ought to be a fundamental shift in the global approach to droughts from reactive relief to proactive, technology-enabled resilience, Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav said at the United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD) conference in Mongolia on Tuesday.

Addressing international delegates at the Ministerial Dialogue on "Accelerating Drought Resilience" in Ulaanbaatar during the 17th Conference of Parties (COP17) to the UNCCD, Mr. Yadav warned that dry spells are rapidly escalating. Drought is "no longer an occasional event, but a defining development challenge", he said, citing its compounding disruptions to global water security, agricultural food systems, biodiversity, and economic stability.

'Restore the forest'

He highlighted India's coordinated, multi-institu-



Union Minister Bhupender Yadav says droughts are no longer an occasional event, but a defining development challenge. FILE PHOTO

tional approach integrating early warning, mitigation, relief and community resilience. Rainfall monitoring and satellite-based drought assessments trigger preparedness at the inter-ministerial and State levels, ensuring that a dry spell does not escalate into a crisis. Emphasising the critical link between land and water, he called for restoring "the forest, before the flow", underscoring India's focus on catchment and riverscape forestry to reduce erosion, improve water retention and recharge groundwater. The Minister advocated

for integrating predictive technologies, localised early-warning monitoring, and proactive land management policies. The goal, he noted, is to equip vulnerable communities to anticipate and absorb environmental shocks rather than relying primarily on post-disaster relief.

Summit objectives

The ministerial talks form a central component of UNCCD COP17, hosted by Mongolia under the theme "Restoring Land, Restoring Hope". Adopted in 1994 following the 1992 Rio Earth Summit, the UNCCD

is one of the three major Rio Conventions – alongside the framework conventions on climate change (UNFCCC) and biological diversity (CBD). It stands as the sole legally binding international agreement linking environmental management directly to sustainable land stewardship.

The 17th conference serves as a pivotal negotiation platform as land degradation currently impacts up to 40% of the planet's land surface, undermining the livelihoods of billions of people worldwide.

During the biennial sessions, delegates from 197 member parties – alongside civil society leaders, scientists, and international financial institutions – convene to negotiate binding frameworks and policy guidance.

The agreements negotiated at COP17 aim to translate high-level environmental commitments into measurable, investable solutions for water and food security over the next decade.

Conduct fresh inspection of MCA eateries, HC tells FDA

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

The Bombay High Court on Tuesday ordered the Maharashtra Food and Drug Administration (FDA) to conduct fresh inspections of five eateries on the premises of the Mumbai Cricket Association (MCA) to determine if the suspension of their food licences can be revoked.

A Division Bench of Acting Chief Justice Ravindra Ghuge and Justice Gautam Ankhad directed the FDA to inspect the premises at Bandra Kurla Complex on Thursday afternoon and submit its report, along with an affidavit on their hygiene compliance, on Monday. For tournaments organised by the MCA in the interim, the bench ordered the petitioners to serve only tea and coffee from vending machines.

The court has listed the matter for further hearing on August 31.

Top brands remove health claims amid FSSAI crackdown

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

Mondelez India Foods, maker of Bournvita and Cadbury products, has withdrawn health and nutrient-comparison claims flagged by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI), along with related advertisements from e-commerce platforms, as the regulator steps up action against misleading food claims.

FSSAI has issued more than 150 notices to food companies over misleading advertisements, false claims and labelling violations. Nestlé India, PepsiCo, Coca-Cola India, Abbott India, Red Bull India, Danone India, Monster Energy India, Ferrero India and Kenue are among companies named by the regulator.

Bournvita had come under scrutiny in 2023 over its sugar content and nutri-

Aravali panel failed to conduct adequate study, say activists

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court-constituted high-powered committee tasked with studying the Aravalis has not conducted adequate scientific assessment, public consultation, and field trips across the mountain range, Aravalli Virasat Jan Abhiyan (AVJA), a coalition of environmentalists and activists, said on Tuesday.

As the August 31 deadline for the panel to submit its report approaches, independent experts and conservationists have written to the committee expressing concerns, the AVJA said.

Pradip Krishen, an ecological restoration practitioner who has worked in the Aravalli landscapes in Delhi, Haryana and Rajasthan for the last two decades, said, "This Committee has a historic opportunity to do what has never been done for the Aravalli range. Aravalis need a cumulative Environmental and Social Impact Study spanning all 64 Aravalli districts."

Stalin Dayanand, director, Vanashakti, an organi-



The Aravalli range is one of the oldest mountain systems.

sation working for nature conservation in Maharashtra and other parts of India, said they have requested the committee to seek more time, broaden the consultation process, involve independent experts, listen to rural and adivasi communities and include knowledgeable local citizens in field visits rather than rushing to submit the report by August 31. "Protecting the Aravalis is a responsibility to future generations. The decisions taken today could determine whether future generations inherit a healthy and functioning ecological system or a severely damaged landscape," he said.

19 trafficked children rescued in Arunachal

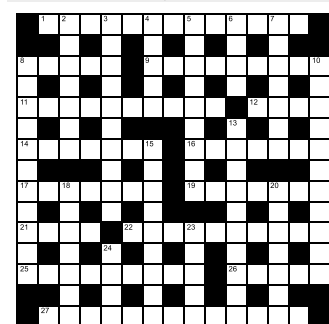
The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

The police in Namsai district of Arunachal Pradesh have rescued 19 children from across the State and arrested three women allegedly involved in their trafficking, officials said on Tuesday.

Sangey Thinley, the district's Superintendent of Police, said an investigation was launched based on a complaint lodged by the Child Welfare Committee (CWC).

According to a statement from the Namsai police, preliminary investigation indicated that economically vulnerable families were allegedly approached with assurances of better education, care, and upbringing for their children. "The children were thereafter allegedly procured, transported, and placed with different persons at distant locations," it read.

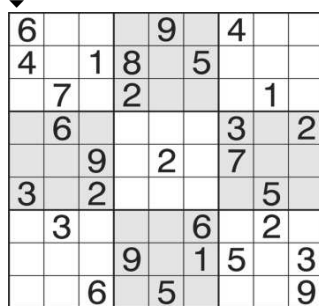
THE CROSSWORD 14882



- Across**
- 1 Playful sexual activity of Bond having drink with English lady in retreat (4,3,6)
 - 8 Massage the Spanish star (5)
 - 9 Charges in Leeds animatedly after taking wicket (9)
 - 11 See godson slyly stealing money — oh dear! (8,2)
 - 12 Wire-tap catches nationalist giving bribe (4)

- Down**
- 14 Hint about turbulent ride in disturbed sea due to currents (4,3)
 - 16 Highest in quiz, dominates completely (7)
 - 17 Associate eventually checks innermost layers of blood vessel (7)
 - 19 Topless seaside resort in England is trendy (5-2)
 - 21 Girl on edge, becoming sullen (4)
 - 22 American character beginning to feel good after controlling hot, quick temper (1,5,4)
 - 25 Prominent feature of model on one's arm (5,4)
 - 26 Consumed some wine at entertainment (5)
 - 27 Couple consuming ganja essentially and relaxing in flat (13)
 - 2 Pursue large dog running around tree (7)
 - 3 Romp with lad in fancy European racecar perhaps (10)
 - 4 Star in retreat cuddling extremely divine, unclad art models (5)
 - 5 Reel about the French master's scientific instrument (9)
 - 6 Peel of cocaine on degenerate (4)
 - 7 Vegetable cutlet served with starter of eggplant (7)
 - 8 Footballer curling with shot over top of goal (5-6)
 - 10 Guess the number in jar without looking (5,6)
 - 13 One chasing blonde in gathering is most frivolous (10)
 - 15 Emphasise how to return cursor to beginning of current active line (5,4)
 - 18 I am weak, taking vitamin (7)
 - 20 Relative enthralled by tenor performing in English county town (7)
 - 23 Selection of robes, extremely large (5)
 - 24 Informed about naked sot entering bar (2,2)

SUDOKU



DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★

Solution to previous puzzle



Solution to yesterday's Sudoku



FAITH

Onam: a revelation

When Perumal manifested on earth as Vamana (and Trivikrama), the avatar was not to destroy the evil forces, but to cherish the virtuous. To this end, He arrived at Mahabali's palace in the garb of a humble man seeking alms. Mahabali, the asura king renowned for his charity, was going to be the tool with which Perumal would impart a lesson for eternity on the efficacy of walking the path of dharma and bhakti, said Damal S. Ramakrishnan.

Vamana came seeking three feet of land from Mahabali, in a show of divine selflessness. Mahabali's guru Sukrachariar spotted the heavenly conch and discus on Vamana and forbade the king from granting the request, saying it was Perumal who was seeking alms. Mahabali found himself in the unenviable position of choosing between right and choosing to obey his guru. Choosing the former, Mahabali points out that it is a guru's duty to show God to his student and now that Perumal Himself was standing in front of him, Mahabali chooses to make the grant of three feet of land to Vamana who transforms into Trivikrama while measuring the land. A furious Sukrachariar shape-changes and hides in the spout of the *kindri* (pitcher), blocking the flow of holy water (a ritual while giving alms). Perumal sends a strand of darba into the *kindri* and ejects Sukrachariar. Trivikrama says it is OK if one is not giving charity, but if one prevents a person from giving (alms) there is no greater sin than that. It is because Mahabali chose to honour dharma over everything that Perumal granted him the post of celestial guard. He also blessed the king with an annual visit to his kingdom, to be welcomed joyously by his subjects, which is celebrated as Onam.

OTTAWA

Canada announces retaliatory tariffs on \$20 bn worth of U.S. goods



Canada on Tuesday announced retaliatory tariffs on \$19.94 billion worth of U.S. goods, matching dollar-for-dollar new duties imposed by Washington. The counter-tariffs take effect on U.S. goods from September 8 and will impose duties of 15%, 25% and 50% across 700 products imported from south of the border. REUTERS

WASHINGTON

Dolly Parton, U.S. country music legend, actor, passes away at 80



U.S. country music legend Dolly Parton, who grew up poor in Tennessee and became a household name with hits like *Jolene* and *Coat of Many Colours*, has died at age 80, her family said on Tuesday. "Dolly has lived in the light and is in the arms of Jesus," her nephew said in a video on social media. AFP

COLOMBO

Sri Lanka Easter Sunday blast case verdict set for mid-September



The Colombo High Court has set September 22 as the date for the verdict on the main criminal case in the 2019 Easter Sunday bombings, which killed 279 people, including 45 foreigners. The bombings were a series of coordinated suicide attacks on churches and luxury hotels in the island nation on April 19, 2019. PTI

NEW YORK

Epstein accomplice Maxwell loses bid to overturn U.S. conviction



A U.S. federal judge on Tuesday rejected a bid by Ghislaine Maxwell, a key accomplice of notorious sex offender Jeffrey Epstein, to throw out her conviction on sex trafficking charges. In his ruling, the judge said that Maxwell's claims that her constitutional rights were violated "are all meritless and all or almost all are frivolous," AFP

'Border stability is an immediate priority'

'Institutionalising stability' on the border is the immediate task for both countries rather than expecting a sudden 'dramatic settlement', says Chinese strategic affairs scholar Hu Shisheng; both sides have incentive for a favourable political atmosphere for possible leader-level interaction, he adds

Ananth Krishnan
BEIJING

As India and China on Tuesday held the 25th round of border talks between National Security Adviser Ajit Doval and China's Foreign Minister Wang Yi in Beijing, Hu Shisheng, a leading Chinese strategic affairs scholar on South Asia, said "institutionalising stability" is the immediate task for both countries even as "structural differences" in the relationship remained.

"On the border, I would expect the immediate focus to be less on a dramatic settlement and more on institutionalising stability. The priority is to prevent misunderstanding and miscalculation along the LAC, strengthen military

and diplomatic communication, and turn last year's idea of an 'early harvest' into an operational process," Mr. Hu, who is Director of the South Asia Institute at the China Institutes of Contemporary International Relations (CICIR) in Beijing, told *The Hindu*.

He was referring to an agreement at last year's 24th round on establishing an Expert Group under the Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination (WMCC) on border affairs to explore "early harvest on boundary delimitation".

Mr. Hu said the timing of Mr. Doval's visit, before the September 12 BRICS Summit in New Delhi, added significance to the visit with Mr. Xi expected to visit India.



A satellite image taken in June 2020 shows the Line of Actual Control and Patrolling Point 14 in the eastern Ladakh sector. AFP

"Both sides have a strong incentive to keep the border stable and create a favourable political atmosphere for possible leader-level interaction," he said, adding that he viewed maintaining stability on the border, achieving "concrete and

operational progress" on "early harvest" outcomes, and creating favourable conditions for the BRICS Summit as immediate priorities.

At the strategic level, he added, Mr. Doval's visit would help "clear potential obstacles ahead of the

BRICS Summit and lay the groundwork for possible leader-level engagement."

He added that ensuring no unexpected border incident before the summit, setting the political tone and identifying deliverables for a possible leaders' meeting, and coordinating the handover of the BRICS agenda from India to China, which takes over as chair next year, would be three essential issues on the table.

Gradual normalisation
The view in Beijing, as in Delhi, is that the normalisation in relations since the October 2024 meeting between Mr. Modi and Mr. Xi is likely to remain gradual and measured.

"As for the broader normalisation, I would de-

scribe it as strategic risk management rather than strategic realignment," Mr. Hu said.

"Recent difficulties in India-U.S. relations may give New Delhi greater incentives to diversify its strategic options, while the relative stabilisation of China-U.S. ties reduces some of the external pressure on China-India relations. But the structural differences between China and India have not disappeared. What we are seeing is an attempt to build a more stable form of competitive coexistence - keeping the border peaceful, restoring practical cooperation, and expanding coordination through BRICS and the Global South without pretending that strategic competition no longer exists."

Israeli Minister Katz vows to keep troops in Syria during visit

Agence France-Presse
JERUSALEM

Israeli Defence Minister Israel Katz made a rare visit to troops in southern Syria on Tuesday, reiterating a pledge to keep forces in the area as long as there were "threats" to his country's security.

The visit comes a week after Israel bombed the disused Abu Duhur base in northwestern Syria, claiming it wanted to prevent Turkish troops deploying to the facility. Ankara has denied any visit to the site.

In southern Syria, Israeli forces have been stationed in a "security zone" since the fall of long-time ruler Bashar al-Assad in December 2024.

"There is daily activity here to thwart threats, to



Israel Katz

eliminate remnants of the old regime, to prevent dangerous consolidation of the new regime," Mr. Katz said.

"The message is clear to the President of Syria as well: when you wake up in the morning in your place in Damascus, look up at Mount Hermon and see the IDF - you know we are here to protect our communities and our border."

Syria 'shakes off' past with removal from U.S. terror list: Sharaa

Agence France-Presse
DAMASCUS

President Ahmed al-Sharaa hailed on Tuesday the U.S. removal of Syria from the state sponsors of terror list, a major sanctions relief step for a country aiming to boost post-war reconstruction.

"Today, Syria shakes off a dark stain and tears away a painful chapter of its past to embark on a path of development, reconstruction and rebuilding," Mr. Sharaa said in a speech.

Washington's decision on Monday rescinded a decades-old designation that came with severe economic restrictions, marking another step in warming



Ahmed Al-Sharaa

ties between the countries following the 2024 ouster of long-time Syrian ruler Bashar al-Assad.

U.S. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said that Monday's move "will help foster additional investment in Syria to promote political and economic stability".

Iran, Oman discuss temporary Hormuz path, mine-clearing

Agence France-Presse
MUSCAT

Iran and Oman's Foreign Ministers on Tuesday said they discussed a framework for a temporary transit corridor through the Strait of Hormuz and a mine-clearing project in the waterway, which they both border.

Omani Foreign Minister Badr Albusaidi and his Iranian counterpart Abbas Araghchi "discussed a phased framework that could provide a practical and implementable basis for moving forward" during talks in Tehran, a joint statement shared by Oman said.

The framework "in-

cludes the establishment of a joint temporary navigational corridor through the Strait of Hormuz and an agreement to implement a joint project to clear the Strait of mines", the statement added.

Mr. Albusaidi said in a post on X after the meeting that he hoped the countries would "soon announce" the temporary corridor in the strait.

The announcement came as U.S. President Donald Trump repeated claims on Truth Social that "all mines have been removed and/or detonated from within the International Waters of the Strait of Hormuz", citing the U.S. navy.

Rohingya refugees rally in Bangladesh camps demanding return to Myanmar

Associated Press
COX'S BAZAR

Tens of thousands of Rohingya refugees from Myanmar living in dozens of camps in Bangladesh held a rally Tuesday to demand their safe return to their home state, nine years after they fled a government crackdown.

The demonstrators urged the international community to ensure security in Rakhine state as they marked what they call the "Ninth Anniversary of Rohingya Genocide Day".

More than one million refugees from Myanmar's Rohingya ethnic and religious minority now live in the sprawling camps around the Cox's Bazar dis-



Exodus anniversary: Rohingya demonstrators gather during an event at a refugee camp in Cox's Bazar in Bangladesh. AP

trict of southeastern Bangladesh.

Most of them fled across the border in a mass exodus in 2017 after Buddhist-majority Myanmar launched a crackdown in Rakhine, following an attack by a Rohingya Muslim

insurgent group.

The Bangladesh government earlier attempted to start the repatriation at least twice, but it did not work out as none of the refugees was willing to go back, citing security concerns. Bangladesh says it

will not force anyone to return.

"Whether it is the Arakan Army or the Myanmar military, as long as they continue playing this double game, the situation in Arakan, or Rakhine, will not become safe. Does that mean we are expected to remain here for another 50 years," Rohingya refugee leader Sayed Ullah said on Tuesday. Arakan is the old name of Rakhine.

Earlier, Myanmar's military-backed government said that more than 300,000 Rohingya refugees living in camps in Bangladesh are former residents of Rakhine state and that it will accept their return once security conditions improve.

ENTERPRISE CONNECT

Punjab National Bank and Indian Army Enter into Exclusive Partnership to Offer PNB LUXURA and PNB Parakram Credit Cards to Army Personnel



Punjab National Bank has entered into an exclusive Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Indian Army to offer PNB LUXURA Credit Card and PNB Parakram Credit Card. Designed exclusively for serving personnel/JCOs/OR of the Indian Army, the MoU signing ceremony was graced by AG, Lt.Gen Viresh Pratap Singh Kaushik, PVSM, UYSM, YSM, SM, DG, MP & PS; Lt. Gen Rajeev Puri, AVSM, VSM representing the Indian Army in the presence of Shri Ashok Chandra, MD&CEO, Maj Gen Dinesh Singh Bisht (Retd.), Chief Defence Banking Advisor, Shri Sudhir Dalal, CMB, and Shri Amit Kumar Singh, AGM, from PNB. Under this partnership, PNB will offer two exclusive credit card variants designed for different personnel categories — PNB LUXURA Metal Credit Card for Army Officers and PNB Parakram Credit Card for JCOs/OR personnel. The credit cards offer a range of specially curated privileges and benefits, including 3% cashback on canteen stores (CSD) purchases, complimentary domestic and international lounge access, zero fore-expenditure, movie tickets (Buy 1 Get 1), complimentary golf lessons, and other reward and lifestyle benefits.

Launch of South Asian University's Flagship Online Certificate Course - 'Introduction to South Asia' (ITSA)

The Institute of South Asian Studies (ISAS) at South Asian University (SAU), New Delhi, under the guidance of the President, Prof. K. K. Aggarwal, launched its flagship programme, Introduction to South Asia (ITSA), on 21 August 2026. Originally offered to second-year undergraduate students at SAU, the course is being offered for the first time this year as an online certificate course to students from across the world. The twelve-week course features lectures by eminent faculty members from different disciplines across the University, bringing together diverse perspectives on the history, politics, society, economy and contemporary challenges of South Asia. The course was formally inaugurated at SAU at 11:00 a.m. on 21 August 2026 by Hon'ble President Prof. K. K. Aggarwal.

BIRAC Showcased India's Biotech Innovation at Bharatiya Vyapar Mahotsav

The Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC), under the Department of Biotechnology (DBT), Government of India, showcased India's

growing biotech and start-up ecosystem at the Bharatiya Vyapar Mahotsav 2026, held at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, from August 12-15. The BIRAC pavilion featured six supported start-ups developing innovative healthcare, medical and assistive technologies. The participating start-ups included Reconstructive Healthcare Solutions, Genetix Technologies, Exobot Dynamics, Bymo Technologies, Translead Medtech and Torchit, working on 3D-printed surgical models, robotic rehabilitation, advanced prosthetics, neuro-rehabilitation, assistive mobility solutions and AI-enabled technologies. BIRAC Managing Director Dr. Dhananjay Kumar Tiwary said the organisation's support extended beyond funding to infrastructure, mentorship, intellectual property assistance, regulatory guidance and market access. He said the showcased start-ups demonstrated how Indian innovation could combine advanced technology with social impact.



MC²+ Ignite, a sector-specific accelerator programme for deep-tech startups, was launched at IIT Madras on 19 August 2026 in the presence of Dr. Neeraj Mittal, Secretary, MoPNG. Shri Rajeev Kumar Singhal, Director (Business Development), GAIL, was also present on the occasion.

NBCC Set to Kick-Start Rs 500 Crore + Development Projects in Delhi-NCR for HUDCO



NBCC and HUDCO, two Navratna CPSEs under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, have further strengthened their strategic partnership with the commencement of two major development projects in the Delhi-NCR region. Bhoomi Pujan ceremonies for both projects were held recently, marking the beginning of project execution. The Bhoomi Pujan ceremony was attended by Shri Sanjay Kulkarni, CMD, HUDCO, and Dr. K. P. Mahadevaswamy, CMD, NBCC, along with Dr. Suman Kumar, Director (Commercial), NBCC, Shri M. Nagaraj, Director (Corporate Planning), HUDCO, Shri Diljeet Singh Khatri, Director (Finance), HUDCO, and senior officials of both organisations. The larger of the two projects is the Integrated Office Complex at Sector-62, Noida, Uttar Pradesh, with a project cost of approximately ₹485.20 crore. The project will have a maximum

A Business Initiative

2B+G+7 configuration with a total built-up area of approximately 82,617 sq. m. and is planned to achieve a 4-Star GRHA Rating, underscoring its focus on sustainable and energy-efficient development. The second project is the Commercial Development at Kaushambi, Ghaziabad, carries a project cost of approximately ₹34.64 crore. With a B+G+7 configuration, the project covering approximately 6,400 sq. m. of built-up area is planned to achieve a 3-Star GRHA Rating.

REC Limited Honoured with GEEF Global CSR Award 2026 for Excellence in Sports Development & Inclusion



REC Limited, through its CSR arm REC Foundation, has been honoured with the "GEEF Global CSR Award 2026" under the category "CSR Excellence in Sports Development & Inclusion 2026", presented during the Global WaterTech Summit 2026 in New Delhi. The award recognises REC's continued commitment to using sports as a powerful tool for youth empowerment, inclusion and community development, creating opportunities and enabling aspiring talent across the country. REC's CSR interventions in the sports sector reflect its focus on nurturing talent, promoting inclusivity and creating avenues for youth to realise their potential. By supporting sports development, REC Foundation continues to contribute towards building a more inclusive and empowered society.

HURL Conferred CSR Lifetime Achievement Award at BridgeBharat 2026



Hindustan Urvarak & Rasayan Limited (HURL) has been conferred the prestigious CSR Lifetime Achievement Award at BridgeBharat 2026 - National Seminar on Corporate Social Responsibility, held in Bhubaneswar on 18 August 2026. The event was organised by the Department of Public Enterprises, Government of Odisha, in collaboration with the Odisha Corporate Foundation and Bridge Bharat Foundation. The award recognises HURL's sustained commitment to social development, empowerment of underprivileged and marginalised communities, and building a more inclusive, equitable and sustainable society.

TIRELESS OPERATOR

'Siraj kept running in with a sore body and created opportunities'



Mohammed Siraj drew praise from Indian bowling coach Morne Morkel. "He kept running in with a sore body and created opportunities. Him having that attitude, that leadership, showing the other guys how it is done, is very important. He tried to get some energy out of the flat surface," said Morkel.

ABUSE OF EQUIPMENT

Prabath reprimanded for breaching Code of Conduct



Sri Lanka's Prabath Jayasuriya was reprimanded by the ICC for breaching Level 1 of the Code of Conduct on day two of the second Test on Monday. After being dismissed, Prabath had flung his gloves and he was adjudged as having breached Article 2.2 which relates to 'abuse of cricket equipment'. He also suffered one demerit point.

MISSED OPPORTUNITY

I should have gone on to get a big score, says Sooriyabandara



Pasindu Sooriyabandara, who scored 80 for Sri Lanka in the second Test against India, hoped that the follow-on would be avoided: "I was batting well and should have gone on to get a big score. Glad I could make some contribution. We need to avoid the follow-on. It's a pity that the top-order couldn't get a big partnership".

IT'S OVER

Djokovic and Sabalenka fall to the Patten-Siniakova pair



Novak Djokovic and Aryna Sabalenka were knocked out of the US Open's mixed doubles tournament on Tuesday by Henry Patten and Katerina Siniakova. The doubles specialists recovered from dropping the opening set 1-4 to take the second 4-2. Siniakova and Patten cruised to a 10-2 win in the third set tie-break.

Sooriyabandara, Dinusha help Sri Lanka stay afloat

The latter holds the key as the home side needs 39 more to avoid the follow-on with two wickets in hand; Prasidh and Suthar scalp three each while Siraj and Jadeja claim one apiece for India

INDIA IN SRI LANKA

K.C. Vijaya Kumar
COLOMBO

The sun often slipped behind the clouds, in the grassbanks a few lads flipped plastic bottles, loudspeakers belted out the classic Surangani number, the thirsty sipped cream-soda, and in the middle, Sri Lanka battled hard against India.

As Tuesday ebbed into darkness in the Sinhalese Sports Club Ground, the host scored 265 for eight in reply to India's first innings score of 503. Leading by 238 runs, Shubman Gill's men hold the edge in the second Test even as Sri Lanka tried to stay afloat on the third day.

The home team's resistance leant upon young batters Pasindu Sooriyabandara and Sonal Dinusha, who became vital anchors at varying points. Earlier, when Colombo stirred awake to the liquid acoustics of steady rain at dawn, there were lingering apprehensions about a delayed start.

But the damp skies cleared and the turf was



Battling it out: Sooriyabandara bounced back after a first-ball duck on debut at Galle while Dinusha notched up his third successive 80-plus score in as many innings. ANI & AP

dry when Sri Lanka resumed at eight for two. Debutant Kamil Mishara clipped two fours off the first over bowled by Prasidh Krishna. The southpaw though fell to the seamer when the latter extracted steep bounce and angled one into the batter. Mishara fended and wicketkeeper Dhruv Jurel caught the edge. Jurel donned the gloves

as Rishabh Pant is nursing a sore shoulder. Sri Lanka was vulnerable at 35 for three but despite that chink, Sooriyabandara and Kamindu Mendis buckled down together in an easy alliance. Sooriyabandara punched a four off Prasidh and Kamindu thumped one over cover while debutant off-spinner Saransh Jain stepped in.

Sooriyabandara guided

Mohammed Siraj past the ropes and Kamindu hoisted left-arm spinner Manav Suthar for six. The two batters found the fence often and then Kamindu fell tamely, pulling Prasidh straight to the fielder at mid-wicket, and that concluded the 87-run fourth-wicket partnership. Sri Lanka moved to 130 for four at lunch, a break that also ushered in a fresh

bout of showers. Once play resumed, skipper Dhananjaya de Silva edged Suthar and even as K.L. Rahul juggled at first slip, he managed to hold on.

A pattern

It was a moment that reiterated the pattern of steady runs marred by soft dismissals in the Sri Lankan scorecard.

Sooriyabandara and Di-

nusha then joined forces. Their right-left combination and the fluency with which they tackled spin, offered hope to the home dressing room. But when Ravindra Jadeja pinged close to the stumps, a defensive Sooriyabandara (80, 133b, 9x4) accidentally guided the ball onto his citadel.

The distraught batter dragged himself away and

Sri Lanka was placed on 171 for six. It got worse when Niroshan Dickwella fancied his runs down the leg-side and feathered Siraj into Jurel's gloves.

However, Dinusha, ever alert to runs, soldiered on. He eased the claustrophobia at the crease, striking a six each off Suthar and Saransh.

The lower-order lingered too as first Keshara

SCOREBOARD

INDIA — 1ST INNINGS

503/9 decl. in 138 overs.

SRI LANKA — 1ST INNINGS

Lahiru Udara c Jaiswal b Prasidh 1 (6b), Kamil Mishara c Jurel b Prasidh 19 (25b, 3x4), Prabath Jayasuriya lbw b Suthar 2 (7b), Pasindu Sooriyabandara b Jadeja 80 (133b, 9x4), Kamindu Mendis c Jadeja b Prasidh 32 (58b, 3x4, 1x6), Dhananjaya de Silva c Rahul b Suthar 8 (14b, 2x4), Sonal Dinusha (batting) 85 (137b, 6x4, 2x6), Niroshan Dickwella c Jurel b Siraj 0 (3b), Keshara Nuwantha c Saransh b Suthar 18 (74b, 2x4, 2x6, 1x4), Lahiru Kumara (batting) 8 (50b, 1x4), Extras (lb-6, nb-5, w-1); 12; Total (for eight wkts. in 83.4 overs): 265.

FALL OF WICKETS

1-1 (Udara, 12 overs), 2-8 (Prabath, 2.6), 3-35 (Mishara, 9.3), 4-122 (Kamindu, 29.6), 5-137 (Dhananjaya, 34.5), 6-171 (Sooriyabandara, 44.6), 7-173 (Dickwella, 45.3), 8-230 (Nuwantha, 68.2).

INDIA BOWLING

Siraj 11-0-33-1, Prasidh 14-1-47-3, Suthar 21-1-83-3, Saransh 18-5-51-0, Jadeja 19-4-44-51.

Nuwantha and later, Lahiru Kumara hung in, leaving Dinusha (85 batting, 137b, 6x4, 2x6) with the task of reducing the deficit. And then the clouds waited in, the covers were hastily placed, and the players trooped back.

Great to see Prasidh's development: Morkel



On the rise: Prasidh, centre, has been among the wickets. AFP

K.C. Vijaya Kumar
COLOMBO

The Indian pace attack, missing the services of Jasprit Bumrah, has found a second wind due to Mohammed Siraj's consistency and the evolution of Prasidh Krishna. The latter's role came in for warm praise when bowling coach Morne Morkel spoke to the media at the Sinhalese Sports Club Ground here on Tuesday.

"It just shows the character of Prasidh, he has the media, commentators on his back, to fight through that and to bowl in the moment, that for me is very impressive. In an environment where you are under the microscope, every movement gets analysed, and sometimes you try and fight those elements. I think Prasidh now is just enjoying his cricket and loves bowling," Morkel said.

Prasidh bagged three wickets during the Sri Lankan first innings in the second Test, and Morkel

said: "The results are showing. He works hard, does his research on the opposition. He is a massive student of the game and it is great to see him develop into a world-class bowler. In all formats, he has the potential to play for a very long time."

About the host's lower-order being difficult to dismantle, Morkel explained: "Sometimes we think the pitch looks nice and dry, and we need to bowl teams out for 180, 200. Unfortunately at times, it is not going to work like that. These are tough conditions and the ball goes soft quickly. The follow-on, that will be the first prize if we can get the last two wickets early. With the weather being the way it is, we need to get in as many overs."

Update on Pant

And as for Rishabh Pant, Morkel gave an update: "He got hit on the shoulder, badly bruised, we will keep monitoring him and hopefully he will be behind the stumps".

'Coaching standards need to get better'

K.C. Vijaya Kumar
COLOMBO

Grace and grit are intrinsic to Sidath Wettimuny. The former Sri Lankan opener was the Emerald Isle's first Test centurion with a 157 against Pakistan at Faisalabad in 1982. He has seen Sri Lankan cricket evolve, first as a player, then as an administrator and now as a member of the SLC Transformation Committee.

After 70 summers, Wettimuny's love for cricket remains intact, as evident during a chat. While referring to the current phase of stagnancy in Sri Lankan cricket, he said: "The main reason (for the decline) is the neglect in some areas, like coaching and umpiring. Once we won the 1996 World Cup, the game spread beyond the city, to the countryside and we did not look at coaching skills in rural areas. We are trying to address that. We have to make sure that the umpiring and coaching standards get better."

Working on the First Class structure, Wettimuny said: "We are bringing down the number of premier tier 1 clubs by next year. From I think 14 to 10 so that the best teams play. More quality rather than quantity. We have proposed a four-day (match) tournament."

Reverting to nostalgia, when asked about being



Wettimuny. FILE PHOTO

Sri Lanka's first Test centurion, Wettimuny said: "After you get it, and you come back and somebody says, 'do you realise it was the first?', and then you say, 'oh is that so?' I was lucky because Roy (Dias) got one a few days later." Part of the squad that defeated Kapil Dev's men 1-0 in a Test series at home in 1985, Wettimuny recalled: "We prepared seaming tracks and we had Saliya Ahangama, who bowled brilliantly. We had a good pace attack and it worked."

An instinctive walker after being dismissed, Wettimuny said: "It's a personal thing. I was taught, when you are out, get lost. It boils down to cheating if you know you are out."

And about 1996 World Cup triumph, Wettimuny said: "Sanath Jayasuriya transformed the game like what K. Srikanth did (for India). Aravinda (de Silva) was at his best, we had a team which was really good and with every match we became optimistic."

Late wickets peg West back, leave contest wide open; East crushes North East

DULEEP TROPHY

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

Some late-afternoon tardiness may end up costing West Zone its Duleep Trophy quarterfinal versus North Zone as it lost four wickets in the final 30 minutes of day three to close at 220 for seven, chasing 287.

This included set batters in Ruturaj Gaikwad (66, 70b, 7x4) and Musheer Khan (96, 126b, 8x4, 2x6), and it brought North back into a contest that had seemingly slipped from its grasp on an eventful Tuesday at the BCCI Centre of Excellence here.

Ruturaj risked a sharp single and was run out by a direct hit from wicketkeeper Kanhaiya Wadhawan while Musheer tried a wild one-handed sweep and was caught behind.

Until then, the duo had combined for an excellent 111-run stand for the fourth wicket. Ruturaj impressed with his wristy stroke-making and Musheer with his footwork. So much so that, the red-soil pitch, which had hissed and spluttered until then, turned a mute witness to their top-notch batting.

But their dismissals, followed by the twin setbacks in the final over of left-arm spinner Abid Mushtaq, left



Fatal sweep: Musheer's one-handed shot landed in the gloves of the wicketkeeper. K. MURALI KUMAR



Captain's pride: Anukul, who spun East to an innings win, celebrates a strike with Kishan. K. MURALI KUMAR

the match on a knife's edge. There is some solace for West as Urvil Patel is still at the crease (17 batting, 17b, 3x4), and capable all-rounders in Shardul Thakur and Tanush Kotian are yet to bat.

Earlier in the morning, North Zone, from an overnight 107 for four, folded for 222, with Ayush Badoni top-scoring with 50 (62b, 6x4).

All 10 wickets were snared by spinners, with

even Musheer claiming two.

The 21-year-old Mumbai cricketer will now hope that his all-round performance doesn't go in vain.

On the adjacent ground, East Zone completed an innings and 210-run win over North East to set up a semifinal date with defending champion Central Zone.

North East was bundled out for 146 after having begun the day at seven for no loss. Anukul Roy took five wickets (five for 37), and 15-year-old Vaibhav Sooryavanshi too joined the party (two for 11) with his handy left-arm spin.

The scores:

North Zone 251 & 222 in 51 overs (Ayush Badoni 50, Nishant Sindhu 44, Shams Mulani 4/78, Tanush Kotian 4/46) vs. West Zone 187 & 220/7 in 51 overs (Musheer Khan 96, Ruturaj Gaikwad 66). East Zone 467 bt North East Zone 111 & 146 in 50 overs (Anukul Roy 5/37).

INBRIEF



Pranesh finishes on top in Kanizsa Open chess

Grandmaster M. Pranesh won the prestigious Kanizsa Open in Kanizsa, Hungary, recently. Pranesh, who started the tournament as the second seed behind GM Matthias Bluebaum, emerged on top with seven points by winning five games and drawing the remaining four. With a rating of 2673, Pranesh gained 0.8 Elo.



Mayank and Prattee take the honours in Asian junior chess

Top-seeded Indians Mayank Chakaraborty and Prattee Bordoloi emerged champions in the open and girls' sections respectively at the Asian junior chess championship N Mumbai on Tuesday. Both finished with 7.5 points from nine rounds.

The standings: Open: 1. Mayank Chakaraborty 7.5/9; 2. Artem Pigin (Rus) 7; 3-9. Daksh Goyal, Harsh Ghadge, Viresh Sharnathi, Vignesh Vemula, Imangali Akhlibay (Kaz), Apoorv Kamble and Madhvendra Sharma 6.5; 10. Ahmet Gubataev (Tkm) 6. **Girls:** 1. Prattee Bordoloi 7.5/9; 2. Mariya Kholiyavko (Kaz) 6; 3-6. V.C. Nivedita, Lala Shrodrava (Tkm), Prishita Gupta and Savayasee Bheemareddy 6.5; 7-10. G. Shivambika, Sunetra Dey, Lelya Shrodrava (Tkm) and Akshaya Sathi 6.

Ahmedabad to host C'wealth cue sports championships

Ahmedabad will host the second Commonwealth cue sports championships from October 7 to 10. The four-day event will see cueists from nearly 46 countries compete across five disciplines – billiards, snooker, heyball, 10-ball pool and blackball – in both men's and women's categories.

Indian squad: Men: Billiards: Siddharth Parikh; **Snooker:** Rayaan Razmi; **Heyball:** Shivam Arora (direct entry), Laxman Rawat; **10-ball pool:** Divya Sharma; **Blackball:** Sundeeep Gulati. **Women: Billiards:** Anupama Ramchandran; **Snooker:** Keerthana Pandian; **Heyball:** Vidya Pillai (direct entry), Anne Kamani; **10-ball pool:** Chitra Magimairaj (direct entry), Neena Praveen; **Blackball:** Natasha Chethan. **Coach:** Ashok Shandilya.

Spurs splash out £75 million for Man City's Savinho

Tottenham signed Brazilian winger Savinho from Manchester City on Tuesday for a reported initial fee of £75 million to take its overall outlay in the transfer market beyond £300 million this window. The 22-year-old failed to establish himself as a first-team regular during two seasons at City. But Spurs are hoping he can add pace and creativity to their attack.

Indian jersey gives a different kind of strength: Jyotirmoyee

Asian Games gold medalist Jyotirmoyee Sikdar on Tuesday highlighted the emotional side of wearing the National jersey. Speaking on 'Merchandising of team jerseys is unethical' at Scorebook 2026, a sports conclave organised by the Confederation of Indian Industries (CII) in Kolkata, Jyotirmoyee said, "We got inspired by seeing idols like P.T. Usha and Shiny Wilson. The Indian jersey is not just a piece of clothing. We earn it through years of hard work. When we wear it and run for our country, it gives us a different kind of strength." At another panel discussion on the National Sports Governance Act, Indian Football Association secretary Anirban Dutta stressed the need to ensure meaningful representation of women in administrative and decision-making positions across sports disciplines. Discussions were also held on sports and corporate hierarchy and anti-doping.

LIVE TELECAST

Duleep Trophy: JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.
Sri Lanka vs India: Second Test, Day 4, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LV, 9.45 a.m.
TNPL: Sony Sports Ten 4 Tamil & TNPL Official YouTube channel, 7.30 p.m.
US OPEN: SS Select 1, 2 & JioHotstar, 8.30 p.m. & 4.30 a.m. (Thursday)
Champions League (play-offs, second-leg): Sony Sports Ten 2, 5 & LV, 10.15 p.m. & 12.30 a.m. (Thursday).



Delighted lot: Kishan took East to the Duleep Trophy semifinals with a thumping win. K. MURALI KUMAR

Kishan keen to regain place in Test squad

The dashing stumper-batter says the competition is something else in the longest format; the 28-year-old adds he is happy for Jurel and Pant

CRICKET

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

In mid-2023, Ishan Kishan was an all-format player for India. With Rishabh Pant having suffered a horrific road accident, and K.S. Bharat not so impressive, Kishan made his Test debut in the West Indies that July and was also part of the limited-overs squads. But since then, the dashing wicketkeeper-batter hasn't played a red-ball game for India, and did not feature in a single white-ball international for two full years in 2024 and 2025. It is only now, since the

start of 2026, that he has regained his spot in T20is and ODIs. A Test call-up is far, but the 28-year-old has his eyes set on making another comeback from the margins. "I love this game," Kishan said after leading East Zone to a thumping innings and 210-run victory over North East Zone in the Duleep Trophy quarterfinal on Tuesday. "I enjoy it because when you are in the middle, the ball is moving, players are coming at you, and there is banter. "It's easier to bat on flat tracks and it's fun as well, but competition in Tests is something different. People don't believe me when I say that, but I really do

enjoy red-ball cricket." But being a regular in the white-ball set-up means he barely gets any time to turn out in whites. Prior to this outing, his last First Class match was more than nine months ago. It is highly likely that the Duleep Trophy will be his only brush with the long format until early 2027. "That is the fun part actually," Kishan insisted. "You need to put a lot of effort to get back in the Test team. Dhruv [Jurel] is doing so well; Rishabh [Pant] is doing so well. "But I am very happy for them, [despite] being a competitor. My job is to not think about what can go wrong for them. My job is to just keep getting better."

Strikers women post narrow win



Impactful duo: Shivi and Nazma played crucial roles for Strikers on Tuesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

DPL

Sports Bureau
NEW DELHI

North Delhi Strikers held their nerve in a tricky run chase to edge past East Delhi Riders by three wickets in the women's leg of the Delhi Premier League (DPL) here on Tuesday. In pursuit of 141, Strikers secured a thrilling victory with one ball to spare. The chase had got off to a shaky start as Strikers slipped to 25 for three in 5.3 overs, but Shivi Sharma steadied the innings with a contribution of 34 off 37 balls. Although Shivi's tempo of scoring wasn't quite up to standard, it was made up for by Nazma and Samaira Raghav. Nazma smashed 34 (2lb, 5x4, 1x6) and Samaira also scored an unbeaten 34 (2lb, 2x4, 2x6). Earlier, Nazma also starred with the ball with figures of three for 13 in four overs as Riders were

restricted to 140 for seven. In the final league match of the men's section, East Delhi Riders, which will progress no further, defeated Purani Dilli-6 by 10 runs. In a game reduced to 10 overs per side, Riders scored 118 for six and restricted Purani Dilli to 108 for six. Purani Dilli, which finished third in the standings, will face Outer Delhi Warriors in the Eliminator on Wednesday night. Central Delhi Kings will take on South Delhi Superstarz in Qualifier 1 on Wednesday afternoon. **The scores:** East Delhi Riders women 140/7 in 20 overs (Vanshika Lila 39, Simran Bahadur 39 n.o., Shivani Jangid 2/27, Nazma 3/13) lost to North Delhi Strikers women 141/7 in 19.5 overs (Shivi Sharma 34, Nazma 34, Samaira Raghav 34 n.o., Simran Bahadur 2/19, Tamanna Singh 2/31). East Delhi Riders 118/6 in 10 overs (Arpit Rana 30, Suryansh Raina 42, Digvesh Rath 2/9, Gaurav Saroha 2/28) bt Purani Dilli-6 108/6 in 10 overs (Aryan Gaur 39 ret'd. hurt). Match reduced to 10 overs per side.

HIL's third edition on shaky ground

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

Even as the Indian hockey teams returned disappointing performances from the ongoing World Cup, the revived Hockey India League's third edition seems to be on shaky ground. The HIL is battling for survival on several fronts barely two years after being re-launched with much fanfare. Multiple sources have confirmed to *The Hindu* that more than one existing team is on the verge of exiting and there are question marks over the women's competition too. In addition, very few foreign players have expressed interest in returning for the league. "Last year, the Ranchi franchise came in as replacement for the Odisha team in the women's competition and Gonasika among the men. Shrachi

Tigers, who own the Bengal franchise among both men and women, are also on the lookout of investors to offload and exit," federation sources admitted. Earlier this year, owners of Ranchi Royals wrote to the HIL Governing Council seeking clarity on their continuation, non-receipt of promised sponsorship worth ₹10 cr. from the Jharkhand government and transparency in commercial terms. The franchise has since been terminated over non-payment issues with Hockey India clearing dues from the franchise's share of revenue. Among the four women's team, only JSW Sports and APL Apollo, owners of Delhi SG Pipers, have agreed to continue in the league, albeit verbally at the moment, after considering an exit. Sources said talks are in final stages for a Bangalore-based team

as well. "The women's league will happen, and with four teams only. The modalities are still being worked out but there is no question of discontinuing it," a source in the know insisted. The men's competition, however, is likely to see fewer teams down from the eight in the first two editions. "There may be a change of ownership or franchise city. The number of teams is also likely to be less, perhaps five or six at the most," Hockey India officials said. The league has been plagued by issues from the beginning. Gonasika was roped in as the eight men's team on the day of Player Auction in 2024. Ranchi's original women's team was accused of non-payment by several foreign players and even Shrachi managed to clear its dues for the 2025 season only towards the end of June. The lack of

foreign players' interest due to payment uncertainties also forced Hockey India to extend its initial registration deadline from July 24 to August 31. It has also been reliably learnt that HIL president Dilip Tirkey has had several rounds of meetings with franchise owners, including Parth Jindal of JSW and Sanjay Gupta of APL Apollo, prospective sponsors and representatives of the Tata Group in the last one month across the country, trying to salvage the league. It has also been learnt that the precarious situation around HIL and the series of meetings had led Tirkey to cancel his own travel for the World Cup and denying official permission to HIL Director General Cdr. R.K. Srivastava, convenor the HIL Governing Committee, for the same, which was disregarded.



Poignant moment: Bichu and Savita pose for Caroline. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Emotional meeting for Savita and Bichu with late coach's wife

HOCKEY WORLD CUP

Aashin Prasad
AMSTERDAM

India's two goalkeepers, Savita Punia and Bichu Devi, were set to go through their training drills, ahead of their crucial World Cup match against Australia on Sunday, when a poignant moment unfolded by the advertising boards. They were approached by Caroline Busch, wife of the late Simon Zip, a renowned goalkeeping coach in Dutch hockey. Zip, who had been training Savita and Bichu since the start of last year, was set to return to India last November before his untimely demise in October. Caroline had travelled from Hague and wanted to take this opportunity to reconnect with the girls, due to the strong bond they shared with Zip. She handed them some chocolates, a couple of small wooden shoes – a symbol of Netherlands' farming history – and a personal note. "In the note, I wrote that Simon always talked very highly of them. I also wished them a lot of luck and success for the future," said Caroline while wiping away her tears. For Savita, the unexpected meeting with Caroline turned into a pleasant memory. Savita said Zip's words

Federer keen to return to Arthur Ashe Stadium

Agence France-Presse
NEW YORK

Roger Federer said on Monday he was looking forward to this week's celebratory return to Arthur Ashe Stadium to play for the first time since his final US Open in 2019. "It really gives me a true opportunity to say thank you," Federer said at a news conference previewing the match and his upcoming induction to the International Tennis Hall of Fame later this week in Newport. New York fans of Federer were deprived of a true send-off for the 20-time Grand Slam champion. While Federer has played some other exhibitions since retiring, he said that the time had only seemed to fall into place for a New York match this year ahead of the Newport ceremony. "The kids are getting older," he said of his four children, two sets of twins now 12 and 17. "So they can also maybe enjoy a little bit seeing, their dad play." Federer expects a "respectful" match with a not-too-intense level of competition. "We're not playing best of five," he said "I hope it's going to be a lot of fun for us and the same for the fans to just see us back out playing."

Chelsea begins Alonso era with an exciting 3-2 win at Fulham

EURO LEAGUES

Reuters
LONDON

Chelsea began life under new coach Xabi Alonso with a breathless 3-2 win at West London neighbour Fulham in the Premier League on Monday as its exciting front three of Joao Pedro, Morgan Rogers and Cole Palmer all found the net. Chelsea got off to a dream start after 31 seconds when Palmer – looking back to his best after struggling with an injury last season – passed to Joao Pedro and the Brazilian flicked the ball over goalkeeper Bernd Leno. Fulham equalised when Josh King beat Chelsea goalkeeper Robert Sanchez at his near post in the 24th minute. But two of Chelsea's



Early strike: Pedro gave Chelsea a dream start by slotting in after just 31 seconds. REUTERS

new signings then combined in the 41st as central defender Maxence Lacroix jinked down the right before cutting the ball back to the club's £117 million record signing Rogers, who made no mistake. Four minutes into the second half, Palmer slotted

the ball through Leno's legs after he was fed by Joao Pedro. Fulham's Gonzalo Garcia, on his league debut after signing from Real Madrid, gave the host hope by heading in after Sanchez could only parry a Timothy Castagne shot in the 54th.

The results: **Premier League:** Fulham 2 (King 23, Garcia 54) lost to Chelsea 3 (Pedro 1, Rogers 41, Palmer 49). **Serie A:** Bologna 0 lost to Lazio 1 (Fratesi 59); Roma 4 (Malen 27, 52, 60, Pissilli 86) bt Fiorentina 0. **La Liga:** Osasuna 0 drew with Levante 0; Malaga 1 (Chupe 34-pen) drew with Deportivo La Coruna 1 (Aubameyang 21).

K. Keerthivasan

Since judo started as a demonstration sport in 1986 in Edinburgh, it has had a chequered journey in the Commonwealth Games.

A casual glance at how the sport has progressed in the Games will show how judo has been in and out of the programme over the years.

After Edinburgh, from 1990 to 2014, it remained an optional sport, not being included in the 1994 Victoria and 1998 Kuala Lumpur Games, before being included in the 2002 Manchester Games and again going out of favour in 2006 Melbourne and 2010 Delhi. While it was included in the 2014 Glasgow Games, it was removed from the programme for the 2018 Gold Coast Games. It, however, made a comeback in 2022 Birmingham.

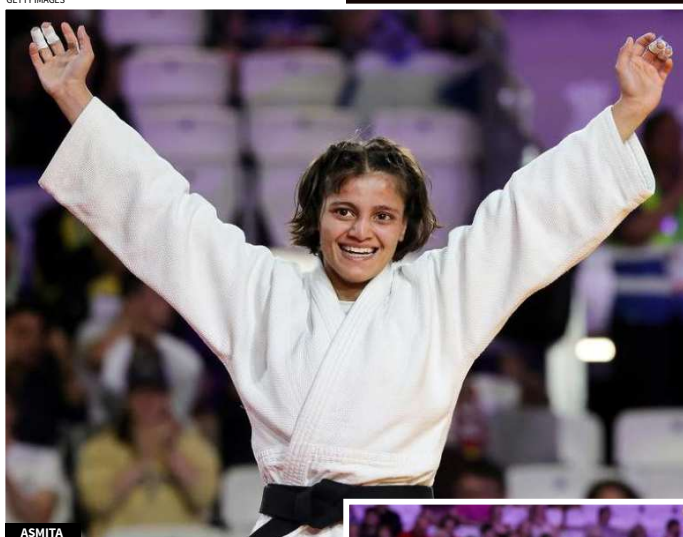
When it was retained for the 2026 Glasgow Games, judo performed remarkably well compared to many other disciplines.

After athletics and para-athletics, judo became the sport that spread its medals across most number of nations – 18 in all, according to the *Commonwealth Sport* website.

"Judo spread its medals across 18 nations at Glasgow, more than any sport except athletics and para-athletics. That reach was particularly striking because judo offered only 14 medal events. England and Canada finished with four golds each, but the podium extended far beyond the established powers," it observed.

Detailing the reach of judo in other countries, the website went on:

GETTY IMAGES



ASMITA

"Malaysia and Mauritius produced their first champions, Cyprus collected seven medals, while Gabon, The Bahamas and Tonga all reached the podium on the final day."

Moreover, the report mentioned that at Birmingham 2022, "16 nations won judo medals. Glasgow increased that number to 18, underlining how many different routes the sport now offers to Commonwealth success."

The most striking development, however, was the emergence of India as a power to reckon with. India won four medals, including a historic two gold medals – its first-ever in Commonwealth Games – but judo now become a core sport in the 2030 Games centenary edition in Ahmedabad?

There is no guarantee, though. In the recently held Commonwealth Sport's Programme Review, judo did not find a place on the list of sports that are certain to feature in Ahmedabad. It remains one of the sports under consideration.

Commonwealth Sport has confirmed that 15-17 sports will feature with the final line-up likely to be announced next year. The two historic gold medals won in Glasgow, however, could strengthen judo's case when the Games return to India. The country's success overall, coupled with the sport's remarkable geographical spread – with medals going to 18 nations in Glasgow – provides a strong argument for its inclusion.

The stars who made that possible were Asmita Dey and Harsh Singh.

Asmita's women's 48kg field at Glasgow was respectable and quite competitive, but certainly it was not an exceptionally deep field by world-judo standards. The important point is that Asmita entered as the No. 1 seed, and that was justified by the world rankings (International Judo Federation) at the Games. Asmita was the No. 1 seed and world No. 48 while Canada's Heidi Quach was the No. 2 seed and world No. 57.

In the regular four-minute contest, Quach initially took the lead with a yuko (partial score), while Asmita was also penalised. Asmita fought back to level the contest, and neither judoka could produce a decisive score in regulation



HARSH

The two historic gold medals won in Glasgow could strengthen judo's case when the Commonwealth Games returns to India. The country's success overall, coupled with the sport's remarkable geographical spread – with medals going to 18 nations in the recent edition – provides a strong argument for its inclusion



Canada, UK and New Zealand are the powerhouses in judo, but India is catching up fast. Because now in the Government, things have changed. In our time, there used to be one- or two-month camps for the Indians. Now, we have camps throughout the year and have sponsors, too

YASHPAL SOLANKI
Asmita's coach



time. The bout went into 'Golden Score', where Asmita eventually produced the winning action to prevail 2-1 and become India's first-ever Commonwealth Games judo champion and Harsh followed suit.

"Winning two gold medals is a big achievement," said Jiwan Kumar Sharma, Indian women's team head coach, who was at Glasgow.

The 64-year-old said the gold was possible only due to the willpower and mental strength of the 23-year-old from Tripura.

"We were actually sure that at least one gold medal this time. We exceeded expectations by winning four medals including two golds. Asmita fought exceptionally in semifinals and final where she was trailing. But it was her willpower that brought her the gold," he said.

For Harsh, the other gold medal winner for India in the men's 60kg category, the medal was priceless as he came to the Games after incurring a serious knee injury in August last year.

Harsh underwent knee surgery in Bengaluru in October the same year. He then went through almost a year of rehabilitation before returning to competition and went on to win gold, which showed his determination and fierce drive.

In Glasgow, Harsh was world ranked 99 and seeded fourth, while his opponent in the final, Australian Joshua Katz, was 115 in the world rankings and seeded sixth.

In fact, Harsh was not the favourite to bag the title. Facing top-seeded Australian

Pedro Carlos Antun Neto, who was ranked 33rd in the world, in the semifinal, the Indian produced a sensational performance, beating Neto 10-0.

Harsh's summit clash was different from Asmita's. While Asmita had to survive a tense battle that went into 'Golden Score', Harsh absorbed Katz's early pressure before doing well to seal the gold.

Katz started aggressively and tried hard to impose himself on the contest. Harsh defended calmly and did not rush into an attack. The Indian waited for the right moment, countering rather than forcing the play.

Head coach Jiwan was all praise for Harsh's relentless drive against the odds to succeed.

"Harsh didn't have that experience coming into the Games as he was playing in third or fourth international event. But his willpower is great as he is from the Indian Army. After the surgery, he was feeling helpless as he was not able to compete in many International competitions," said Jiwan, who trains Harsh at Inspire Institute of Sport. "My ward outplayed all his opponents with clear technique and it was really great performance by Harsh."

Now with a historic performance under their belt, Indian judokas will be facing far tougher competition at the Asian Games to be held in Japan in September-October.

India's record in judo has been poor at the Games. Its last medal came in the 1994 Games in Hiroshima when Poonam



Chopra bagged a bronze in the women's 56kg category.

Jiwan Kumar knows it better than anyone else. He still expects a medal in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan, at the Asian Games.

"This time, I am expecting at least one medal. Of course, that depends on the draw and how we maintain our performance. I am sure they are capable of defeating anyone. Japan, Korea, Uzbekistan, Kazakhstan, Mongolia and China are very good as they have many Olympic champions, but we have defeated them earlier. Let's hope for the best," he said.

For the Asian Games so far, only three women – Asmita (48kg), Yamini Mourya (57kg) and Inunganbi Takhellambam (70kg) – have qualified as they are ranked among the top six in Asia, according to Jiwan.

"The National Federation has told the Sports Ministry that the medalists from the CWG should also be included as they are in good form," he said.

Yashpal Solanki, who has been coaching Asmita for the last eight years, believes Indian judo is catching up fast with the established powers.

"Canada, UK and New Zealand are the powerhouses in judo, but India is catching up fast. Because now in the Government, things have changed. In our time, there used to be one- or two-month camps for the Indians. Now, we have camps throughout the year. That time, we didn't have sponsors.

Right now, we have Sanskar Dham Academy (Ahmedabad) and many private academies, accredited academies. Then, we have JSW and Olympic Gold Quest," he said.

Yashpal believes Asmita is capable of winning a medal in the Asian Games, though he admits it will be quite tough.

"It is very difficult. But it totally depends on the day. If she performs well and plays to her potential, she can win a medal. Not gold, but at least win a medal," he said.

Indian judokas have raised expectations after their stupendous show in Glasgow, and it is incumbent upon them to keep raising their performance for the sport to remain in the radar and gain popularity and people's acceptance. The Asian Games will be a litmus test.

THE GIST

Despite a historic performance under their belt, Indian judokas will be facing far tougher competition at the Asian Games to be held in Japan in September-October

Coach Yashpal believes Asmita is capable of winning a medal in the Asian Games

It is incumbent upon the Indian judokas to keep improving their performance for the sport to remain in the radar and gain popularity

SCIENCE

Models struggled to predict the 2026 monsoon's rapid changes

While one bad year is no reason to panic, it must also serve as an opportunity to identify the key issues that remain; for instance, will combinations of the El Niño and global warming make the monsoon unpredictable at sub-seasonal and local scales? How will models prepare for such a future?

Raghu Murtugudde

Climate models predicted the 2026 El Niño during early spring, just as they had in 2023. And the predictions have turned out to be accurate, with the robust evolution of a strong El Niño by the summer.

Models had predicted the 2023 monsoon to be slightly deficient, and the final seasonal total, at 94% of the long-period average, essentially validated the forecasts. Monsoon predictions this year have already called for a deficit of greater than 10% and it will also likely hold true.

But the real cause for concern is the erratic and unprecedented evolution of the monsoon across space and time in 2026, which the models have not been able to capture even a few days in advance.

The key question now is whether the challenges posed by the 2026 predictions were an aberration, and, if so, why. In other words, do the models need to do anything dramatic to ensure they do better in the coming years? Or is it just a trend to be expected for the monsoon system, which has only become more notorious for its vagaries?

Expectations of improvements

The El Niño is one of the most predictable modes of natural variability. But models being able to predict its occurrence to the tune of 80% still means they will be wrong one-fifth of the time. The failed La Niña prediction of 2024 is a good example. Models' ability to predict the monsoon is much lower, hovering at around 60%, which means prediction failures will also occur more often. And this is for the all-Indian monsoon rainfall (AIMR); long-lead forecasting of monsoon onset and space-time evolution are even greater challenges.

This year's monsoon onset over Kerala was predicted to be delayed, and it was, by a few days. But everything after that has been a whiplash. Rainfall in June was 40% below normal but July recovered quickly to 1% above normal. At the same time, these AIMR values hardly captured the heartache of farmers, who suffered much larger deficits over their arable land.

India's multi-tiered prediction systems cover short (days 1-3), medium (days 3-10), and extended (weeks 2 and longer) range demands for weather information. Seasonal to interannual predictions of AIMR are relatively easier; long-lead predictions of spatial and temporal monsoon evolutions face irreducible uncertainties at present.

While one bad year is no reason to panic, it must also serve as an opportunity to identify the key issues that remain. For instance, are we going to



Motorists navigate through a water-logged street in following a sudden downpour on Tuesday in New Delhi. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

have more years of such erratic monsoon evolution? Will combinations of the El Niño and global warming make the monsoon unpredictable at subseasonal and local scales? And how will models prepare for such a future, to better help the country maintain its progress towards becoming economically developed?

Knowns and unknowns

The monsoon domain is blessed with more than a century's worth of data. Experts have extracted significant knowledge from this rich dataset of monsoon variabilities in space and time, and have made considerable advances in understanding the intrinsic timescales of active-break cycles, the onset becoming more erratic, delayed withdrawal, switching between extreme dry and wet events, more frequent extreme wet spells over Northwest India, and so on. However, their understanding of the mechanisms underlying these events remains incomplete.

The hope is that complete climate models with coupled land-ocean-atmosphere components can shed light on the missing links and help scientists make better, more skillful predictions.

The multi-tiered approach taken to develop separate tools for short, medium, and extended range predictions has yielded many impressive advances in useful predictions for various sectors, including agriculture, water, energy, health, and so on.

At present, the most promising avenues for further advances in

Climate models' ability to predict the monsoon is low, hovering at around 60%, which means prediction failures will also occur more often – and this is just for the all-Indian monsoon rainfall

improving models and predictions are likely to come from using artificial intelligence (AI) tools.

The dearth of mechanistic understanding is not a limitation for AI since these tools can extract patterns from the data and based on that make predictions, without any knowledge of the governing physics.

That said, experts must overcome one critical limitation in the course of combining AI with climate models: they must ensure they collect sufficient data to cover all aspects of the monsoon and its drivers at all the relevant spatial and temporal scales. In fact, this data must also account for the local amplifiers of extreme weather, such as land use change, urbanisation, deforestation, and irrigation.

That said, given new technologies and platforms, the volume and value of data will only grow. And AI models are already advancing optimal and cost-effective observation networks and improving our knowledge of processes, models, and predictions. AI is also proving to be indispensable for bringing global predictions at the scale of several kilometres down to farm and neighbourhood scales, for sector-specific

advisories and early warnings.

Public-private partnerships are also part of the landscape today when it comes to delivering weather and climate services.

Predictions and expectations

As predictions get better, so do the expectations. Specifically, advances in predictions related to the monsoon, including its onset, evolution, extreme dry/wet events, and withdrawal, also allow the users of these data to believe they can expect even better in future.

To this end, hybrid dynamic and AI models could deliver sector-specific predictions at the requisite space-time scales for users to better manage disasters, farm-related decisions, and water and energy use.

Extensively engaging users with sustained feedback can pave the way for decision-support products to be co-produced with the people who make those decisions.

Predictions will never be perfect but they can continue to serve user needs by staying within the level of uncertainty a user can tolerate. In the coming years, policymakers, farmers, health workers, energy companies, and insurance providers can expect to be served bespoke forecasts. Global warming will keep throwing monkey wrenches into prediction systems but observations, dynamic models, and AI will continue to step up to the challenges.

(Raghu Murtugudde is an Earth Systems Scientist and a visiting professor at IIT-Kanpur. mahatma@umd.edu)

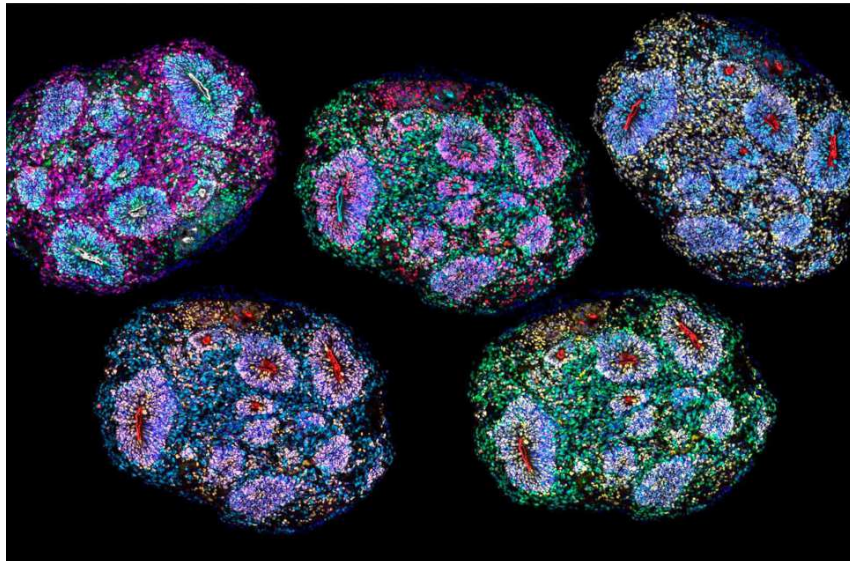
THE GIST

India's multi-tiered prediction systems cover short (days 1-3), medium (days 3-10), and extended (weeks 2 and longer) range demands for weather information

The real cause for concern is the erratic, and unprecedented, evolution of the monsoon across space and time in 2026, which the models have not been able to capture even a few days in advance

At present, the most promising avenues for further advances in improving models and predictions are likely to come from using artificial intelligence (AI) tools

BIG SHOT



Brain organoids — human brain cells grown in a lab — are seen in this March 2023 image, provided on August 19, by Harvard University researchers. These peppercorn-sized clumps of human brain cells were grown from stem cells in a lab for a record seven years and aged similarly to those inside our heads, the researchers said. AP

QUESTION CORNER

Race against time

Q: What is a launch window?
A: On August 24, China called off the launch of its Chang'e 7 mission to the moon's south pole for the sake of "prudence, reliability and absolute mission success". It will now have to wait until next year for another chance. All space missions have specific launch windows — periods when the positions and motions of the satellite (on the rocket), the earth, and the target body are properly aligned. The moon orbits the earth once every 27.3 days, so launch windows to the moon open once a month. But if a mission has to go to the moon's south pole region, the window changes. A spacecraft approaching a point near the moon's rotational pole will have to be orbiting the moon close to a north-south plane. The plane of the moon's orbit is tilted by 5.1° relative to that of the earth's orbit. And the moon's equator is tilted by just around 1.5° relative to the earth. As a result, the desirable trajectory a spacecraft should achieve around the moon will change depending on the moon's position around the earth. The end goal is to launch the mission such that it achieves this trajectory after expending the least amount of fuel



The Long March-5 Y14 rocket carrying the Chang'e 7 lunar probe being transferred to the launching area at Wenchang Spacecraft Launch Site in Hainan Province, China, on August 19. AP

possible. Since the Chang'e 7 mission spacecraft will be powered by sunlight, it also faces a second constraint. The sun doesn't rise high above the horizon at the moon's south pole, so Chang'e 7 will have to land at its designated spot when it is sufficiently sunlit. This is why missing one launch window can mean waiting for several days, weeks or even months for the next one.

For feedback and suggestions for 'Science', please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject 'Daily page'